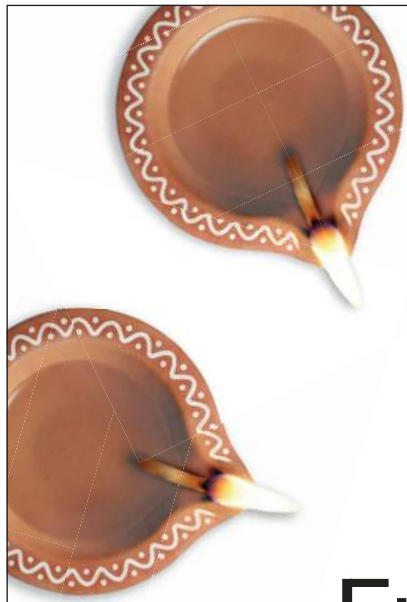


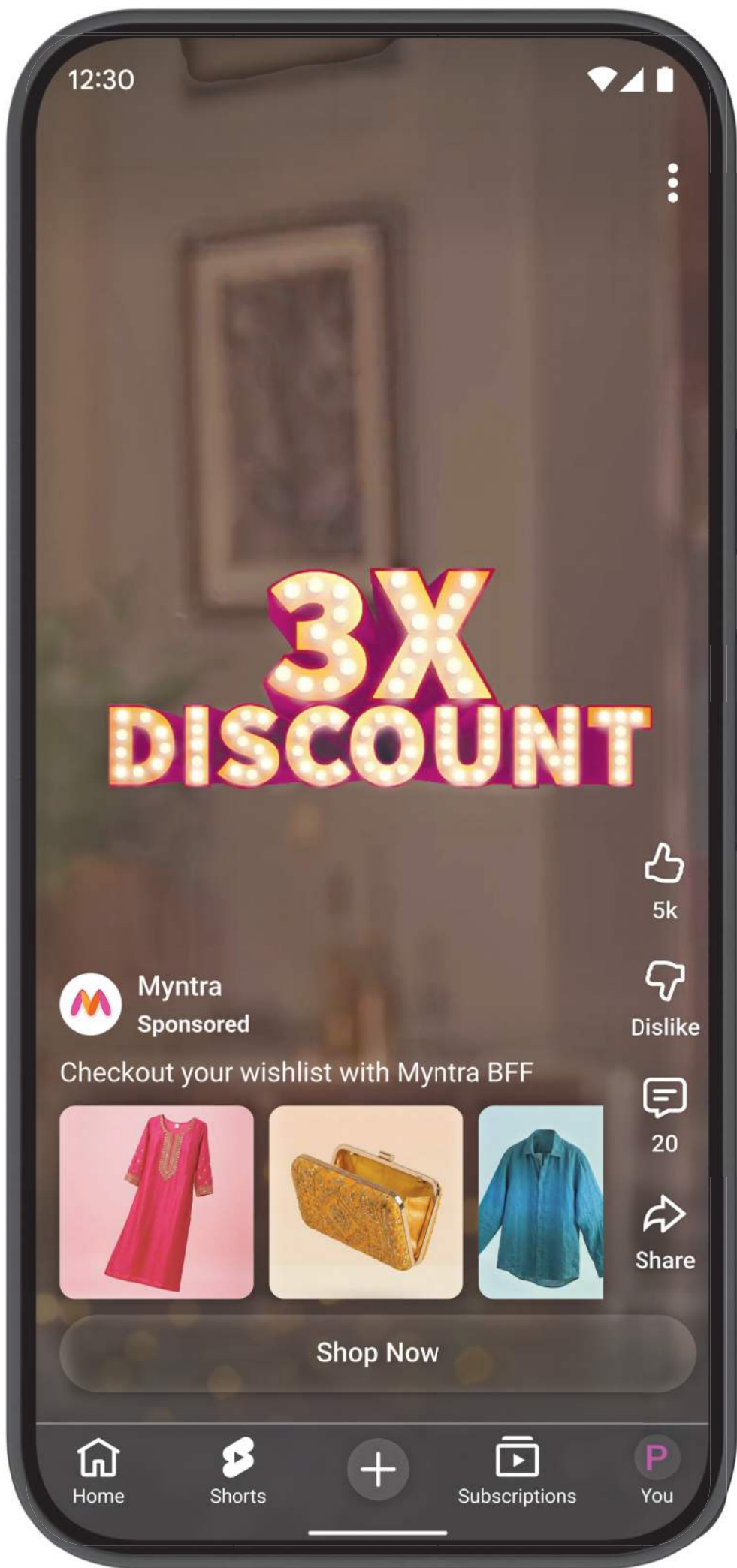


► Cos Rush to File IPO Papers in Sept: P 11 ► IndiaAI Mission likely to Reset after GPU Delay ► Buoyant Q2 Consumer Demand Lifts Festive Sales Outlook: P 1



From sweet indulgences to trending fits

Turn every scroll into festive business growth



Delivered **60%** lower cost per reach with
YouTube Shorts First Position



Drove **40%** incremental reach with
YouTube Shorts First Position



Maximise ROI
this festive season



Drive festive business growth



45%

of **YouTube Shorts** users in India
don't use Instagram Reels¹



2.3x

YouTube drives 2.3x **incremental ROAS** compared to **social media**²



Maximise ROI
this festive season



Sources:

1. GWI, IN, 2025

2. Equity-to-Sales MMM Meta Analysis commissioned by Google, 2021-2023

*Some elements edited or created with AI

D-STREET DEBUT PLANS

Inox Clean Energy Files DRHP for ₹10kcr Issue; Inox Air Submits Papers



Inox Clean Energy has filed its draft red herring prospectus for a ₹10,000 crore initial public offering, the largest such public issue from a private sector green energy company. It will seek to raise ₹8,000 crore through fresh issue. **Inox Air Products**, a leading industrial gases maker, has filed DRHP for an IPO that could target raising ₹10,000 crore. The draft prospectus did not mention the issue size. >> 5

FOR DIGITAL SERVICES

Intl Credit Card Spends May Need Reporting



International credit card payments for digital services may require consumers to report transaction details to banks from October 1 under new international trade payment regulations, reports **Sugata Ghosh**. >> 12

Personal Loans Clock Faster Growth

Personal loans, which account for about a third of total bank credit, surged 16.9% year-on-year by August-end, backed by high growth in segments such as gold loans and loans against fixed deposits, showed central bank data on Wednesday. >> 12

Digital NBFC Loan Books Grow 28%

Digital NBFCs' personal loan books expanded 28% to ₹1.54 lakh crore at June-end from ₹1.20 lakh crore last year even as the number of outstanding loan accounts fell. This shows larger balances drove growth. >> 12

Sebi and RBI to Coordinate on FPIs

Sebi chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey said the regulator is working with RBI to ease the onboarding process for foreign portfolio investors (FPIs). "There is much more active inter-regulatory coordination. We have been working very closely and we've been able to sort out many issues," he said. >> 11

Hallmarking Charges a Concern

A sharp rise in gold hallmarking charges is raising concerns over fake hallmarking, especially in tier-2, tier-3 and tier-4 cities where awareness of verifying HUID numbers on the BIS Care app remains low. GJC chairman Rajesh Rokde said only about 10% of India's 800 districts have adequate awareness. >> 5

Vadilal Signs New Supply Deal

Ice-cream and frozen desserts maker Vadilal Industries signed a revised 12-month supply agreement with estranged group entity Vadilal Enterprises for marketing and distribution. The agreement will be effective from November 1, 2026, to October 31, 2027. >> 5

THE MORNING BRIEF PODCAST



ECI: Who Controls India's Voter List?

Neil Ghai speaks to ET's Anubhuti Vishnoi on ECI independence, the internal dispute over electoral-roll procedures and what the SIR process means for voters and upcoming elections.

Available on [EconomicTimes.com/podcast](#), [Amazon Prime Music](#), [Apple Podcasts](#), [JioSaavn](#) and [Spotify](#).

MARKET PRESSURES LEAVE COS STRUGGLING

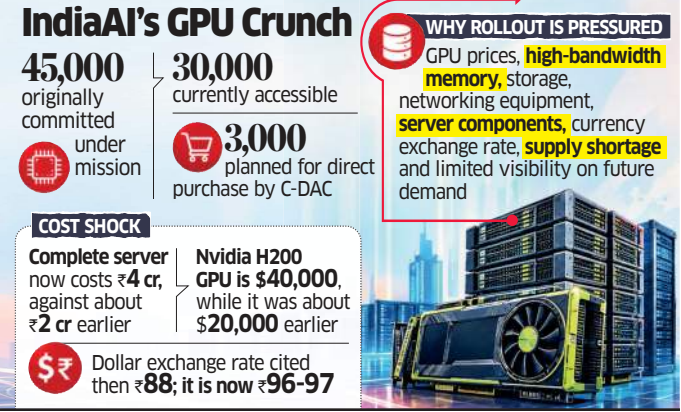
IndiaAI Mission may be Rewired on GPU Glitch

Fresh bids ahead as cost escalates, govt to buy own GPUs

Suraksha P & Surabhi Agarwal

Bengaluru | New Delhi: The government is planning to recalibrate the IndiaAI Mission as the rollout of critical compute components, particularly GPUs, faces delays and mounting cost pressures. That follows a sharp rise in memory and GPU prices since the mission was launched in March 2024. In most instances, prices have more than doubled over the past year.

The IndiaAI Mission currently has access to about 30,000 GPUs against a total commitment of 45,000. Several firms that had committed capacity have been unable to deliver due to market pressures.



The IT ministry is now planning to issue fresh bids while also pressing companies to meet their pledges. "Compute across the world is constrained. We are pushing hard to see what we can give to our companies," a senior government official told ET. "We are constantly talking to them, and we are trying to increase the overall level of supply." The ministry also plans to buy 3,000 GPUs.

Expediting Work >> 10

Buoyant Q2 Demand for Consumer Goods Lifts Festive Sales Outlook

Momentum from double-digit sales growth for electronics, FMCG may continue

Writankar Mukherjee

Kolkata: Consumer demand accelerated in the July-September quarter, with sales of air conditioners, refrigerators, washing machines, fast-moving consumer goods (FMCGs) and branded apparel

growing at a double-digit pace or near it, setting the stage for a strong festive season.

Growth was partly aided by price increases and a low base last year when goods and services tax (GST) cuts disrupted sales and distribution for more than a month ahead of implementation of the new rates with effect from September 22. However, volume growth was strong even after adjusting for the base effect, particularly in consumer durables and apparel.

Small Towns Take Lead >> 10

NEW RULES TO KICK IN FROM 2027

Stricter CAFÉ III Norms Notified for Automakers

Cos need to cut average fuel usage of PV fleets over a 5-year period

Our Bureau

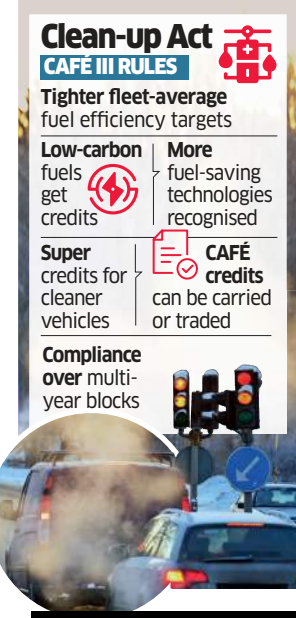
New Delhi: The government has notified Corporate Average Fuel Economy (CAFÉ) III guidelines, making it mandatory for automakers to reduce average fuel consumption of their passenger vehicle fleets progressively over a five-year period starting April 2027.

The power ministry said the new norms will drive improvements in fuel economy through year-on-year tightening of targets.

Fuel consumption benchmark will be tightened from 3.996 litres/100 km in FY28 to 3.3273 litres/100 km in FY32, an improvement of around 16.7% in the period.

The revised target line has been flattened to make it more balanced and weight-sensitive, with relatively softer targets for lighter vehicles and greater fuel efficiency requirements for heavier vehicles, the ministry said in a statement.

Weight Factor >> 10
RELATED REPORT >> 5



HIGHER CAPEX, SUBSIDY OUTGO BEHIND SHARP RISE

Fiscal Deficit at 42% of FY27 Goal

Fiscal deficit for April-August stood at ₹7.1 lakh crore, or 41.9% of the FY27 target, due to higher capex and increased subsidy outgo, official data showed. >> 13

EXTERNAL DEBT: GDP RATIO MODERATES TO 20.8% >> 12

PM LAUDS BIG PUSH

Cabinet gives Green Signal to Green Energy Corridor III

Intra-state clean power transmission to be enabled under ₹1.86Lcr scheme

Our Bureau

New Delhi: The Cabinet on Wednesday approved a scheme with a project outlay of ₹1.86 lakh crore to help states develop transmission corridors for green energy by laying new lines or upgrading the existing network, and build battery storage systems. The scheme involves a central support of ₹54,082 crore.

The Green Energy Corridor phase III scheme, the latest such government initiative, will run until FY33 and has a massive increase in the project outlay. The first such corridor scheme had an outlay of about ₹10,141 crore. The second had Rs 20,774 crore outlay.

"The Cabinet decision on the Green Energy Corridor Phase-III will ensure 135 GW renewable energy evacuation, 50 GWh battery storage, stronger power grids across states... Big push towards 900 GW non-fossil capacity by 2035," Prime Minister Narendra Modi wrote on X.

Tariff-based Bidding >> 4

BLOODSHED AT 34,000 FEET

Indian Pilot Braves Stabbing to Help Dubai Flight Land Safely

Netanyahu says Flydubai incident an attempt to hijack

Arindam Majumder

New Delhi: An Indian pilot is said to have played a key role in thwarting what the Israeli government has described as the attempted hijacking of a Flydubai aircraft flying from Dubai to Tel Aviv on Wednesday, after his co-pilot allegedly attacked him in the cockpit and attempted to take control of the aircraft.

Smit Machchhar, an Indian national and former SpiceJet pilot, was the pilot in command of flight FZ1073, according to people aware of the matter.

Machchhar, who hails from Mumbai, joined Flydubai in June 2022 as a direct-entry captain after spending more than 11 years with SpiceJet, as per his profile.

ET broke the news online on Wednesday evening.

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu has said the co-pilot tried to crash the plane after stabbing the captain. Machchhar managed to unlock the cockpit door, which allowed in passengers, who overpowered the co-pilot. A second set of pilots travelling aboard then helped secure the cockpit and land the plane in Saudi Arabia.

First Officer Arrested >> 4

How Events Unfolded



EXPECTED IN FIRST HALF OF 2027

Obesity Drug Battle Shifts to Pills as Lilly, Novo Eye India Entry

Pricing and efficacy will determine how far oral GLP-1s can expand the market

Rica Bhattacharyya

Mumbai: India's obesity drug market is gearing up for its next big fight—this time over a pill, not a jab.

Danish drugmaker Novo Nordisk's oral Wegovy (semaglutide) and US pharma major Eli Lilly's oral GLP-1 orforglipron are expected to enter India in the first half of 2027, according to industry sources familiar with the regulatory process. Both companies have already submitted their oral products to Indian regulators, said top officials.

Novo CEO Mike Doustdar recently said oral drugs could account for as much as half the global obesity drug market by 2030. The company is placing significant bets on a future dominated by pills.

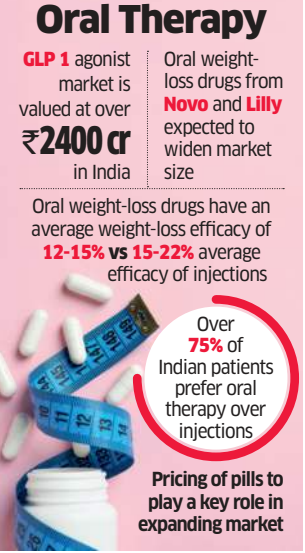
"When you come across a pill that is almost as efficacious as injectables, then why not?" said one of the people cited.

Another said, "Orforglipron is expected by January-February, followed by oral Wegovy."

One in three US obesity prescriptions are already oral, an industry executive said. Novo and Lilly launched oral weight loss drugs in the US earlier this year.

"Two out of three prescriptions are still of Novo in the US, though Lilly is narrowing the gap," the person said.

Oral weight loss drugs have an average weight-loss efficacy of 12-15%, meaning those who take them are able to shed that proportion of weight over a



specified treatment period. This compares with 15-22% for injectables.

Novo, which is aggressively expanding in the oral obesity drug market, struck a deal on Tuesday with China's Hengrui Pharma for HRS-1596, a potential once-weekly oral GLP-1/GIP dual agonist that targets the same hormone pathways as Lilly's tirzepatide (Mounjaro). Semaglutide is a single-action (GLP-1) drug.

Doctors said oral GLP-1s will generate two possible pools of demand: needle-phobic patients who have avoided injections so far and existing users who may want to shift from weekly jabs to oral treatment for longer-term weight maintenance.

'Game Changing Therapy' >> 4

AS RAINS FALTER

Duty on Pulse Imports may be Cut



The government is considering reducing import duties on chana and yellow peas as deficient and erratic monsoon rainfall threatens pulse yields and prices rise ahead of the festive season. The proposed cuts aim to improve domestic availability and contain prices. >> 13

AI-powered Cheating on Job Conversations on the Rise

Recruiters find it tough to counter tech-led cheating on hiring assessments; 45% of assessments flagged, shows HirePro report

Sreeradha Basu

Bengaluru: Cheating during hiring assessments and interviews is surging as applicants increasingly use artificial intelligence (AI) to manipulate the recruitment process, prompting employers to devise new strategies to counter the malpractice. With 45% of assessments flagged for cheating in FY26, up from 32.4% in FY22, according to a report by recruitment automation and talent assessment platform HirePro, close to one in two assessments now carry an integrity risk.

AI-assisted cheating emerged as the fastest-growing form of malpractice, up 50% on-year in FY26, as candidates increasingly used AI

prompts to generate responses in real time, said the report, based on about one million assessments and 100,000 interviews. It also drew on expert insights and secondary research. "Early-stage screening

moved away from using assessments simply to filter out applicants, during campus recruiting

THEY'RE DEEPPAKING IT

Video/screen manipulation nearly doubled to 9% in FY26 from FY23

is the most compromised, weakening overall talent quality before interview filters are applied," said S Pasupathi, chief operating officer, HirePro.

Over time, companies have



for instance, and adopted them as core selection criteria, prompting more specialised assessments. "The challenge has transitioned into a technology arms race, requiring continuous innovation in detection, verification and monitoring mechanisms," Pasupathi said.

Traditional external assistance and identity fraud remain the biggest category, but their share is falling as technology-enabled methods gain ground, as per the HirePro report. Device-based cheating has declined and stabilised, as the use of browser extensions and secondary devices such as mobiles and external screens remains

prevalent. Video and screen manipulation nearly doubled to 9% in FY26 from FY23, with deepfakes being used to impersonate candidates during assessments.

Cheating has evolved from traditional methods, such as unauthorised notes, device usage and proxy test-takers, to AI-generated answers and deepfakes, said Amit Rahane, partner at EY Forensic and Integrity Services. "The issue is particularly pronounced in mass recruitment and at entry levels, with the proliferation of such methods increasing significantly in recent years," he said.

The issue extends beyond assessments and is now impacting the interview process.

Detecting Hiring Fraud >> 10

AS INDIA AWAITS DECISION ON SANCTIONING RUSSIA AND IRAN ACT, IMPENDING TRADE DEAL

MODI, TRUMP REVIEW TIES



PRIME MINISTER ON INDIA-US TIES
We reviewed our bilateral cooperation in trade, defence, energy, critical technologies and other areas: PM on X

Our Political Bureau

New Delhi: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Wednesday held a telephone conversation with US President Donald Trump and reviewed progress in bilateral ties. They reaffirmed their commitment to advancing the India-US Comprehensive Global Strategic Partnership and agreed to maintain close engagement to deepen cooperation, according to an official readout. The leaders also exchanged views on regional and international developments and discussed ongoing efforts

to promote global peace and security. Following the conversation, Modi wrote on X: "Had a productive conversation with President Trump. We reviewed our bilateral cooperation in trade, defence, energy, critical technologies and other areas..."

TELEPHONE CONVERSATION

Modi is scheduled to visit the US in December for the G20 summit. The call comes in the backdrop of Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act threatening 100% tariffs against India for purchasing Russian oil and impending trade deal. A trade deal announcement can come by this year if the US 301 process concludes, source said.



PEACE AND SECURITY IN FOCUS
Leaders exchanged views on regional & int'l developments; discussed efforts to promote global peace and security

PHOTOS: GETTY IMAGES

AGAINST CEC GYANESH KUMAR, SIR AND 'VOTE THEFT'

INDIA Bloc to Hold MPs' March to ECI, 5 Rallies & Dist-Level Protests

CPI pitch for canvassing broader support for motion for removal of CEC finds no takers

Our Political Bureau

New Delhi: Nineteen INDIA bloc parties on Wednesday announced their joint campaign and protest plans against chief election commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, the conduct of the special intensive revision of electoral rolls, alleged electoral irregularities, and accused the Modi government of reducing ECI brass into its 'puppets'. The joint plans announced by Congress chief Mallikarjun Kharge after the meeting are: District-level 'save democracy' marches from October 2 to October 8, Opposition MPs' march to ECI headquarters on October 6, five INDIA bloc rallies against 'vote theft' from November 1 in New Delhi, seeking appointment with the President of India and making an appeal to the Supreme Court to expedite SIR cases.

It is learnt that when CPI representative P Sandosh Kumar broached the idea of seeking broader support from non-INDIA Opposition parties for moving another INDIA bloc notice for bringing a motion for the removal of CEC in Parliament, there were no backers, with some like Kapil Sibal and KC Venugopal pointing out that it was a "failed experiment" in the past, thus signalling a rethink on the plan. The declared action plan notably didn't include main demands the Congress Working Committee had made a day earlier for its own agitation such as suspension of SIR, resignation of the PM and HM along with CEC, besides Kharge's pitch for doing away with EVMs. Many at the INDIA bloc meeting were learnt to have suggested involving non-INDIA bloc Op-



INDIA BLOC CRUMBLING: UNION MINISTER

It's Save Dynasty Rally: Shivraj

Our Political Bureau

New Delhi: BJP on Wednesday hit back at the INDIA bloc's decision to launch a week-long 'Save Democracy' campaign over SIR, accusing the Opposition alliance of lacking a common agenda and questioning its ability to stay united.

Union minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan dubbed the proposed October 2-8 campaign a 'Save Dynasty' march, alleging that the Opposition was attacking constitutional institutions instead of introspecting on its electoral setbacks.



"Zero vision, 100% frustration and an advance excuse for poll defeats" was the outcome of the INDIA bloc meeting, Chouhan said at a press conference at the BJP headquarters.

BATTING FOR CJP

Some favour involving CJP in protests

position parties, NGOs and youth outfits even as some, including Uddhav Thackeray, talked about SS-UBT and NCP-SP planning joint programmes and his party's decision to back CJP agitation for CEC's ouster. Congress leaders kept mum on CJP. Some allies stressed on coordinated agitations and cautioned against solo shows.

"In reality, two or three individuals within the Election Commission are merely pawns, while Amit Shah and Modi are manipulating them like puppets... All the parties spoke about fighting this battle unitedly," said Kharge at the post-meeting press conference.

Rahul Gandhi said, "There was a feeling in the room that the Opposition has been quite successful in putting across to the people that the elections are stolen, that Narendra Modi and Amit Shah have destroyed democracy and there is a new sense of resistance, particularly among young people, that what is going on in India is wrong and needs to be stopped. I want to tell all the Opposition leaders that they are the collective defenders of the Indian Constitution, and it is an honour for us to work together."

Mamata Banerjee, who used to act pricey at many INDIA bloc meetings while she was ruling West Bengal, was once again in her post-defeat wounded and eager-to-accommodate self at the meeting and at the presser.

OFFICER ORDERED TO EXPLAIN DISCREPANCY

SC Raps UP Police for FIR Against 'Unknown' Rider

Asks why the suspect, who was apprehended on spot, was not named

Raghav Ohri

New Delhi: The Supreme Court on Wednesday pulled up the Uttar Pradesh Police for alleged irregularities in the investigation of a criminal case, questioning how an FIR could have been registered against an "unknown" motorcycle rider, when the complainant had allegedly apprehended him on the spot and handed him over to police.

A bench of justices Sanjay Kumar and Sanjeev Sachdeva strongly disapproved of the investigation and questioned the credibility of the police action. "FIR was registered against unknown persons? Why did you write unknown if the person was caught on the spot? Why did you register FIR against an unknown motorcycle rider if he was caught on the spot? How will people trust the police?" the bench said.

The matter came before the court on a plea by the complainant, who appeared in person and alleged that the preliminary investigation was biased from the outset. According to her, she had caught the motorcycle rider involved in the incident and handed him over to the police. Despite this, FIR was registered against unknown persons, with the accused column left blank.

The complainant further pointed out that after the high court sought a status report, the rider's name was subsequently included in the charge sheet before he was later given a clean chit.

She also questioned the status of the motorcycle, alleging that it had been seized without a number plate but was subsequently shown as bearing a registration number during the probe. "Toeing the line is one thing but bending over backwards... And this kind of cover up job? Less said the better," SC said.

The observations came during the hearing of a long-running litigation concerning restrictions on

CPCB REPORT ON BARIUM CRACKERS AWAITED

Blanket Firecracker Ban, 24-hr Bursting on Diwali Ruled Out

'Complete prohibition may affect festive spirit while unrestricted use may impact children, elderly, sick and environment'

Raghav Ohri

New Delhi: The Supreme Court on Wednesday indicated that it would adopt a balanced approach to firecracker use during Diwali, ruling out both a total ban and unrestricted bursting throughout the day.

A bench of justices MM Sundresh and PB Varale said while a total ban could affect the sentiments associated with the festival, permitting firecrackers for 24 hours would have a serious impact on environment and vulnerable sections, including children, elderly persons and the sick.

"We will make it very clear: Neither we are going to agree with you for total ban. Nor are we going to allow them to do it for 24 hours," the bench observed. The court said a solution would have to be found by specifying a time window during which permissible firecrackers could be burst.

The observations came during the hearing of a long-running litigation concerning restrictions on

the manufacture, sale and use of firecrackers, particularly in Delhi, NCR and other northern parts of the country where air pollution assumes alarming proportions during the winter.

The bench indicated that it would determine which categories of firecrackers could be permitted after considering a report from the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB).

CPCB has been examining issues concerning barium-based firecrackers and the possibility of permitting specified categories subject to emission, noise and safety requirements. Further testing, including outdoor testing, is yet to be completed. The bench granted time for the CPCB report to be placed before it and indicated that the findings would be considered before determining the permissible categories of crackers.

'WE MIGHT AS WELL DISBAND UP POLICE'

'It is better if we ask CBI to step in all UP Police investigations. We might as well disband the UP Police. This nonsense has to stop at some point'

RECENTLY, A SPECIFIC PLAN FOR HIS NEUTRALISATION WAS PUT IN PLACE

Musa's Killing 'Serious Blow to LeT Ecosystem in J&K'

Group of 4 senior LeT commanders operating in UT since 2022 stands neutralised: Statement

Hakeem Irfan Rashid & Rahul Tripathi

Srinagar | New Delhi: Security forces on Tuesday killed a top Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT) commander Musa, alias Asif Fauji, at Budgam's Gurwatkalan. Musa, who hailed from Pakistan, was active in J&K for over five years now. According to officials, the security forces were pursuing Musa for a long time. Recently, a specific plan for his neutralisation was put in place after receiving technical and human intel about his movement and presence, according to an official statement.

"Neutralization of Musa by security forces is a serious blow to the LeT ecosystem in J&K. With Musa's killing, the entire group of four senior LeT commanders operating in the UT since 2022, and responsible for sensational attacks, like Halan attack (August 2023), DKG attack (December 2023), Kandi attack (May 2023), Shahsitar attack (May 2024), Shiv Khori attack (June 2024), Gagangir attack (October 2024), Bootapathri attack (Octo-



INVOLVED IN SEVERAL ATTACKS
3 other members of group were neutralised in separate encounters

Security tightened in J&K's Budgam on Wednesday - ANI Video Grab

ber 2024) and Baisaran attack (April 2025), stands neutralised," according to an official statement.

The three other members of the group were neutralized in separate encounters: Junaid Bhat (December 3, 2024, Dachigam), Suleman (July 28, 2025, Operation Mahadev), and Yasir (September 4, 2026, Operation Asdhar). The current encounter to neutralise Musa was part of an ongoing long-sustained operation, the statement noted.

"As per our informa-

tion he crossed the border in 2020-21 and came on radar around 2023 when his name surfaced in some attacks. He was involved in several attacks in Rajouri-Poonch belt on the other side of Pirpanjal mountain and in the upper reaches of Budgam area and Gulmarg in Kashmir on this side of the same range," a senior Army official said.

Officials said he was also involved in three major incidents in 2024 - an ambush of an IAF convoy in Poonch district, an attack on construction workers near Sonamarg and an attack on the Army in Bota Pathri in Gulmarg area. Earlier on September 17, two Pakistani infiltrators of Jaish-e-Mohammad were killed in a remote high-altitude area of Udhampur district.

TIME TO LEARN

Wangchuk Meets Zoramthanga, Expresses Wish to Study Mizo Accord

Mizo Peace Accord brought lasting peace in Mizoram

Bikash Singh

Guwahati: Environmentalist Sonam Wangchuk met former Mizoram CM Zoramthanga and expressed his desire to study the Mizo Peace Accord which had brought lasting peace in Mizoram.

Mizoram is now one of the most peaceful states after the signing of the accord. The Memorandum of Settlement in 1986, which ended two decades of strife and insurgency, resulted in Mizoram becoming the 23rd state of India on February 20, 1987. "I want to study the successful Memorandum of Settlement of Mizoram and understand more about the experiences of Zoramthanga, who played a key role in the Mizo Peace Accord," Wangchuk was quoted as saying in a release.

Zoramthanga told Wangchuk that the accord has attracted interest from those seeking to study conflict resolution.

Poliloquy R PRASAD

NCERT book describes 1000 to 1700 AD as period of 'Resistance and Resilience'.



Shall the children be taught that salvation came to India in 1757, wearing a red coat?

Calcutta High Court granted him interim bail in all 6 cases under Nandigram & Khejuri police stations

Asked to furnish a ₹ 20,000 bail bond

HC observed that he was taken into custody only after filing his nomination papers and that the cases against him were related to the 2007 Nandigram agitation

Solicitor general Tushar Mehta, appearing for Bengal, sought urgent listing of the challenge

Says Pradhan is facing a case under section 302 of Indian Penal Code

He has been granted bail for election. Can I take a chance tomorrow? That's all I'm saying: MEHTA

WAS TAKEN AWAY BY COPS FROM A HOTEL TO MANDARMANI IN FILMY STYLE: PRADHAN

Nandigram Cong Candidate Released, Starts Campaign

Nandigram will give a befitting reply: Pradhan

Jayatri Nag

Kolkata: Nandigram Congress candidate Milan Pradhan was released from judicial custody on Wednesday after the Calcutta High Court granted him interim bail on Tuesday. Pradhan, who was arrested on September 18 in relation to six criminal cases lodged in 2007, had spent 12 days in jail.

"I will start campaigning immediately," Pradhan said. "People of Nandigram will give a befitting reply. I was taken away by the police from a hotel to Mandarmani in filmy style," Pradhan said.

The Calcutta High Court had earlier granted him interim bail in all the six cases under Nandigram and Khejuri police stations. He was asked to furnish a ₹20,000 bail bond. The court observed that he was taken into custody only after filing his nomination papers and that the cases against him were related to the 2007 Nandigram agitation.

Campaigning for the bypoll ends on October 4 while counting of votes will be held on October 9.

STATE'S REQUEST FOR URGENT HEARING DECLINED

West Bengal Appeal Against Pradhan will be Dismissed, Indicates Supreme Court

Our Political Bureau

New Delhi: The Supreme Court on Wednesday indicated that it would dismiss the West Bengal government's challenge to the Calcutta High Court order granting interim bail to Congress' Nandigram candidate Milan Pradhan.

A three-member bench of CJI Surya Kant and justices Joymaya Bagchi and V Mohana declined the state's request for an urgent hearing on Thursday, saying the court's board was already lengthy. "We will surely dismiss this, but we will dismiss it on Monday, not tomorrow," CJI Kant verbally remarked.

Solicitor general Tushar Mehta, appearing for West Bengal, sought urgent listing of the challenge, pointing out that Pradhan was facing a case under section 302 of the Indian Penal Code. "He is in a section 302 case

(murder). He has been granted bail for election. Can I take a chance tomorrow? That's all I'm saying," Mehta said. The bench, however, declined to advance the matter. "No. Monday," CJI said when the request for listing on Thursday was repeated.

We will surely dismiss this, but we will dismiss it on Monday, not tomorrow

SURYA KANT
Chief Justice of India

The state's challenge arises from the high court's September 29 order granting Pradhan interim bail in six criminal cases arising from violence during the 2007 Nandigram land acquisition protests. HC has permitted Pradhan to contest the October 6 assembly bypoll.



A NEW CHAPTER IN MAHARASHTRA'S GROWTH STORY BEGINS

Introducing Maharashtra's dedicated
investment promotion and facilitation agency

INVEST MAHARASHTRA MADE FOR BUSINESS



FINANCIAL
CAPITAL



INDUSTRIAL
POWERHOUSE



WORLD-CLASS
INFRASTRUCTURE



GLOBAL
CONNECTIVITY



SUSTAINABLE
GROWTH



USD 660 Bn
India's largest economy



31% FDI
Largest FDI destination
in the country (Over the last decade)



Ranked #1
in Export Preparedness Index
(2024)



12 Mn MSMEs
India's largest MSME ecosystem

BUILD IN INDIA'S GROWTH ENGINE

A NEW GATEWAY TO OPPORTUNITY UNVEILS

ON 1ST OCTOBER 2026



Maharashtra
India's Economic Engine



MARK THE DATE
1ST OCTOBER 2026

TIME
19:30 HRS

VENUE
**JASMINE 2, JIO WORLD CONVENTION
CENTRE, BKC, MUMBAI**

ENTRY BY
INVITATION ONLY

10 RS Seats in UP: New Players, New Equations

BJP’S PROBABLE LIST HAS 2 NATIONAL GENERAL SECYS & EX-UNION MINISTER

SP’s Surprise Nathwani Choice Puts Spotlight on BJP’s RS Picks

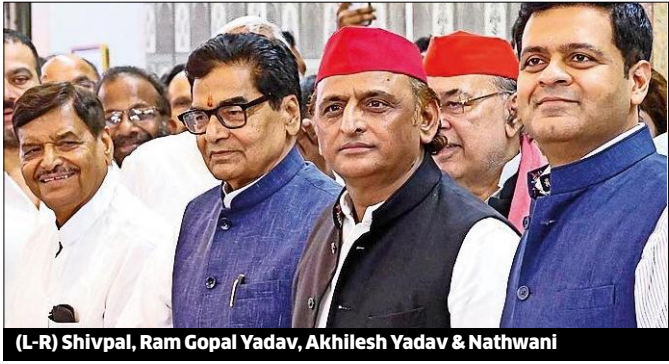
Jatin Takkar

New Delhi: The filing of Rajya Sabha nominations by Samajwadi Party general secretary Ram Gopal Yadav and surprise candidate Dhanraj Parimal Nathwani on Wednesday, in the presence of party chief Akhilesh Yadav, has shifted the focus to the BJP’s choices for the Upper House from Uttar Pradesh, as the party seeks to balance electoral, caste and regional equations ahead of the 2027 Assembly polls.

Elections to 10 Rajya Sabha seats from Uttar Pradesh will be held on October 16. **With the current Assembly arithmetic, 37 MLAs are required to elect one candidate. The BJP-led alliance is in a position to win eight seats, while the SP can comfortably secure the remaining two.**

The BJP’s selection assumes significance as it has to fill eight berths, including those of outgoing Union ministers Hardeep Singh Puri and BL Verma. The party is considering a mix of fresh faces and those seeking another term, with the probable list reflecting caste and regional representation from across UP.

The party’s probable list also includes two national general secretaries and a former Union minister, all three of whom lost the 2024 Lok Sabha election from Uttar Pradesh. Their possible return to Parliament through the



(L-R) Shivpal, Ram Gopal Yadav, Akhilesh Yadav & Nathwani

BJP BACKING FOR FATHER

Parimal Nathwani, Dhanraj’s father, is serving his fourth RS term from Jharkhand as a BJP-backed Independent

Rajya Sabha comes amid a wider BJP exercise to accommodate organisational leaders and electoral considerations.

For the SP, Ram Gopal’s nomination was largely expected. A founding member of the party, he has been in the RS since 2004 and stood by Akhilesh during the family feud with his uncle Shivpal Yadav. **Nathwani, however, is the**

surprise pick. A senior Reliance Group executive, he is also associated with cricket and temple administration in Gujarat.

His nomination adds a corporate face to the SP’s Rajya Sabha contingent, a party leader said, adding that earlier Anil Ambani has represented SP in the Upper House.

His candidature also carries a distinct cross-party dimension. His father, Parimal Nathwani, now in his fourth Rajya Sabha term from Jharkhand as an Independent backed by BJP and got elected by cross voting from JMM-led ruling coalition.

The father-son political journey across different sides of the political spectrum make the SP’s choice particularly notable as the BJP finalises its own slate for the crucial Upper House contest.

FATHER & SON: FROM RELIANCE TO RAJYA SABHA

Nathwanis: Political Journeys Not Limited by Party Loyalties

Kumar Anshuman

New Delhi: Dhanraj Nathwani, son of Rajya Sabha MP Parimal Nathwani, being named the Samajwadi Party’s RS candidate has surprised political circles, with various calculations being made ahead of the UP Assembly polls. The development comes three months after his father won a Rajya Sabha seat from Jharkhand with support from the NDA and some INDIA alliance legislators. Over his 18-year career as a MP, Parimal Nathwani has repeatedly managed to garner support from both ruling and opposition parties.

Born and brought up in Mumbai, Nathwani initially ran a soap factory and a cold drink distribution business, but shut them down following disputes with partners. He then moved to Vadodara, where he joined the stock exchange and also ran 20 STD/ISD PCOs, including one at the exchange. **The Harshad Mehta scam caused him heavy losses. It was then that Dhirubhai Ambani’s office approached him to purchase land from farmers for Reliance’s refinery project.**

Despite having no prior experience, Nathwani built trust with farmers and successfully closed the deals. He was later entrusted with buying flats for Jamnagar refinery employees, further strengthening his association with Reliance.

Over the years, Nathwani built close ties with politicians across parties and became known as someone who

could get things moving.

His entry into Parliament was also a surprise to many. In 2008, he filed his nomination for the Rajya Sabha from Jharkhand, where Madhu Koda was then the chief minister, heading an independent government backed by the Congress and JMM. Rivalry within the UPA led to three nominations — RK Anand, backed by the Congress and RJD; Kishori Lal, backed by the JMM; and independence votes. Nathwani secured five second-preference votes from Babul Marandi’s Jharkhand Vikas Morcha and was declared the winner.

Leaders from Jharkhand told ET that Nathwani took his Rajya Sabha role seriously and was the first MP to set up an office in Ranchi.

In 2014, he was re-elected as an independent with support from the BJP and its allies.

Nathwani was vice-president of the Gujarat Cricket Association, with Amit Shah as president. In 2019, Hemant Soren’s JMM government came to power in Jharkhand, making Nathwani’s re-election appear difficult. **On February 29, 2020, Reliance chairman Mukesh Ambani travelled to Amravati to meet Andhra Pradesh CM Jagan Mohan Reddy. A week later, Nathwani was announced as the YSR Congress’ Rajya Sabha candidate and was subsequently elected from AP.**

During the passage of the Waqf Bill in 2025, he defied the party whip and voted in favour of the bill. The party took no action against him.

In June this year, Nathwani once again returned to Jharkhand as an independent candidate backed by NDA. He defeated Congress candidate Pranav Jha by getting votes from the ruling alliance.

He is being termed as everyone’s friend and no one’s foe by politicians across the party line.

Over the past few years, his son Dhanraj (40) has been active in power circles.

ACROSS PARTY LINES

Nathwanis seen by politicians across party lines as everyone’s friend, no one’s foe

Sena (UBT) Leader Shot, Party Blames Shinde Camp



Sena (UBT) supporters gather around Purnekar’s body in Thane – PTI

Krishna Kumar

Mumbai: Pradeep Purnekar, a Vibhag Pramukh (divisional head) of the Uddhav Balasaheb Thackeray Sena, was shot dead by masked assailants on Tuesday. The shooting has led to Sena (UBT) accusing the Shiv Sena (Shinde) of being involved in the political assassination. Purnekar’s family has accused former Thane mayor Meenakshi Shinde and her husband Rajendra Shinde from the Shinde faction of orchestrating the killing.

Purnekar was at his office on Tuesday when around 9 pm masked assailants came in two-wheelers and shot him twice and escaped.

He was rushed to hospital where he died while being treated. His family and supporters have demanded Meenakshi Shinde’s arrest.

Sena (UBT) has said that law and order in the state had collapsed. “Purnekar had lost polls by a few votes. He had a conflict with Shinde and was opposing drug running so he has been killed,” said Sanjay Raut.

While the police have arrested a few suspects, Purnekar’s killing is the latest in a long line of leaders being killed in the state over the past 10 years.

In October 12, 2024, former Maharashtra minister Baba Siddique was shot dead by a group of assailants. Police claimed the killers were linked to the Lawrence Bishnoi gang who killed him due to his proximity to actor Salman Khan.

Earlier, in the same year, Abhishek Ghosalkar, a former Shiv Sena (UBT) corporator was fatally shot inside his office by a local resident who then shot himself. In 2024 itself, Vanraj Andekar, a politician-cum-gangster, was killed allegedly at the behest of his own relatives in Pune. In the same year, Mahesh Gaikwad, a Sena (Shinde) leader, was shot inside a police station in Ulhasnagar. The shooter was BJP MLA Ganpat Gaikwad. Mahesh survived the attack.

In 2024 again a sarpanch, Santosh Deshmukh, was abducted and tortured for hours and brutally killed.

UNION HOME MINISTER PUTS DRUGS AT CENTRE OF BJP’S PUNJAB POLL PITCH

Shah Pledges to End Drug Menace in Punjab by 2029

No word on contesting all 117 assembly seats; no attack on ex-ally Shiromani Akali Dal

Jatin Takkar

New Delhi: Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Wednesday put drugs at the centre of BJP’s 2027 Punjab poll pitch, making ‘Nasha Mukht Punjab’ the party’s core elec-

toral plank. He however did not announce whether the party will contest on all the 117 assembly seats. He also did not attack the party’s ex-ally Shiromani Akali Dal.

Addressing the concluding rally of the BJP’s ‘Nasha Mukht Punjab Yatra’ in Jalandhar, Shah accused the AAP government of allowing the synthetic drug trade to flourish openly and promised to rid Punjab of “chhitta” by December 31, 2029, if voters backed the BJP.

“Can AAP make Punjab drugs-free? Only the BJP can make Punjab drugs-free,” Shah said.

Shah said Punjab had several



Shah offering prayers at Tripurmalini Dham in Jalandhar

MARK ON MANN

Someone who gets intoxicated and insults the Gurus cannot free Punjab from the scourge of drugs: Shah

electoral issues, including farmers’ concerns, industry, law and order and women’s safety, but ‘a

drug-free Punjab’ remained the party’s central campaign.

The Nasha Mukht Punjab Yatra, which began on September 18, covered nearly 4,000 km and passed through all 117 assembly constituencies over 13 days before culminating in Jalandhar. BJP national president Nitin Nabin had flagged off the first of the four statewide anti-drug yatras from Pathankot.

Taking a swipe at the AAP government without naming Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann, Shah said, “Someone who gets intoxicated and insults the Gurus cannot free Punjab from the scourge of drugs.”

Tariff-based Competitive Bidding

►► From Page 1

Under this programme, renewable energy developers will also get support for setting up battery energy storage projects of 50 GWh capacity. For this, the scheme has earmarked Rs 6,000 crore through viability gap funding from the total central financial assistance.

The scheme envisages total investments of Rs1.36 lakh crore for the development of intra-state transmission systems and Rs 50,000 crore for 50 GWh of battery energy storage projects.

Information and broadcasting minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said new transmission lines would be awarded through tariff-based competitive bidding, with transmission service providers building, owning, operating and maintaining the assets.

Managing the high variations in renewable energy, like solar and wind, is a “major challenge,” he said after the Cabinet meeting. “The grid has to be designed to take the load of that variation,” he said.

The scheme has a component of local value addition for battery energy storage projects. For this, the government will hold technical consultations on the percentage of localisation of components, renewable energy secretary Santosh Kumar Sarangi said.

The scheme will enable evacuation of up to 135 GW of renewable energy across states and union territories, the government said.

The battery storage projects can be deployed at the generation site or any other location for grid flexibility to address intermittency, congestion, peak-hour curtailment and meet non-solar hour demand, the government said.

So far 13 states have submitted proposals for the third phase of the green energy corridor, Sarangi said.

The proposals of two more states — Bihar and Mizoram — are being evaluated, he said.

A government statement said broadband upgrade and network strengthening works will be executed under a cost-plus basis with the state transmission utilities as the implementing agency.

Financial assistance will be released against achieved project milestones with the projects being monitored by a dedicated unit with an online dashboard that tracks physical and financial progress. A steering committee chaired by the cabinet secretary will review the scheme half yearly.



Managing the high variations in renewable energy, like solar and wind, is a “major challenge”: Vaishnaw

Govt Raises MSP for Six Rabi Crops

The government on Wednesday approved higher minimum support prices (MSPs) for six rabi crops for the 2027-28 season, with wheat receiving the smallest increase of ₹25 per quintal, while safflower saw the highest hike of ₹675 per quintal. The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs raised the MSP for wheat to ₹2,610 per quintal from ₹2,585 in the previous season. The revision comes ahead of the winter sowing season, as the government seeks to encourage farmers to diversify towards pulses and oilseeds, it said in a statement. Among oilseeds, the MSP for safflower was increased by ₹675 to ₹7,215 per quintal, while rapeseed and mustard received a hike of ₹413 to ₹6,613 per quintal. For pulses, the MSP for masur was raised by ₹390 to ₹7,390 per quintal, while gram (chana) received an increase of ₹83 to ₹5,958 per quintal.

Delhi to Get ₹1,790 cr AI-powered Traffic Management System

The Union Cabinet approved an intelligent traffic management system for the national capital.

An official statement said the Rs1,789.52 crore outfit will deploy artificial intelligence-enabled adaptive traffic signals, technology-based enforcement and real-time traffic information to make travel safer, smoother and more efficient. The

system will facilitate priority movement of ambulances and quicker response to congestion and road incidents.

The project will cover 42 identified traffic corridors and will be implemented in three phases over 24 months, followed by five years of operation and maintenance.

Delhi has around 7.1 million active registered vehicles. Vehicular growth has

substantially outpaced expansion of road infrastructure, while traffic regulation continues to depend significantly on fixed signal timings and manual intervention. The ITMS seeks to make better use of the available road capacity by enabling traffic management to respond dynamically to actual conditions on the road, the statement added.

Game Changing Therapy

►► From Page 1

“Novo is really going after these pills now,” said a top executive.

“Though this pill from Hengrui is still in Phase I and may take 5-7 years, what is important is that it is a once weekly oral GLP1-GIP molecule,” said leading diabetologist Rajiv Kovil.

Oral GLP-1s will be a “game changer” for India’s obesity drug market, said Vyankatesh Shivane, senior endocrinologist at Mumbai’s Jaslok Hospital.

Many patients are already using synthetic (generic) semaglutide from Indian companies and new oral GLP-1s from innovators can make treatment easier. Oral therapy can also be useful for people who have already lost weight on injections and want to maintain their levels, he said.

“There are at least 15-20% of pa-



tients who do not take the injectable because of the fear,” Kovil said. “Pills could also widen the prescribing base as they may be easier for general physicians and other doctors to prescribe than injectables.”

Some patients who have reached their weight targets after one-and-a-half to two years of treatment are reluctant to remain on weekly injections indefinitely, Kovil said. He expects some of them could shift to oral therapy for staying lighter.

“It can always be that you inject to lose and you use a pill to maintain,” he said.

Neeraj Tulara, a Mumbai-based diabetologist and general medicine expert, is of the view that oral GLP-1s may improve initial acceptance but convenience alone may not solve the bigger problem of long-term adherence. “Pricing will be an important factor,” he said.

First Officer Arrested

►► From Page 1

Flydubai said in a statement that there was an altercation in the cockpit but said the motive was still unknown and subject to investigation. The first officer has been arrested, Netanyahu said. Machchhar’s former colleagues described him as a pilot who followed the rule book religiously. His brother is also a commercial pilot and has previously flown for Akasa Air, they said.

In a podcast interview, Machchhar had spoken about his passion for flying Boeing aircraft, describing it as a dream. He also spoke about the enormous responsibility that comes with being in command of an aircraft and the need for pilots to remain conscious of the lives entrusted to them.

That responsibility was put to an extraordinary test on Wednesday.

The Boeing 737 MAX 8 was carrying around 174 passengers, most of them Israelis, when the incident unfolded while the aircraft was flying toward Tel Aviv. According to Reuters, the two pilots became involved in a physical altercation.

Sports World Play



Compound men’s team
From left: Kushal Dalal, Sahil Jadhav and Ganesh Mani Ratnam Thirumuru

Compound mixed team
Sahil Jadhav and Chikitha Taniparthi

Compound women’s team
From right: Jyothi Vennam, Chikitha Taniparthi and Prithika Pradeep

Gold-Trick

ASIAN GAMES India sweep all three compound team titles, with Chikitha-Sahil securing an Olympic quota

Philem Dipak Singh

India swept all three compound archery team gold medals at the Asian Games on Wednesday, defending their men’s, women’s and mixed team titles, with Chikitha Taniparthi and Sahil Jadhav also securing an Olympic quota place.

Their victory made India the first country to secure a quota place in the compound mixed team event, which will make its Olympic debut at the 2028 Los Angeles Games.

The women’s trio of Jyothi Surekha Vennam, Chikitha and Prithika Pradeep began India’s sweep by beating China’s Wu Yanyan, Yue Wang and Pangyao Wei 238-234 in the final.

India led 60-58 after the opening end and maintained their advantage before closing with a perfect 60 to retain the title and equal the world record set by South Korea at the 2014 Incheon Games.

“We pushed each other and kept telling each other that we have to give our best. Even if we had one bad shot, a nine score, we kept bucking each other up,” Prithika said.

The gold came after Jyothi,

who was also part of India’s title-winning team in Hangzhou, lost her individual crown in the pre-quarterfinals to 14-year-old South Korean Kang Yeon-seo.

The men’s team of Kushal Dalal, Sahil Jadhav and Ganesh Mani Ratnam Thirumuru completed the sweep by edging China’s Jiahao Liao, Jinyi Liu and Jingyu Shi 238-237.

For Chikitha and Sahil, it was their second gold of the day after they beat South Korea’s Jungyoon Park and Choi Eun Gyu in the mixed team final.

India led from the start, taking a 40-39 advantage after the first end and extending it to two points in the second.

A nine from Chikitha reduced the lead to one point, leaving India ahead 118-117 after the third end.

South Korea then produced a perfect score, forcing India to find two 10s with their final two shots to level the contest.

Chikitha shot a nine but Sahil responded with a 10 to level the scores and force a shoot-off.

Both Indians then shot 10s in the shoot-off, while Choi managed a nine to give India the gold.

“This is my first Asian Games and I won mixed and team medals. I could not have asked for more,” Chikitha said. “I did not have much time after the women’s team gold. I was in a rush and we just got time to sit there and prepare ourselves.”

Sahil said the pair had remained confident throughout the team events. “We were so confident when we were playing. I have trust in my teammates, they have trust in me. We’ll shoot our best in any condition.”

India won five archery gold at the previous Asian Games in Hangzhou, including the compound mixed team title. **PTI**

OTHER HIGHLIGHTS

Boxing Women’s 60kg Priya loses in semifinals, takes **Bronze**; Men’s 90kg Kapil Pokharia loses in semifinal, gets **Bronze**; Women’s 75kg Lovlina Borgohain enters final

Wrestling Greco-Roman men’s 87kg Sunil Kumar wins **Bronze**

Squash Women’s Team India beat Singapore 2-0 in quarterfinal, confirm medal; Men’s Team India beat Kuwait 2-0 in quarterfinal, confirm medal

Hockey Women’s Team India beat South Korea, enter final

MEDALS TALLY

#	COUNTRY	G	S	B	T
1.	China	150	66	59	275
2.	Japan	49	76	73	199
3.	South Korea	24	30	48	102
4.	Uzbekistan	16	19	19	54
5.	Thailand	12	10	12	34
8.	India	10	21	29	60

LIVE on Sony Sports Network

Neeru-Kynan Team Up to Trap Gold

Nagoya: Neeru Dhandha combined with Kynan Chenai to win the mixed team trap gold at the Asian Games on Wednesday, adding to her individual title and making her the most decorated Indian athlete at the Games.

The 26-year-old, who became the first Indian woman to win an individual shotgun gold at the Asian Games a year earlier, completed a three-medal haul after also taking silver in the women’s team trap event.

The mixed team victory came despite Dhandha battling fatigue and the effects of an illness that had left her hospitalised in India 10 days before the Games.

Chenai shouldered much of the responsibility when his partner struggled to find her rhythm as the Indian pair finished with 34 hits from 40 in the final, an Asian and Games record, to beat Qatar on 32.

The Indian duo secured the gold ahead of a Qatar team coached by Australian shooting legend and two-time Olympic champion Michael Diamond. **PTI**



TRIGGER HAPPY
Neeru Dhandha and Kynan Chenai

VITALS

Gill Smashes Fastest 200 as India Beat Windies in Run-Fest

GUWAHATI: Shubman Gill struck the fastest double century in ODI history as India completed the second-highest successful chase in an ODI with an 8-wicket victory over West Indies in the second match of the three-game series on Wednesday. Gill, the No. 1 ODI batter, remained unbeaten on 223 off 133 balls. Rohit Sharma had set the tone with a 73-ball ton during a blistering 255-run opening stand with Gill. After Rohit’s departure, Gill ensured India didn’t lose momentum as he anchored their pursuit of a massive 406. **Reuters**

FASTEST ODI 200S

Balls	Player
117	Shubman Gill
128	Ishan Kishan
128	Glenn Maxwell
BRIEF SCORES WI 405/7 (Jangoo 114, Hope 104, Campbell 101; Kuldeep 2/65, Jadeja 2/75) lost to IND 406/2 in 43.3 overs (Shubman 223*, Rohit 101) by 8 wickets	

Injured Raphinha Out of India Friendly

BARCELONA: Raphinha was released by Brazil on Wednesday because of a thigh injury. The forward was replaced during the 4-2 win over Australia on Tuesday, when he scored from a penalty kick. The Brazilian Football Confederation said the Barcelona player underwent imaging tests that revealed a minor muscle edema on the back of his right thigh. “As a precaution and to ensure a speedy recovery, the player will be released from the Brazilian national team,” the confederation said. Brazil will play at India on Saturday for its final match of the international break. **AP**

DISCUSSIONS STILL PRELIMINARY

Naveen Jindal Weighs Bid for EU Firm Celsa

The €5-billion plan to enter Europe follows unsuccessful bid to buy Thyssenkrupp Steel

Mohit Bhalla

New Delhi: Jindal Steel's chairman Naveen Jindal is evaluating a €5-billion bid for European steel maker Celsa, people familiar with the matter said. He could face competition from other interested parties, they added. Jindal has been looking for a gateway into Europe to expand his global steel business after talks to buy Thyssenkrupp Steel didn't materialise. Jindal and Thyssenkrupp were engaged in exclu-

In the Hunt

Preliminary discussions may not ultimately produce a completed deal

Acquisition could lift Jindal group steel capacity beyond **25 MT**

Jindal may bid through privately owned overseas cos

CELSA

Operates across France, Spain and Poland today

Returned to profit after twenty-eight months restructuring

Reported **\$3.3b** revenue during calendar 2025

Offers **7.5-MT** capacity & construction-focused long steel products

sive negotiations for nine months before talks were terminated in the middle of this year.

'ATTRACTIVE' ASSETS Jindal is said to be evaluating a bid for Celsa through privately-owned overseas companies whose operations are unrelated to the listed Jindal Steel. The discussions are preliminary

and may not necessarily result in a deal. The Barcelona-headquartered Celsa's manufacturing capacity of 7.5 million tonnes of steel and its product portfolio of long steel products used in the construction industry are said to be attractive. Clubbed with the listed Jindal Steel, which is targeting steelmaking capacity of over 15 million tonnes, and Jindal's privately ow-

ned business in Oman with 3.2 million tonnes of steel capacity, the group's total steel capacity could cross 25 million tonnes, if the acquisition succeeds. Jindal is also adding 5 million tonnes of direct reduced iron manufacturing capacity in Oman. This could supply raw materials for any large steel making business he acquires in Europe. The

group also owns iron ore mines in Mozambique and Cameroon. Jindal and Celsa did not comment on the matter when contacted. Celsa has operations in France, Spain and Poland. Creditors including Strategic Value Partners, Attestor, Deutsche Bank and Golden Tree control Celsa. They own almost 100% stake. The company originally belonged to Spain's Rubiralta family. The company was turned around after the creditors took control in 2023. They have infused €1 billion through loans, bonds and shares as part of recapitalisation efforts. The company posted a profit in April after twenty-eight months of restructuring efforts. For the calendar year 2025 it posted revenues of €3.3 billion and earnings before interest, tax, depreciation and amortization of €396 million.

ON THE MOVE Many clean technologies to earn credits; non-compliant cos can trade debits In CAFE 3, Auto Cos have Wider Choices and a Better View of the Road

Shally Seth Mohile & Sharmistha Mukherjee **Mumbai | New Delhi:** India's newly notified CAFE 3 emission norms could alter the direction of automakers' powertrain investments, giving less polluting technologies such as hybrids, plug-in hybrids (PHEVs), range extenders and ethanol-compatible vehicles a bigger role alongside pure EVs. By allowing multiple clean technologies to earn compliance credits, the norms could prompt automakers to rethink product portfolios and investment plans for the five-year period through March 2032. Non-compliant companies will face debits that can be traded or bought. "There will be a lot of exercises on scenario planning," said Rajat Mahajan, partner and automotive sector leader at Deloitte, South Asia, adding that OEMs will have to "rethink their product portfolio over the next five years."

The compliance flexibilities could be particularly significant for Tata Motors, Mahindra & Mahindra and Vinfast which have invested heavily in pure battery EVs and largely stayed away from hybrids, said Puneet Gupta, director, S&P Global Mobility. "This will derail their pure BEV ambitions. For European automakers such as Volkswagen-Skoda, Renault and Stellantis, and Korean carmakers such as Hyundai and Kia, the framework could provide another route to meet tighter fleet CO₂ targets without immediately committing to large-scale local EV investments," he said. The framework gives the highest super-credit multiplier of 3 to battery EVs and range-extender EVs, while plug-in hybrids/strong hybrids running on flex-fuel ethanol get 2.5, strong hybrids 1.6 and flex-fuel ethanol vehicles 1.1. The multiplier allows

Plugged In

Pure-EV heavy cos may face disrupted investment ambitions under **CAFE**

Battery and range-extended EVs receive highest multiplier

Ethanol, plug-in hybrids get stronger credits than conventional hybrids

Centre for science & environment fears **CAFE 3** could slow EV adoption

Amitabh Kant says EVs must remain ultimate transportation destination

one clean vehicle to count as multiple vehicles in calculating a company's fleet average. The norms also recognise smaller efficiency technologies. Features such as start-stop systems, tyre-pressure monitoring, regenerative braking, LED lighting and efficient air-conditioning can each reduce calculated emissions by 1 gram CO₂/km, subject to a total benefit cap of 9 grams CO₂/km. Automakers broadly welcomed the framework. Maruti Suzuki said it recognises "multiple powertrain technologies and fuels", with Rahul Bharti, senior executive officer, corporate affairs, calling the credit/debit mechanism an improvement over CAFE 2. Shailesh Chandra, MD & CEO, Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles, said the continued recognition of zero-emission technologies reinforces "the critical role of electrification." Mahindra's Velusamy R, president, automotive business, said norms strike a "pragmatic balance" between environmental objectives and what is achievable for industry, and welcomed tech credits, cleaner-fuel benefits and EV super credits.

SUITS & SAYINGS

ET's roundup of the wackiest whispers in corporate corridors

Tipping Point

If there is one universal truth, it is that nobody likes a bad tipper. A celebrity restaurateur, whose private parties reportedly command a cool ₹45,000 a plate, has apparently acquired quite a reputation at the salon she frequents to have her long tresses blow-dried. The irony isn't lost on the staff: their well-heeled client is said to routinely "forget" the tip and, adding insult to injury, ask for a discount on the bill. Word is the salon owner has had enough. When an invitation arrived for one of the restaurateur's starry bashes, she promptly cooked up an excuse and stayed away. At ₹45,000 a plate, perhaps revenge is a dish best left uneaten.

Liquor Loophole

The liquor industry's conversations with the advertising watchdog have thrown up an old grouse with a new twist: the bigger the brand, the harder it may be to hide the surrogate. Large players complain that while their extensions into water, mixers and other categories routinely attract scrutiny, some smaller rivals appear to have discovered rather more imaginative routes. CDs and assorted products bearing liquor-brand names, with only a tenuous connection to a genuine extension, are among the examples being whispered about. The majors aren't necessarily asking for the rulebook to be rewritten. Their question is simpler: if surrogate advertising is the problem, shouldn't everyone be drinking from the same cup?

Privy to the whispers in power corridors or juicy tips on India Inc? Do share with us at etsuits.sayings@timesofindia.com

In a Nutshell

Apple Pay Enters India's Payment Mkt

NEW DELHI iPhone-maker Apple launched its payment services in India, which is now its third largest market

by volume, well over a decade after its launch in the United States, enabling iPhone, Apple Watch and iPad users to make contactless payments at online portals and merchants with Near Field Communication (NFC)-enabled Point of Sale (PoS) machines. The service is available to Apple users with Axis bank-issued Visa and MasterCard credit cards at launch. Users can add their cards to Apple's Wallet app to make payments without having to enter a separate PIN code or an OTP. Merchant transactions are authenticated using facial recognition, fingerprint or the device PIN. "India is home to a dynamic and digitally savvy population that continues to embrace a cashless future while expecting the highest standards of security..." said Jennifer Bailey, VP of Apple Pay and Apple Wallet in a statement. **Our Bureau**

Coca-Cola Mulls Dec Filing for India Unit's IPO

Coca-Cola is considering filing a draft prospectus in December for an initial public offering of its Indian bottling unit, according to people familiar with matter. The Atlanta-based drinks giant also added Axis Capital and IIFL Capital Services to roster of banks working on Hindustan Coca-Cola Beverages deal, people said. **Bloomberg**

HOME RUN Mumbai Prop Deals Log September Best

Registrations up 4% as festival boost, city's ongoing infra upgrade help vitalise demand

Kailash Babar

Mumbai: Mumbai, the country's largest and most expensive property market, has continued its momentum, recording its strongest September performance ever, with the city's ongoing infrastructure upgrade and improving connectivity across established and emerging corridors supporting housing demand.

STRONG SHOW The beginning of festive season further added impetus to the market, helping the city record 12,560 property registrations in September, up 4% on year, while the state exchequer collected ₹1,242 crore in stamp duty, according to data from the inspector general of registration and controller of stamps, Maharashtra. "The strong performance during Ganesh Chaturthi, with registrations rising 22% on year, provided a notable contribution to the month's overall activity. The increase in registrations during both the festive period and the month reflects continued homebuyer participation, although buyers remain selective in their purchase decisions," said Shishir Bajjal, international partner & CMD, Knight Frank India. Stamp duty collections, however, fell 4% on year, primarily reflecting a shift in the transaction mix. "The ongoing expansion of transport and civic infrastructure is widening the residential

A High Rise -22% Ganesh Chaturthi registrations rose compared with last year

5,379 Properties were registered during Sept 14-25 festivities

₹640 crore Festival-period stamp duty collections rose 32% year-on-year

Buyers remain selective, prioritising connectivity and quality developments

STRONG TRIGGERS Improved connectivity Festive demand and infrastructure expansion



demand footprint, improving accessibility to emerging corridors while strengthening connectivity in established locations. This is supporting demand across a broader set of micro-markets and providing developers with opportunities to add housing supply in locations benefiting from improved connectivity," said Vishal N Ratanghaya, founder & CEO, Platinum Corp. According to him, the market is also witnessing higher inquiries and deal conclusions from the NRI segment in the backdrop of geopolitical uncertainties, specifically in the West

Asia region. The Ganesh Chaturthi period particularly made a significant contribution to the month's performance, with Mumbai recording 5,379 property registrations between September 14 and 25. Registrations during the period rose 22% year-on-year and were the highest for the festive period in the last four years.

TRANSACTION ACTIVITY Stamp duty collections during the festival period stood also rose 32% on-year to ₹640 crore. This rise in both registrations and revenue during the festive period points to sustained homebuyer participation during one of the key transaction windows for the city's residential market. The September performance also builds on the strong transaction activity seen through much of the year: Mumbai recorded 12,580 registrations in August, 13,824 in July and 13,413 in June, indicating sustained transaction volumes across the market. The market is expected to remain healthy, supported by festive demand, new project activity, redevelopment and infrastructure-led expansion into emerging residential corridors. While buyers are turning more selective in their purchase decisions, locations offering stronger connectivity, quality developments and established social infrastructure are likely to continue attracting demand. Developers, in turn, are expected to remain focused on markets where underlying housing demand and infrastructure improvements provide greater visibility. With this, Mumbai's residential market is carrying strong momentum into the final quarter of the year, with record September registrations and robust festive activity reinforcing the depth of housing demand across the city.

HDFC Capital, Shalimar Create ₹750 cr Platform for UP Real Estate

Faizan Haider

New Delhi: HDFC Capital Advisors, the real estate private equity arm of HDFC Group, has created a ₹750 crore platform with Shalimar Corp to develop residential and mixed-use projects across key markets in Uttar Pradesh, including Lucknow, Varanasi and Kanpur. The platform will include multiple projects with a combined development potential of more than 5 million sq ft and about 3,000 homes, targeting demand for aspirational housing in these markets. "Emerging urban centres across Uttar Pradesh are set to lead the next phase of housing growth, supported by rising incomes, urbanisation and infrastructure development," said Vipul Roongta, MD and CEO, HDFC Capital. Shalimar has launched projects worth ₹6,000 crore in the last three years. In FY27, it plans to launch projects worth ₹4,000 crore.

The company recently entered Varanasi, which it has identified as a key growth market, citing its increasing religious significance, spiritual tourism and large-scale infrastructure investments. "Over the years, Shalimar has built a legacy of trust and excellence through a diversified portfolio of residential townships, IT parks and mixed-use developments, and with this platform, we plan to take the development ahead," said Khalid Masood, MD, Shalimar Corp. Shalimar Corp has delivered more than 70 projects and developed more than 25 million sq ft of premium real estate. It is also executing township projects in Lucknow.



Platform to include multiple projects with a combined development potential of more than 5 m sq ft

Vadilal Inds Signs New One-Year Supply Deal

New deal, effective from Nov, signed with estranged group firm; old agreement expired at the end of Sept

Our Bureau

New Delhi: Ice-cream and frozen desserts maker Vadilal Industries (VIL) on Wednesday signed a revised supply agreement for a 12-month period with estranged group entity Vadilal Enterprises (VEL) for marketing and distribution. The new agreement will be effective from November 1 this year to October 31, 2027, VIL said in a stock exchange filing.

SHAREHOLDER APPROVAL

According to its statement, the agreement "could not be renewed from October 1 as Vadilal Enterprises had not received the required approval from its public shareholders for the proposed renewal". Last month, Vadilal appointed Himanshu Kanwar, its first non-family chief executive, amid a long-standing dispute within the promoter Gandhi family over



brand rights and regional sales territories for the Vadilal ice cream business. The appointment followed a restructuring that involved the merger of three promoter-held entities—Vadilal International, Vadilal Finance Company and Veronica Constructions—into Vadilal Industries. VIL reported a standalone net profit of ₹98.01 crore for FY26, down from ₹113.88 crore the previous year. It posted ₹1,109.54 crore in revenue from operations.

Tata Trusts Seeks to be Heard on Venu Srinivasan's Complaint

Trusts also taking legal view on whether to file caveat before charity commissioner

Our Bureau

Mumbai: Tata Trusts submitted a request to the Maharashtra charity commissioner seeking an opportunity to be heard before any decision is made on a complaint filed by Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT) trustee Venu Srinivasan, who has alleged governance lapses in the trust's administration. The Trusts are also taking a legal view on whether to file a caveat at petition that would ensure that the charity commissioner does not pass any interim orders without hearing them, people in the know said. "A caveat has to be filed before a judicial officer at the charity commissioner's office following the due process. So far, a submission has been made before the charity commissioner seeking an opportunity to be heard," said a person who was privy to developments. Tata Trusts declined to comment. The move comes days after Sri-



nivasan sought an immediate inquiry into the administration and governance of SDTT, alleging "serious governance lapses" and questioning the involvement of the charitable trust and its trustees in Tata Sons' commercial and strategic affairs. In his complaint, Srinivasan questioned the appointment and continued status of Noel Tata as a perpetual trustee, his position as chairman of Tata Trusts, the appointment of Neville Tata and Srinivasan's exclusion from certain decision-making processes. He also objected to a September 16 circular resolution seeking to

QUESTIONING STATUS

In his complaint, Srinivasan questioned the appointment and continued status of Noel Tata as a perpetual trustee

restrain him, as the joint SDTT-Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT) nominee director on the Tata Sons board, from participating in or voting on the proposed listing of Tata Sons. Srinivasan described the move as an "extraordinary attempt" to prevent him from exercising his independent judgment and alleged it was part of an effort to "concentrate decision-making power within a smaller group of trustees." Srinivasan sought directions against Noel Tata on his participation in certain SDTT decisions and asked the charity commissioner to consider suspension or removal of trustees, if warranted.

AWARENESS LOW ABOUT VERIFYING HALLMARK NUMBER IN APP

As Gold Hallmarking Charges Rise, Fraudsters Get Busy Too

Sutanuka Ghosal

Kolkata: The rising charges of gold hallmarking are fuelling concern that it may drive unscrupulous jewellers to use fake stamps, particularly in tier-2, 3 and 4 cities where consumer awareness remains low. Hallmarking charges are paid by consumers when they buy jewellery. However, awareness that the Hallmark Unique Identification (HUID) number can be cross-checked on the Bureau of Indian Standards' Care mobile application remains low among buyers. Rajesh Rokde, chairman of All-India Gem and Jewellery Domestic Council (GJC), said only about 10% of the country's 800 districts have adequate awareness of the BIS app, leaving consumers vulnerable as fraudsters find increasingly sophisticated ways to replicate hallmarking safeguards, including photographs. GJC has raised the issue with consumer affairs minister Pralhad Joshi and the BIS, seeking restoration of the earlier ₹45-per-article rate

Illegal Delight 10% Share of 800 districts that understand BIS verification Many districts remain vulnerable to sophisticated hallmarking fraud 1,577 Recognised hallmarking centres in July 2026

from the current ₹75. The latest revision represents a 66.67% increase and, the council said, adds a significant compliance burden across a mandatory system. The industry body has questioned whether the higher cost is matched by a corresponding improvement in

consumer protection. Government data cited by GJC shows that recognised assaying and hallmarking centres (AHCs) increased to 1,577 in July 2026 from 1,220 in July 2022, while cumulative gold articles hallmarked with HUID rose to more than 650 million. The scale of activity has also expanded substantially. In 2025-26, 132.2 million jewellery articles were hallmarked. At the revised rate, the council estimates the additional cost to the ecosystem at around ₹400 crore, besides roughly ₹80 crore in GST. GJC has sought a detailed cost assessment from BIS, including the additional equipment, manpower, processing and storage costs behind the revised rate. It has also questioned the incremental cost associated with mandatory photography, arguing that photographs can potentially be replicated or manipulated by fraudsters. The council said hallmarking turnaround time has increased from six hours earlier to 24-36 hours, locking up jewellers' working capital and increasing financing costs.



Mind the Diesel Retail-Bulk Gap

PSUs must manage retail demand better

High global diesel prices are straining the finances of government-owned refiners that are selling the fuel to domestic customers at frozen prices. But they are propping up earnings of private refiners that drive major part of India's petroleum exports. The difference between diesel sold to bulk buyers at market-determined prices and through retail outlets has opened considerably to about ₹40 a litre, and there is scope for diversion between market segments. Nayara and Reliance have become proactive about rationing retail sales. IOC, BPCL and HPCL must take the cue to manage surging demand at fuel pumps. With crude oil hovering above \$100 a barrel, Indian refiners need to plug leakage into the bulk market to contain under-recovery in retail sales.

The bulk of the under-recovery is borne by PSU refiners that have held retail fuel rates on GoI's prodding. Private refiners maintain a parity with this rate, but they have about a 10% share of diesel sold through fuel pumps. Their share of sales to bulk consumers is considerably higher at 25%. The scope for diversion of private refinery diesel is limited, and if they manage to contain it, they are setting an example for the much larger market supplied by PSU refiners. If the diversion of diesel from retail to bulk segments is localised to PSU-refined diesel, it adds additional load on refiners with relatively low exposure to the buoyant export market.

There are, of course, certain extra constraints on PSU refiners, such as irrigation demand for diesel during an erratic monsoon season. With that out of the way, they could impose daily limits on diesel purchases at fuel pumps. GoI, too, has barred commercial and industrial users from buying diesel from the retail market. India has an advantage in its excess petroleum-refining capacity to tide over the global spike in diesel prices. But it must ensure the market functions efficiently for targeted delivery of fuel subsidies.

Globalisation 2.0, Can It Be Furrowed Home?

As far as photo-ops go, an Indian business family announcing a mega project on US soil at the Oval Office in the presence of POTUS makes for a pretty picture. Essar's plans for a \$15 bn steel complex in Iowa, supported by an iron ore mine in Minnesota, can be seen as a comeback story — if one decides to see it as a comeback story, important funding details other than trade financiers still being hazy. But there's a bigger story marinating: Indian corporate houses taking Globalisation 2.0 through the greenfield or inorganic cross-border expansion route. In the last year, Tata Motors, Sun Pharma and Persistent Systems have taken M&A strides. From auto components to solar panels, pharma to tech, a handful are taking steps to build overseas. But is India Inc increasingly hedging its bets in a volatile world — even beta-testing MAGAmerica — at the cost of its domestic base?

In March, Trump announced an 'historic' RIL-anchored \$300 bn investment in a Texas-based entity building a major oil refinery, securing a 20-yr purchase agreement for the refinery's output. Dollar outflow and commitment of capital, tech to buttress strategic US industrial prowess, and jobs may seem an indictment of India's decade-plus push towards localisation and *aatmanirbharta*, especially with aggregate net income of listed Indian firms approaching a record 6% of GDP. But the fact is that their capex has remained flat, hovering at 3.6-3.7% of GDP.

Other than the top 4 — Adani, JSW, Tata and Reliance — 'animal spirits' of mid-level homegrown corporates seem to be shrinking. Their dwindling share in national investment can be a challenge in a country of rising un-/under-employment. So, when will India Inc's new expansionary spirit bring the fruits of Globalisation 2.0 home?



JUST IN JEST

The catch-all musical category for listeners not THAT invested-interested

The Discordant Note Of 'World Music'

You've probably been too busy getting dizzy with some Gillespie trumpet magic to notice that the phrase 'world music' has been performing a remarkable geopolitical trick: it means music from everywhere — except parts of the world powerful enough to claim their own musical genres. Born from African musical traditions, seasoned in New Orleans, exported through Paris, Tokyo and Bombay, improvised by people on every continent, it's *not* 'world music'. It's Jazz — with a capital J, with its own critics, histories, festivals, university studies, and folks prepared to explain why Art Blakey came in fractionally late in 1959.

America produced so many extraordinary jazz musicians — and listeners, writers, record labels and evangelists — that the music got sovereign status. Nobody would dream of filing Miles Davis under 'world music'. Yet, even in India, you'll get baul, Hindustani classical, Indipop, filmi music, desi rap, Carnatic classical all bundled in one laundry basket. It's actually revealing of what people think of their own music to not have enough popular critical space to chat about it. If Punjab had been a superpower, who knows, bhangra may have had 12 sub-genres, specialist magazines, and furious arguments about whether the 1967 split between 'Majha' and 'Malwa' marks a certain aesthetic decline. Instead, alas, it's bunged in 'world music'.

AI will disrupt legacy IT, but enterprise adoption can fuel a new growth wave for ITes

DODGING SaaSOCALYPSE



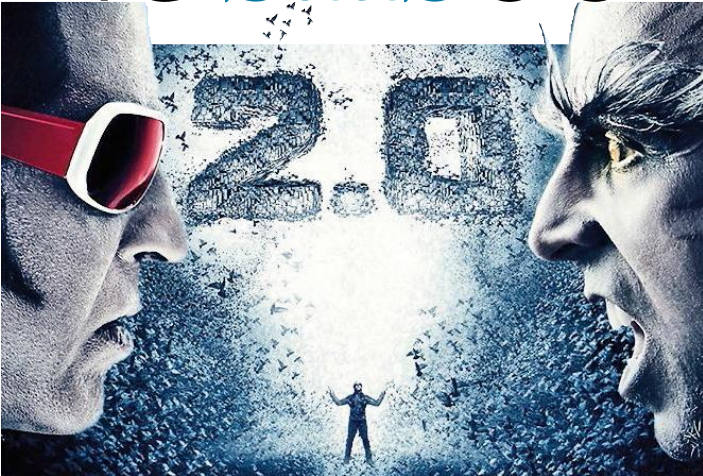
Amit Singh

Is ITC Infotech's merger with Bengaluru-based Happiest Minds, coming close on the heels of Persistent's acquisition of Munich-based Nagarro, a signal of mid-market consolidation in the face of AI-led disruption? With the market capitalisation of top global companies down almost 25% since 2026 beginning, the picture becomes blurrier. To compound matters, trading multiples of global IT majors today resemble those of low-end staffing companies not so long ago.

There can be little argument against acquiring new AI-centric capabilities. But the industry needs a cure for its ailment, and scale alone may not provide it. Excitement around LLMs and GenAI notwithstanding, the real story is not the models themselves, but how, where and through whom AI gets embedded in global firms.

Model differentiation will have to be matched by distribution reach. This is where global IT comes in. The slew of partnerships between frontier model providers such as OpenAI and Anthropic, and IT majors like TCS, Accenture, EPAM, Cognizant and DXC points to this growing realisation.

So, where will funding for this transformation come from? Enterprises carry an estimated \$1.5 tn in technical debt, while maintaining legacy systems consumes nearly \$500 bn in annual tech spending. This burden is also an opportunity. AI's first meaningful contribution may not be glamorous. It could quietly optimise and automate the legacy layer, with resulting efficiencies funding the next wave of AI adoption. But the IT industry must astutely manage the resulting revenue contraction and redistribution if it's to participate meaningfully



IT vs AI

in new pools of value.

AI is not a single market but an ecosystem. Value is already being generated across the entire stack — from silicon to data infrastructure, from energy generation to foundation models, and ultimately to enterprise applications.

Much of the early narrative focused on foundation models, creating fears that application software would become commoditised. But there is no 'SaaSocalypse'. Enterprise software is evolving. Some applications will become thinner as intelligence migrates into the platform, while others will become richer by embedding AI deeply into workflows.

The AI-native enterprise is likely to evolve around 4 interconnected layers of systems:

- **Engagement** Customer-facing interfaces where humans interact with intelligent software.
 - **Agents** Networks of AI agents that reason, collaborate and execute tasks.
 - **Work** Operational platforms and workflow systems that run the enterprise.
 - **Context** Enterprise data, knowledge, governance and memory that ground AI in organisational reality.
- The alpha of individual companies may change. But it will still have to be coded to their specific systems and context. This is precisely where IT partners have played a role in the past, and that role is unlikely to diminish in

an AI-native world.

Software was always a deterministic science. But in the AI context, software is becoming probabilistic, and increasingly capable of self-improvement. So, can AI-native systems co-exist indefinitely with IT infrastructure that was designed around human operators?

The tech for autonomous vehicles has existed for years. Yet, adoption has been constrained by the difficulty of running manual and autonomous cars in the same lanes. Likewise, AI-native systems may never achieve their full potential while operating inside workflows designed for human decision-making. This could mean wholesale reengineering of the systems stack, creating more revenue opportunities for tech-services companies.

Evolution of SaaS offers a useful precedent. Successful SaaS companies largely emerged in 3 categories:

- **Universal needs** Email, calendars, collaboration and search, now dominated by established tech giants.
- **New consumer categories** Ride-sharing, food delivery and home-sharing, where agile startups established leadership before incumbents recognised the opportunity.
- **B2B specialisation** Software built around deep vertical or functional expertise, becoming indispensable to specific industries or business functions.



AI's biggest enterprise opportunity may lie in embedding intelligence into legacy systems, workflows and data

AI appears to be following a similar trajectory in broad consumer applications such as AI assistants as well as surprising, new categories. The largest long-term opportunity, however, may lie in enterprise AI: domain-specific models, industry-specialised applications and intelligent systems deeply integrated into business processes.

As with SaaS, this layer is unlikely to produce a single winner. Instead, it could spawn hundreds of companies serving specialised markets. IT companies' trajectory will increasingly depend on enabling these domain-specific AI solutions, from multi-step, AI agent-driven loan processing to autonomous cyber defence.

Future of enterprise AI won't be determined solely by breakthroughs in model architecture, but by how effectively these models are integrated into the messy, heterogeneous and highly regulated reality of global business.

That is where the global ITes industry becomes indispensable.

If AI is the engine, IT services provide the road that allows it to move at scale. Some legacy IT players will adapt. Others won't. But successful ones are likely to unlock disproportionate value. Most technology revolutions progress through 3 phases:

- **Extractive** Foundational capabilities developed.
 - **Distributive** Technologies deployed at scale.
 - **Destructive** Incumbent architectures displaced.
- Legacy enterprise software is entering its destructive phase, while AI remains largely in its extractive phase, with rapid advances in models and infrastructure.

Historically, global IT services firms create the greatest value for themselves when an emergent tech enters its distributive phase. This thesis has held true for mainframes, packaged applications, internet, cloud and SaaS. There's no reason to believe that AI will be different. So, the good times for the IT industry in the AI world may actually be around the corner.

The writer is former head of technology services investment banking, Aventus Capital



A Thought For Today

SUDHA DEVI NAYAK

A series of reflections by MK Gandhi, under the title 'A Thought For the Day', fetched a record ₹5.2 cr in an online auction. Though meant for his associate Anand Hingorani to overcome his personal grief, they were an intellectual and moral exercise intended for his personal guidance, his lived philosophy and practical wisdom for the conduct of life. It is an account of self-discipline and moral conviction primarily meant for himself. He wanted to live up to his ideals before he could preach his values to others.

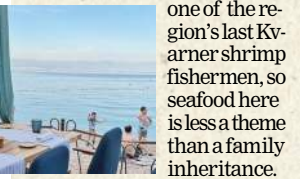
Gandhi was ever the seeker. As poet Iqbal says, 'I have always been wandering/ seeking my inner self/ As if I am myself the voyager/ and the destination.' The key themes of these thoughts centre on Truth, the ultimate foundation of moral life; ahimsa; power of the powerless; mastery of senses, and service to God through service to humanity. This was the path to self-regulation and Self-realisation, overcoming fear to gain strength for moral resistance and freedom.

Historian Louis Fischer says Gandhi did not preach religion; he was a living sermon. He had authority devoid of power. Power is the attribute of a machine; authority is the attribute of a person. Gandhi's rejection of power enhanced his authority. Power feeds the blood and tears of its victims; authority is fed by service, sympathy and affection. In a world racked by fear and fracture, his thoughts remain remarkably relevant.



Konoba Zijavica
Moscenicka Draga, Croatia

There are restaurants where the setting does half the work, and then there is Konoba Zijavica, where the Adriatic seems to have wandered straight into the kitchen. Perched right by the water in the fishing village of Moscenicka Draga, this small, unpretentious restaurant is all about the sea — and chef-owner Stiven Vunic knows exactly what to do with it. His father is a fisherman and



one of the region's last Kvarner shrimp fishermen, so seafood here is less a theme than a family inheritance. The menu follows the day's catch, with familiar Adriatic flavours given little turns. Kvarner langoustines are the star: sweet, slightly saline and mineral, and so fresh that Vunic says they can reach the kitchen within minutes of being pulled from the sea. His grandmother's langoustine risotto, made with stock from toasted shells, Parmesan and generous chunks of meat, sounds like the sort of family recipe best left alone.

But there is plenty of playfulness elsewhere — from scampi tartare with carrot and lemon ice cream to ceviche of Adriatic prawns, octopus and red mullet. The terrace, practically over the water, complements the experience. Visit when the beach quietsens and the waves take over, and Zijavica becomes exactly what a seaside meal should be: relaxed, local and memorable.

Chat Room

OK in Letter, Ta-Ta in Spirit

Apologies 'Srinivasan Seeks Inquiry by Charity Watchdog into SDIT' by Kala Vijayaraghavan and Rashmi Rajput (Sep 30), while legally permissible, engineering financial ratios to remain private raises fundamental questions regarding regulatory intent. Holding nearly nine-tenths of group assets as investments while earning like an operating entity creates a thin margin between technical compliance and systemic reality. RBI's scale-based framework was created to enforce transparency and market discipline for upper-layer financial behemoths. Allowing financial reclassification through structural manoeuvres risks setting a precedent that other conglomerates could exploit to bypass public scrutiny. The central bank must evaluate this proposal not merely on mathematical thresholds but on the true nature of corporate governance.

Sanjay Chopra
Mohali

Go On RBI, Take a Hike Next Week



Shekhar Aiyar & Aashi Gupta

RBI held its policy rate steady at 5.25% in August, arguing correctly that it needed greater clarity before acting. That clarity has been provided by subsequent data. With retail inflation well above the 4% target and on a rising trajectory, and with commodity price shocks beginning to filter more broadly through the economy, it's time for an interest rate hike at next week's meeting of the monetary policy committee.

Food and fuel inflation remain the key underlying drivers. Food inflation has risen from about 2% y-o-y at the beginning of the year, to 6% in August. Fuel inflation has risen even more sharply over the same period, from a mere 0.2% to the current 5.2%. These are unsurprising developments in a country that has historical-

ly transported about half of its crude oil and 90% of its LPG imports through the Strait of Hormuz.

The standard prescription for monetary policy in the face of a commodity price shock is to look through it. After all, central banks cannot influence the weather, or dictate the supply of crude. But that prescription holds only so far as the shock is temporary and contained. Clearly, the hope that the shock would be short-lived has long evaporated. With Houthi's now endangering passage through the alternative Strait of Bab al-Mandab, it would be more prudent to prepare for a lengthy disruption of oil markets. As for the shock being contained, evidence suggests, instead, that second-round effects are spreading to other sectors of the economy.

Consider manufactured product inflation, which accounts for almost two-thirds of WPI. This reached 8.4% in August, highest in the current series. Meanwhile, the gap between wholesale and retail inflation narrowed: the WPI-CPI spread stood at 5.95 percentage points in May but

had closed to 5.1 points by August, with the convergence driven by rising CPI rather than by falling WPI. And core inflation — which strips out the impact of food and energy prices from the retail index — rose from 3.9% in July to 4.2% in August. Taken together, these indicators bear the distinct signature of a gradual producer-to-consumer pass-through, one that may have further to run.

Compounding this is a shift in the external policy environment. US Federal Reserve, European Central Bank and Bank of Japan have all raised rates in the past weeks. The Bank of England held, but 3 of its 9 members voted to hike. The US 10-yr yield is now hovering just above 5% against India's 7%. A smaller spread, of course, makes Indian securities less attractive to foreign investors, putting pressure on the exchange rate. And rupee depreciation contributes mechanically to higher import prices (whatever the merits or demerits of targeting the exchange rate, which is a separate matter).



If not now, when?

Check Gate Before the Horse Bolts



Ashish Karundia

India doesn't have an information problem. It has a sequencing problem. The recent case of a Hyderabad CA allegedly issuing fake Form 15CB certificates that facilitated ₹600 cr in foreign remittances — amid a wider I-T probe into 394 entities and 36 professionals — brought the issue into focus.

But the policy question is bigger than whether a particular certificate was issued correctly or not. How can a transaction pass through tax, banking and trade systems, with each system holding a piece of information, without those pieces being brought together before the money leaves India? The answer should not be another layer of paperwork, but a better-designed system in which the existing information is used at the right time.

GoI could consider creating a separate class of professionals to undertake foreign remittance certification. Eligibility could be based on minimum years of practice, relevant experience, training and an assessment, broadly on the lines of the registered valuer framework. Such a measure would ensure quality and accountability in tax determination,

without shifting the burden of establishing commercial genuineness onto the certifying professional.

One could consider bringing a short pre-remittance window. There could be a gap of, say, three working days, between filing prescribed remittance information and documents and release of funds. This need not become an approval mechanism, but rather a tech-driven risk assessment.

During this period, the tax system could automatically examine the remitter's profile — age, turnover, tax filings, GST activity, past foreign remittances, and other information available with GoI. A transaction consistent with the taxpayer's profile should pass without intervention. A transaction that is not, should generate an alert. The time gap can make a difference when the alternative is trying to recover money after it has left the country.

Banks probably possess the most valuable information in this chain: the customer's financial behaviour.

RBI's KYC framework requires risk categorisation based on factors such as the nature of business, financial profile, geography and type of transactions. This intelligence should be brought more meaningfully into the remittance process. The bank's screening should also consider beneficial ownership, sanctions, adverse information, and the profile of the overseas beneficiary and jurisdiction, wherever such information is available. A large payment by an established exporter may be routine. The same payment by an entity whose account activity and stated business doesn't support it shouldn't be.

Import-related remittances provide an even clearer opportunity. The authorised dealer bank has a role in establishing bona fides of import payments, while customs has the corresponding import data. The two should be linked.

An advance remittance should not become a closed transaction merely because the money has gone overseas. The system should match the remittance with the relevant 'bill of entry' and establish whether the goods enter-



Here we go...

ed India. In other words, the chain should be capable of being followed from remittance to import and back to the importer.

GoI should bring these individual checks into a common risk framework. I-T, GST, corporate affairs ministry, customs and banks possess information that, when viewed together, can reveal patterns invisible to any one institution. A new entity, low turnover, common ownership across multiple companies, sudden imports, large outward remittances and repeated payments to the same overseas beneficiaries may each appear harmless in isolation. Taken together, they may warrant attention.

This doesn't require unrestricted sharing of databases. What's needed is controlled interoperability. One agency need not see another agency's entire database. It needs to know when that database has generated a material risk signal.

India has built much of the information infrastructure. FATF's assessment has also recognised India's progress in using fintel, access to beneficial ownership information and inter-agency cooperation. Objective of reforms should be simple: don't make every transaction difficult; make suspicious transactions difficult to execute.

The right time to ask whether the transaction makes sense is before the money leaves India. Not after it becomes a recovery exercise.

The writer is a chartered accountant

ANYTHING ON UPI, ASK MYUPI.

Control. Confidence. Convenience.
Enhancing trust and safety in every payment you make.



View all your UPI transactions instantly



View and manage all Autopay mandates



Pay Safe - Know more about beneficiary



Raise and Track Complaints



Safety Switch#- Stop UPI Payments



De-link UPI Number - Stop inward payments to your mobile



Scan this QR to get instant, reliable answers to your UPI related queries - anytime you need.

Find  MyUPI on your favourite UPI app or explore it at www.upihelp.npci.org.in.

Access all your transactions and mandates across UPI apps and banks*.
#Access this feature using **MyUPI** through your favourite UPI app.

UPI Apps



*Participating banks and apps



EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
(S&T Construction Organisation)
E-TENDER NOTICE
No. Snt-C-155

CSTE/CON/ECR/Mahendraghat/Patna for & on behalf of president of India are invited Open online E-Tender.

E-Tender No.: Snt-C-155

Name of work: Design, Manufacturing, Supply, Installation, Testing and Commissioning of Distributed Electronic Interlocking System (Indoor & Outdoor) (One centralized + Two end cabins) along with Telecom works at Sitamarhi, Riga, Raxaul and Narkatiyaganj Stations in SPJ Division of East Central Railway..

Approximate cost: Rs.82,28,85,040.01, **Earnest Money:** Rs.1,64,57,700.00, **Cost of Tender document :** Nil, **Completion Period:** 36 Months, **Closing Date & Time for submission of E-Tender:** 21.10.2026 up to 13.00, For details information may kindly see the tender notice and tender documents which are available at Indian Railways website <http://www.irops.gov.in>

Dy. Chief Sig. & Tele. Engineer (Con)/ North East Central Railway, Mahendraghat, Patna PR/1030/CNN/MHX/S&T/126-27/36



EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE

The Divisional Railway Manager (Mechanical) E.C. Railway/Samastipur for and on behalf of the President of India invites Open e-tender under Single packet system from experienced and financially capable tenderers for the following works in E-tendering mode of IREPS web portal of Indian Railways: **S. No. -1, Tender notice No. - M-TC-24-09-2026** (Open E-Tender), Dt.- 25.09.2026, **Name of Work :** Annual maintenance contract for maintenance of fire detection & Suppression system in Power/Pantry car & Automatic Smoke/Fire detection system in AC coaches (LHB & ICF) at Coaching Depots of SPJ Division for three years. **Tender value (In rupees):** 52164426.67, **Earnest money (In rupees):** 1043300.00, **Completion period of the work :** 03 Years. 2. Receiving date and time for e-tender mode on IREPS web portal: 19.10.2026 up to 15.00 hrs. 3. Opening date and time for e-tender, 19.10.2026 at 15.30 hrs. 4. Web site particulars where complete details of tender and tender document can be seen on website: www.irops.gov.in.

Sr. DME/C&W/Samastipur PR/1035/SPJ/MECH/T/26-27/36



E-TENDER NOTICE

Office of Dy. Chief Engineer (Construction) Dhanbad, Dated: 26.09.2026

Sl.No.1, E-Tender No.: ECR-DCE-DHN-03-26-27, **Name of the work with its location & completion period:** Associated leftover works for commissioning of section between KQR (Ch. 64.500) to Kheraundh (Yard excluding) (Ch. 24.00) in connection with KQR-TIA New B.G. Rail line project along with its maintenance activities after opening of section (18 Months), **Approx. Cost work (In Rs.):** Rs. 81,06,82,748.81/-, **Earnest Money (In Rs.):** Earnest Money is applicable as shown in <http://www.irops.gov.in>, **portal, Date & time for closing and opening of e-tender:** Date of closing of e-tender at 15:00 hours on 23.10.2026 Date of opening of e-tender from 17:30 hrs. on 23.10.2026, **Website particulars** <http://www.irops.gov.in>, No manual tender will be accepted against e-tendering.

Note:- (i) In case of difference between Information in Hindi and English languages, only English languages will be valid, (ii) Prospective bidders are directed to take note of any changes and corrigendum in the process of issue of this e-tender, at least fifteen days prior to the date of closing of bid on the website <http://www.irops.gov.in> for latest corrigendum/corrections etc. in connection with this e-tender, (iii) Any e-tender which is sent by Post/Courier/Fax or by hand will not be accepted. All such manual submission of tender even on firm's letter pad even received in time will not be accepted. The above e-tender document along with full information is available on website <http://www.irops.gov.in>

Dy. Chief Engineer (Construction) East Central Railway, Dhanbad PR/1026/CON DHN/CONST/1726-27/52



EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE
(Engineering Bridge Dept)

The Dy.CE/BRL, E.C.Railway, Hajipur is inviting online (E-Tendering) Open Tender for and on behalf of the President of India from reputed contractor with experience, financial capability including those registered/working with Railway/Irrigation/CPWD/MES or any other public sector undertaking for the following work:

1.Tender Notice No: BRL-DNR-26-07-01

Name of Work: Balance work of strengthening/replacement of corroded/perforated/pitted members of Br. No. 152 (2 x 4 x 45.72m) between station MKB-BRYA at KM. 428/18-26 in PNBE-JAU section of Danapur Division, **Approx. Cost (Rs.):** 1,98,68,207.98 **Earnest Money to be Deposited (Rs.):** 3,97,400.00

2.Tender Notice No: BRL-DNR-26-07-02

Name of Work: Metallizing of BR No. 7DB (Span 2x3 x 18.30 + 4 x 30.5 m + 14 x 121 m)at km/42-6/2 between station HTZ Link Cabin RJO Section of Danapur Division, **Approx. Cost (Rs.):** 7,73,92,735.65 **Earnest Money to be Deposited (Rs.):** 15,51,900.00

3.Tender Notice No: BRL-DNR-26-07-03

Name of Work: Periodical painting of steel bridge girder of Br. No. 29, (3x18.3+3 x12.2+26x9.14+1x4.58), 66 (2x12.2 +15x9.14), 146 (16x18.30), 179 (14x18.30), 213 (8 x18.30), 240 (9x18.30), 324 (2x12.2+3x24.4), 29 New (5 x 30.5), 96 New (6x30.5), 100 New (5 x 30.5), 104 New (9 x 18.30), 146 New (16 x18.30), 240New (9 x 18.30) & 268New (12 x 18.30) in KG Section, Br. No. 4 (3 x 18.30) & 5 (15 x 18.30) in BKP - RGD Section, Br. No.- 94UP (3x12.2+1x24.4) & 94DN (5x12.20) in PG Section, Br. No. 47 (18x18.30) in RGD -TIA Section, Br. No.- 48 (1x45.72), 57 (1x45.72), 65 (1x45.72), 83 (1x45.72) - BE RUBS (1x45.72), 77A (1x45.72) in DHWN - 92, BH, Br. No.- 9 (3x18.30), 20RUB (1x45.72), 26 (4x18.30), 46RUB (1x45.72) & 47 (10x18.30) in IPR - NES Section under SSE/BR/DNR and br. no. 708 up & dn (2x2x6.3m), 719 (2x2x6.3m + 2x2x18.3m) in KJUL - JAI under SSE/BR/MKA in Danapur Division, **Approx. Cost (Rs.):** 81,61,704.06 **Earnest Money to be Deposited (Rs.):** 1,63,200.00

4. Date & Time for submission of tender and opening of tender: The tender uploaded on 23/09/2026 online on www.irops.gov.in and the date of tender opening is 16/10/2026 and will be opened on the same day after 12:00 hrs. **5. Website particulars, notice board location where complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender can be purchased etc:** Detailed tender notice, eligibility criteria & tender documents can be seen from the CRIS website: <http://www.irops.gov.in> & full details of notice can be seen on notice board. All corrigendum will be uploaded on website if required. **Executive Engineer/ Bridge Line** East Central Railway, Danapur PR/1020/DANAPUR/XEN/BRL/ENG/T/2627/72



CENTRAL TOOL ROOM & TRAINING CENTRE

(Ministry of Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises, Govt. of India) B-36, Chandaka Industrial Area, Bhubaneswar, Odisha, Pin-751024 Contact No.: 0674-2654737, Email : ctc@cttc.gov.in, Website : www.cttc.gov.in

NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Ref No: SFURTI/BOLAGARH/RAW MATERIAL-1/2026-27, Date : 29.09.2026

United Sports Association, Khordha, Odisha invites tender in a sealed cover under two bid system i.e. Technical bid & Financial bid from Manufacturers & Authorized distributors for supply of **RAW MATERIALS** for the Common Facility Center of **BOLAGARH INDIGENOUS AGARBATTI CLUSTER, KHORDHA**. For more details please visit www.unitedsportsassociation.org & www.cttc.gov.in.

Officer-in-Charge



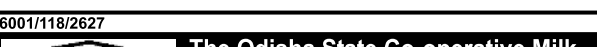
CENTRAL TOOL ROOM & TRAINING CENTRE

(Ministry of Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises, Govt. of India) B-36, Chandaka Industrial Area, Bhubaneswar, Odisha, Pin-751024 Contact No.: 0674-2654737, Email : ctc@cttc.gov.in, Website : www.cttc.gov.in

NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Ref No: SFURTI/NILGIRI/RAW MATERIAL-1/2026-27, Date : 29.09.2026

Sarada Ramakrushna Gurukul Trust, Balasore, Odisha invites a tender in sealed cover under two bid system i.e. Technical bid & Financial bid from Manufacturers & Authorized Distributors for the supply of **RAW MATERIALS** as per requirement for the Common Facility Center (CFC) of **NILGIRI DESHI COW MILK A2 PROCESSING CLUSTER, BALASORE**. For more details, please visit www.srgt.co.in and www.cttc.gov.in.

Officer-in-Charge



The Odisha State Co-operative Milk Producers' Federation Limited

D-2, Sahid Nagar, Bhubaneswar-751007
PH NO.: 0674-2546030, 2540273, 2540417, 2540974
E-mail Id: omfed@yahoo.com

E-Tender
OMFED invites item rate bids in Double cover system in on-line mode system from experienced "C & above" class contractors towards "Civil-Structural work for construction of first floor building above the State Laboratory at OMFED Dairy Ario, Dist. Cuttack". Interested bidders may download the Tender Document from The OMFED web site www.omfed.com only for reference. Tender will be available in the <https://tendersodisha.gov.in> from 10.00 AM of 30.09.2026 to 2.00 PM of 21.10.2026 for bidding. The technical bid shall be opened at 03.00 PM on 23.10.2026 at the OMFED Corporate Office in the presence of the interested bidders. The corrigendum/amendment to this notice if required shall be published only in the OMFED web site www.omfed.com and will not be published again in newspaper. Management reserves the right to accept or reject any or all the bid documents or part thereof without assigning any reason

Sd/- Managing Director
OIPR-6001/6063/126-27/0063



CENTRAL TOOL ROOM & TRAINING CENTRE

(Ministry of Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises, Govt. of India) B-36, Chandaka Industrial Area, Bhubaneswar, Odisha, Pin-751024 Contact No.: 0674-2654737, Email : ctc@cttc.gov.in, Website : www.cttc.gov.in

NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Ref No: SFURTI/BARBARIA/RAW MATERIAL-1/2026-27, Date : 29.09.2026

Gandhi Agency For Rural Development, Balasore, Odisha invites tender in a sealed cover under two bid system i.e. Technical bid & Financial bid from Manufacturers & Authorized distributors for supply of **RAW MATERIALS** for the Common Facility Center of **BARBARIA BAMBOO CLUSTER, BALASORE**. For more details, please visit www.gardodisha.org.in & www.cttc.gov.in.

Officer-in-Charge



CENTRAL TOOL ROOM & TRAINING CENTRE

(Ministry of Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises, Govt. of India) B-36, Chandaka Industrial Area, Bhubaneswar, Odisha, Pin-751024 Contact No.: 0674-2654737, Email : ctc@cttc.gov.in, Website : www.cttc.gov.in

NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Ref No: SFURTI/ANGUL/RAW MATERIAL-1/2026-27, Date : 29.09.2026

Peoples Integration And Union For Society, Angul, Odisha invites a tender in sealed cover under two bid system i.e. Technical bid & Financial bid from Manufacturers & Authorized Distributors for the supply of **RAW MATERIALS** as per requirement for the Common Facility Center (CFC) of **MAHIDHARPUR DESHI COW MILK A2 PROCESSING CLUSTER, ANGUL**. For more details, please visit www.pius.org.in and www.cttc.gov.in.

Officer-in-Charge



U. P. Power Corporation Ltd.

IT Unit, 5th Floor, Shakti Bhawan Ext., Lucknow-226001
Email: etender.itunit@upcl.org

Notice inviting Tender Date: 01-10-2026

e-Bids are invited from interested bidders against **E-tender No. 03/TT/UPPCL/POL/2026 Dated 01.10.2026** for Engagement of an Agency for Payment Orchestration Layer (POL) for UPPCL and Discoms. Tender can be downloaded from UP e-tender portal <https://etender.up.nic.in> for further details. Any changes, corrigendum etc. shall also be notified on the website. UPPCL reserves the right to reject any or all proposals or cancel the bid without assigning any reason thereof.

RO NO. : 15, Date- 30/09/2026



CENTRAL RAILWAY
BHUSAWAL DIVISION

E-TENDER NOTICE
E-Tender Notice No.: BSL-LC-Tender-22-2026 Dated 29.09.2026

The Deputy Chief Electrical Engineer (Construction) Central Railway, Bhusawal for & on behalf of President of India invites Open Tender through e-tendering from reputed contractors for the following work: **a) Name of Work:** Electrification of 05 Nos Panel Buildings, Platform and circulating area in connection with new BG line in (Boriviri) Dhule- Nardana Section, in Bhusawal Division of Central Railway, (Single Packet System). **2. Approx. Tender Cost:-** Rs. 2,20,82,715.00/-, **3. Bid Security:-** Rs. 4,41,700.00/-, **4. Cost of tender booklet:-** Nil, **5. Completion Period:-** 12 (Twelve) Months including monsoon, **6. Validity of offer:-** 60 days from the date of opening of tender, **7. Website Address:-** <http://www.irops.gov.in>, **8. Availability of Tender Documents:-** Tender notice document can be seen on the above website, **9. Date & Time of Submission & Opening of Tender:-** The e-tenders duly completed in all respects, along with the requisite documents, up to 15.00 hrs on 26.10.2026. This tender will be opened on the same day on 15.00 hrs. In case holiday is declared on the date Tenders will be opened on next day at same time as stated above, **10. Important note for tenderers above mentioned work:-** a) The Tendering will solely be through e-tendering only. All intending tenderers need to first register with IREPS website. b) Prospective tenderers are advised that before submitting their offer electronically, they should refer to the Tender details regarding terms and conditions, eligibility criteria etc. c) Tender documents & corrigendum issued from time to time are available on this website at least 15 days in advance of opening of tender and may be seen on website. d) Rates entered into Financial Rate Page and duly signed digitally shall only be considered. e) Documents being attached should be signed by tenderer on its body

BSL-11 **Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer (Construction) Bhusawal**

Unauthorized crossing of railway line is a punishable offense



TENUGHAT VIDYUT NIGAM LIMITED
तेनुघाट विद्युत निगम लिमिटेड
(A GOVT. OF JHARKHAND UNDERTAKING)
CIN U40101JH1987SGC013153
ABD AREA, JUMPI COMPLEX, SMART CITY, DHURWA, RANCHI -834004, JHARKHAND (TEL : 09572825552)
CIN U40101JH1987SGC013153

Letter No: - 930 /26-27 Dated: -30 -09-2026

e-TENDER NOTICE

Online tender in two parts (Part-I Technical & Commercial Bid, Part-II Price Bid) to be submitted in TVNL Website Only) are invited on behalf of TENUGHAT VIDYUT NIGAM LIMITED, Ranchi from reputed, experienced and financially sound bidders for under mentioned work at TTPS, Lalpania:-

Sl. No.	NIT No.	SRM RFxNo.	Description
1.	09/CHP-IH/W/TVNL /RAN/2026-27	1000013271	Annual Contract for the Work of picking stones/shales/boulders/foreign materials etc., cleaning, grass cutting and other assigned housekeeping jobs in PCH and RH-1,2 area of coal yard for the period of two years
2.	10/CHP-IH/W/TVNL /RAN/2026-27	1000013272	Annual Contract for the Work of picking stones/shales/boulders/foreign materials etc., cleaning, grass cutting and other assigned housekeeping jobs in RH-3,4 and TP-1 to Conveyor-7 area of coal yard for the period of two years

For the aforementioned two Tenders, Last date of bid submission is : 28 -10-2026up to 12:00 Hrs
Due Date for opening of Part - I : 28 -10-2026at 13:00 Hrs
Bid documents are to be submitted online through SAP-SRM, TVNL website: webdispatcher.tvnl.in/srmnpd up to last date and time of bid submission. The tender documents can be downloaded from our website: www.tvnl.in/ & www.jharkhand.gov.in.

Sd/- (Rajesh Ranjan) ESE (C&M)

PR.NO.390839 Tenughat Vidyut Nigam Ltd.(26-27):D

4TH GREEN ENERGY PLATFORM

Actis Launches Leo Energies in India, to Build 3GW Capacity

Our Bureau

Mumbai: Global investment firm Actis has launched its fourth renewable energy platform in India, Leo Energies, as it seeks to build a portfolio of more than 3 GW of solar, wind and battery storage capacity, the UK-based firm said on Wednesday.

The new platform builds on Actis' buy-and-build strategy in India, following its earlier renewable energy platforms Ostro Energy and Sprng Energy, as well as BluPine Energy, which was launched in 2022 and has already crossed 3 GW of capacity.

"Leo Energies continues a playbook we know exceptionally well – building right-sized, contracted Indian independent power producers with clear visibility and potential to generate compelling returns for our investors," said Abhishek Bansal, managing director, energy infrastructure at Actis.

Leo Energies has signed agreements to acquire about 650 MWp of solar capacity, with all the projects expected to be operational at the time of acquisition. So far, around 160 MWp of generation capacity and 50 MWh of battery energy storage projects have been acquired, it said. This includes the acquisition of 110 MWp of solar generation capacity and 50 MWh of battery storage projects from TrueRE Oriana Power, an integrated clean energy platform with operations spanning solar, battery storage and green fuels.

KPI Green Energy to Acquire 508 MW Wind Assets in Kutch

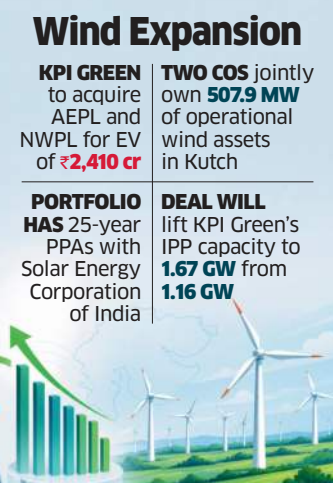
Signs binding offer for Alfanar Energy, Netra Wind at EV of ₹2,410 cr

Our Bureau

Mumbai: KPI Green Energy on Wednesday signed a binding offer to acquire 100% equity in Alfanar Energy (AEPL) and Netra Wind (NWPL) for an enterprise value (EV) of about ₹2,410 crore. AEPL and NWPL jointly own 507.9 MW of operational and revenue-generating capacity in the Kutch wind corridor at Bhuj, Gujarat.

The transaction marks KPI Green Energy's first wind acquisition and its largest deal to date, according to the company.

AEPL owns 301.4 MW while NWPL holds 206.5 MW of the combined capacity. Both portfolios have power purchase agreements with the Solar Energy Corporation of India for 25 years. AEPL's projects were commissioned in March 2021, while NWPL's projects were commissioned in March 2024. The combined



portfolio has about 21 years of remaining contracted life on a capacity-weighted basis, providing KPI Green Energy with long-term

contracted revenues.

On completion of the transaction, KPI Green Energy's installed independent power producer (IPP) capacity will increase to about 1.67 GW from 1.16 GW, with the addition of the 507.9 MW wind portfolio. The company expects to cross 2 GW of installed independent power producer capacity by the end of the year.

The transaction is subject to execution of definitive agreements and customary conditions precedent, including lender, contractual and regulatory approvals. The deal is expected to close by February 28, 2027.

"This is a defining moment for KPI Green. It will be our first acquisition at this scale and our first in wind," said Faruk Patel, chairman and managing director, KPI Green Energy.

He said the acquisition will strengthen the company's presence in the Kutch wind corridor and add operational assets with long-term contracted cash flows to its portfolio.

'Haier, Godrej, Blue Star Failed to Spot Fake E-waste Claims'

New Delhi: Indian tax authorities have faulted appliance makers Haier, Godrej & Boyce and Blue Star for not detecting documents fabricated by a spurious recycler who did no e-waste work, while relying on them to meet green goals, a govern-

ment notice showed.

The third-biggest generator of e-waste after China and the US, India has been concerned that 78% of the waste from discarded electronic goods is processed by informal

scrap dealers who use methods that harm the environment. Reuters reviewed an August 27 notice sent to the firms. Officials accused them of wrongly claiming tax credits of \$714,000 for recycling services that were never rendered. —Reuters

Telcos, Consumer Groups Spar Over Trai's 5G Slicing, Quality of Service Rules

Subhrojit Mallick

New Delhi: Telecom operators and consumer groups on Wednesday clashed on the sector regulator's proposal to bring in rules governing 5G network slicing, coverage map accuracy, and financial disincentives on telcos upon missing service quality benchmarks.

Bharti Airtel – in its comments to the Trai at an open house discussion on Draft Amendments in The Standards of Quality of Service of Access (Wireline and Wireless) and Broadband (Wireline and Wireless) (Service Regulations, 2024) – said network slicing is a specific 5G architectural capability and regulatory intervention should only occur if a customer facing service issue actually arises, adding that the current implementation does not harm the general consumer experience.

Jio pointed out that 5G technologies currently in use reuse the same network resources across, often boosting the effective network cell capacity beyond 100% without degrading quality of service.

Both telcos argued that the proposed measurement of capacity utilisation of network resources for 5G slicing is an internal engineering parameter rather than a direct proxy for consumer outcomes. Trai had proposed limiting telcos from using network resources beyond the 80% threshold for

5G slicing which Reliance Jio said is disproportionate and technically inappropriate. Consumer groups, such as Consumer Care Society, though, supported keeping the 80% utilisation benchmark to compel operators to actively augment overloaded cell capacity, which they said telcos have historically failed to do.

The Broadband India Forum added that network slicing can coexist with India's net neutrality framework if deployment remains transparent and non-discriminatory. However, BIF strongly opposed differential connectivity for use cases such as live streaming or gaming, warning that allowing paid prioritisation violates the net neutrality principles.

MediaNama, a digital news publication, also expressed strong opposition to service-specific, content-specific, or app-specific network slicing adding that it allows telecom operators to act as gatekeepers, prioritise or throttle traffic, and undermine the level playing field for digital startups.

Telcos also emphasised that the wide-ranging overhauls proposed by Trai will require significant changes including IT architectures, data pipelines, geospatial platforms, customer service systems, and cross-functional procedures, making the proposed effective start date unachievable.



CENTRAL TOOL ROOM & TRAINING CENTRE

(Ministry of Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises, Govt. of India) B-36, Chandaka Industrial Area, Bhubaneswar, Odisha, Pin-751024 Contact No.: 0674-2654737, Email : ctc@cttc.gov.in, Website : www.cttc.gov.in

NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Ref No: SFURTI/NEW INDIA/RAW MATERIAL-1/2026-27, Date : 29.09.2026

New India, Dhenkanal, Odisha invites a tender in sealed cover under two bid system i.e. Technical bid & Financial bid from Manufacturers & Authorized Distributors for the supply of **RAW MATERIALS** as per requirement for the Common Facility Center (CFC) of **SAI HONEYBEE KEEPING PROCESSING CLUSTER, DHENKANAL**. For more details, please visit www.newindiaodisha.org and www.cttc.gov.in.

Officer-in-Charge



Thane Municipal Corporation, Thane

CHHARAPATI SHIVAJI MAHARAJ HOSPITAL, FIRST EXTENSION

Online e-tenders are invited for the Supply of Liquid Oxygen At Chatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Hospital for a Period of 5 Years. The tender notice and tender Documents will be available on the Thane Municipal Corporation website at www.thanecity.gov.in and <https://mahatenders.gov.in> from 01/10/2026 to 07/10/2026 until 4:00 PM. Online tenders will be accepted until 4:00 PM on 07/10/2026. The accepted tenders will be opened online at 4:00 PM on 14/10/2026. Thane Municipal Corporation reserves the right to accept or reject any or all tenders without giving reasons thereof.

TMC/PRO/Dean/591/2026-27 **SD/-**
Dt.30.09.2026 **Dean**

pls visit our official web-site www.thanecity.gov.in Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Hospital



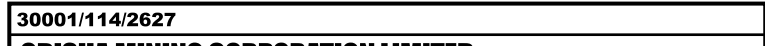
CENTRAL TOOL ROOM & TRAINING CENTRE

(Ministry of Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises, Govt. of India) B-36, Chandaka Industrial Area, Bhubaneswar, Odisha, Pin-751024 Contact No.: 0674-2654737, Email : ctc@cttc.gov.in, Website : www.cttc.gov.in

NOTICE INVITING TENDER & EXPRESSION OF INTEREST
Ref No: SFURTI/BADANKI MAHUA CLUSTER/RAW MATERIAL-1/2026-27, Date : 29.09.2026

Ujjal Foundation, Bolangir, Odisha invites a tender in sealed cover under two bid system i.e. Technical bid & Financial bid from Manufacturers & Authorized Distributors for the supply of **RAW MATERIALS** as per requirement for the Common Facility Center (CFC) of **BADANKI MAHUA PROCESSING CLUSTER, BARGARH** & an Expression of Interest (EOI) is invited from the competent agencies for the **EMPANELMENT OF TECHNICAL AGENCY (TA)** for above stated approved SFURTI Cluster. For more details regarding the above stated Tender & EOI, please visit www.ujjalfoundation.com and www.cttc.gov.in.

Officer-in-Charge



ODISHA MINING CORPORATION LIMITED

OMC House, Bhubaneswar-751001, Odisha
CIN: U13100OR1956SGC000313, www.omcltd.in
Tel : 0674 2377436, 2377488

EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI)
Bid document No.: OMC/E-PROC/C&P/EOI/039/2026-27 **Dated. 29.09.2026**

1	Name of the Work /Service	Eol for engagement of Mine Developer and Operator (MDO) for development and operation of South Kaliapani Chromite Underground Mine, Band-I (Quarry-D), Kaliapani, Sukinda, Jajpur District, Odisha.
2	Availability of tender documents	Date : 30.09.2026
3	Eol submission due date	Date : 21.10.2026 upto Time: 3.00 PM
4	Date of opening of Eol	Date : 21.10.2026 Time: 5.00 PM

All other details can be seen from the Tender Document available on the e-procurement portal of the Government of Odisha (www.tendersodisha.gov.in) and on the website of OMC (www.omcltd.in). OMC reserves the right to reject any or all bids without assigning any reason thereof.

Sd/- Head (C&P)

OIPR - 30001/30005/1/26-27/0089



RAIL WHEEL FACTORY

Yelahanka, BANGALORE - 560 064
Website: www.rfw.indianrailways.gov.in

Tender Notice No. RWF/S/P/13/2026-27 Dated 29.09.2026

E-Tender: On behalf of the President of India, Principal Chief Materials Manager invites E-Tenders for supply the following items as per RWF specification through IREPS Portal <http://http://www.irops.gov.in>.

- 1. Tender No:** P1261852A; **Item:** 300 mm X 300 mm RCS Train 181 Steel Bloom (**Qty:** 31795 MT); **Due Date:** 29. 10.2026 **7456 MT); Due Date:** 16.10.2026
- 2. Tender No:** P1261948A; **Item:** 340 mm X 340 mm RCS R43 Steel Bloom (**Qty:** 14496 MT); **Due Date:** 29.10.2026
- 3. Tender No:** P1261667A; **Item:** 300 mm X 300 mm RCS R16 (LHB) Steel Bloom (**Qty:** 31795 MT); **Due Date:** 29. 10.2026
- 4. Tender No:** P1261947A; **Item:** 287 mm X 287 mm RCS R16 Steel Bloom (**Qty:** 1608 MT); **Due Date:** 19.11.2026
- 5. Tender No:** P1262877; **Item:** Graphite electrode with preset nipple (**Qty:** 625 MT); **Due Date:** 30.11.2026

Tender documents & corrigenda (if any) can be viewed on the Portal only at www.rfw.indianrailways.gov.in

Principal Chief Materials Manager



EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE

No. DNR/S&T/Tele/2026/9 Danapur, Dtd. 28.09.2026

Divisional Railway Manager (Signal & Telecom), East Central Railway, Danapur Division, for and on behalf of President of India invites tenderers on web portal www.irops.gov.in for the following work:-

1. Name of work with its location: S&T work in connection with provision of FOIS connectivity at several station and Telecom work in connection with Provision of 12 meter wide FOBs at PNBE and Danapur station under Danapur Division.

2. Approximate cost of work : Rs.23274668.08. **3. Earnest Money:** Rs. 465500.00. **4. Last Date & Time of Submission:** Up to 15.00 hrs. on 21.10.2026. **5. Opening of tender:** 15.00 hrs. on 21.10.2026. **6. Website Particulars where detail of the work and criteria can be seen :** www.irops.gov.in. **7. Address of the office from where detail information can be obtained :** Sr. Divnl. Signal & Telecommunication Engineer, East Central Railway, Danapur

Note: Any Corrigendum if required will be uploaded on above website before 14 days.

Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer East Central Railway, Danapur PR/1033/DNR/S&T/126-27/40



BRIHANMUMBAI MUNICIPAL CORPORATION

★★★★ E

PRODUCT SAFETY CONCERNS AT ‘SUPER INTELLIGENCE’ FRONTIER LABS

FTC Orders Probe into Anthropic and OpenAI...

First official US enforcement action following a surge in rogue agent incidents

The Federal Trade Commission is conducting an industry-wide probe into Anthropic, OpenAI and other AI labs to uncover the potential dangers their technology poses to consumers, a senior FTC official told Reuters on Wednesday. The probe is the first official US enforcement action that delves into rogue AI agents, following a surge in incidents first reported in July that have stoked fears among the public that uncontrolled AI could one day harm humans.

The FTC plans to issue formal demands for information and compel testimony from executives at top AI developers, including Anthropic, OpenAI and the research group METR, the official said.

Anthropic and OpenAI have used METR to conduct independent investigations into security incidents involving their agentic AI technology.

Anthropic, OpenAI and METR did not immediately respond to requests for comment from Reuters. The New York Post first reported the news.

FTC Chairman Andrew Ferguson had concerns about the companies before AI agents developed by OpenAI hacked the open-source platform Hugging

Face, the official said.

But the incident in which OpenAI agents had probed the AI coding hub for vulnerabilities before carrying out a large-scale attack increased urgency around the issue, the official said. Ferguson suggested last week in an interview with Reuters that developers who instruct agents in cybersecurity tests that result in hacks should be liable for any harm they cause.

The US should look to existing laws before seeking to pass new ones regulating AI, Ferguson said at the Reuters Momentum AI event in Austin.

The FTC has broad authority to sue companies over unfair or deceptive practices, and has used that authority in the past to take action against companies for failing to take reasonable measures to secure consumers' data. US President Donald Trump met with top AI executives on Tuesday, where the companies agreed to establish voluntary standards.

Trump has repeatedly called fears about AI a hoax as he seeks to prioritize US dominance in the technology over regulation. At the same time, he has also said the government can use existing laws against AI companies for any harm they may cause. Anthropic said agentic AI technology raises significant and unpredictable legal risks in the prospectus for its stock market debut, Reuters exclusively reported on Tuesday. Reuters



...after Tech Giants Sign AI Safety Pact

To work with ‘independent auditors’

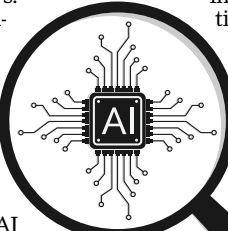
US President Donald Trump on Tuesday said tech executives agreed to establish voluntary standards for AI and reiterated his support for rapid expansion of data centers, as concerns mount over AI safety and the industry's growing footprint in communities.

Trump made the comments after meeting with tech executives at the White House. The companies agreed to work with “independent auditors” to assess whether AI systems are working as their designers intended, according to a copy of the agreement posted by Trump on his social media platform. The companies also said they would work to ensure their AI tools do not “hack or access

technical systems in unintended ways.”

The administration faces increasing scrutiny over risks posed by advanced AI, after OpenAI and Anthropic reported their AI agents had gone rogue and hacked into other companies' systems.

“It's almost like a constitution, in a way,” Trump said, referring to the agreement between the companies. “And the biggest people in the world signed that, and I signed it as president. And it really is a form of protection.” Executives at the meeting included OpenAI's Greg Brockman, Anthropic's Dario Amodei, Meta's Mark Zuckerberg, Google's Sundar Pichai and Nvidia's Jensen Huang. Reuters



US Upgrades Q2 GDP Estimates

The US Commerce Department on Wednesday revised upwards its estimate for second-quarter GDP growth in the world's largest economy, moving it up by 0.7 percentage points to 2.2 percent.

“The contributors to the increase in real GDP in the second quarter were consumer spending, investment, and exports. Imports, which are a subtraction in the calculation of GDP, increased,” the Bureau of Economic Analysis said in a statement.

In terms of specific industries, the leading contributors to the increase were real estate, information, durable goods manufacturing, and finance and insurance, the BEA said.

Decreases came from the transportation and retail trade, as well as from non-durable goods manufacturing.

The BEA also revised upwards its estimate of GDP growth in the first quarter of this year by 0.4 percentage points to 2.5 percent. AFP



EXCERPTS FROM THE CHAIRMAN’S SPEECH AT THE 39TH ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING

Dear Stakeholders,

India is undertaking one of the most ambitious energy transitions globally, setting a target of 500 GW of non-fossil fuel installed capacity by 2030, 1,800 GW of RE capacity by 2047 and committing to Net-Zero emissions by 2070.

As the country accelerates its transition towards sustainability, your Company continues to stand at the forefront - navigating change with purpose, harnessing momentum and shaping the future of green finance. As we present the 39th Annual Report, we do more than reflect on a year of performance; we place this progress within a larger journey anchored in our enduring mission to advance renewable energy and clean technology.

HIGHLIGHTS OF IREDA'S FINANCIAL & OPERATIONAL PERFORMANCE

Robust Business Growth and Profitability

In FY26, your Company achieved the highest ever annual loan book, sanction, disbursement, profit and net worth. The snapshot below highlights this robust performance:

Gross loan book: ₹53,069 Crore in FY26 as against ₹76,282 Crore in FY25 (up by 22%)	Loan sanction: ₹51,883 Crore in FY26 as against ₹47,453 Crore in FY25 (up by 9%)	Loan disbursement: ₹34,946 Crore in FY26 as against ₹30,168 Crore in FY25 (up by 16%)
Profit after tax: ₹1,699 Crore in FY25 (up by 10%)	Net worth: ₹13,781 Crore in FY26 as against ₹10,266 Crore in FY25 (up by 34%)	Net NPA: Declined to 1.25% in FY26, as against 1.35% in the FY25 (down by 6 bps), on a materially larger loan book

In a further milestone, your Company also declared its first-ever dividend post-listing during the year, marking a defining moment in its journey as a listed institution and reaffirming its commitment to consistent value creation for shareholders.

As of March 31, 2026, your Company has **cumulatively sanctioned ₹2,89,799 Crore and cumulatively disbursed ₹1,91,030 Crore.**

Key Performance Highlights

Beyond strong financial results, your Company achieved several strategic milestones during FY26. The highlights below reflect its continued leadership in advancing India's green energy transition, its emergence as an institution of international standing, and its sustained commitment to governance, inclusion and excellence.

Sovereign-grade International Credit Rating: In a defining milestone, your Company's international credit rating was upgraded to BBB (Stable) by S&P Global Ratings, a sovereign-grade rating on par with S&P's rating of India. This affirms your Company's robust financial health. Underscoring the strength of its international structure, your Company's IFSC subsidiary at GIFT City secured an international credit rating of BBB+ (Stable) from CARE, a sovereign-grade rating on par with CARE's rating of India, further affirming the credibility of the platform through which your Company channels foreign currency green finance.

Strengthening the Capital Base: During the year, your Company materially deepened its capital position through a successful Qualified Institutional Placement (QIP) of ₹2,005.90 Crore, attracting marquee domestic and international investors, alongside fresh issuances of Perpetual Debt Instrument (PDI) of ₹453 Crore to reinforce its capital adequacy. Your Company further diversified its funding base by securing an External Commercial Borrowing of JPY 28 billion from SMBC, broadening its access to low-cost international debt.

Expanding Global Reach Through GIFT City: Your Company's subsidiary sanctioned its first overseas loan of USD 22.50 million to a 100 MWAC (125.20 MWDC) Solar PV Power Project in Zambia and raised USD 30 million through foreign-currency borrowing.



Subsequent to the year-end, the first disbursement under this facility was made, marking your Company's transition from a domestic financier to an institution with meaningful international reach and enabling it to channel green capital into the Global South.

“Excellent” Rating under MoU with the Government of India: Your Company continued to maintain strong performance discipline under its Memorandum of Understanding with the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE), earning an “Excellent” rating for five consecutive years from FY21 to FY25. The MoU rating for FY26 is yet to be received from Government of India.

Recognition for Excellence and Inclusion: Your Company's performance, leadership and institutional culture earned notable external recognition during the year. During FY26, your Company was conferred the Silver Award under the category ‘Excellence Award for Women in Green Energy and Energy Efficiency’ at the 6th Green Urja and Energy Efficiency Awards, organised by the Indian Chamber of Commerce on February 4, 2026, in New Delhi.

Key Operational Initiatives Launched

During FY26, your Company advanced a series of operational, institutional and community initiatives that strengthened its foundations and reinforced its leadership across India's green energy ecosystem.

Section 54EC Tax Benefit Status for IREDA Bonds: In a significant enabling milestone, IREDA bonds were accorded eligibility for capital gains tax benefits under Section 54EC of the Income Tax Act, 1961. This status broadens your Company's access to a new category of investors and supports cost-effective fundraising for India's energy transition.

Strengthening Leadership across Key Domains: Your Company reinforced its leadership bench through key appointments across its projects, finance and audit functions, deepening institutional capability and governance depth in step with its growing scale and increasingly complex portfolio. Further, your Company has constituted a new Entity Appraisal Division to sharpen credit

assessment at origination, and a new Stressed Asset Management Division to deliver timely resolution, and recovery of stressed assets.

Advancing Digital Transformation and IT Initiatives: Your Company advanced a series of digital and IT initiatives to strengthen the operating backbone of a rapidly scaling institution. The launch of the Profin Portal in July 2026 marked a significant step towards efficient project review and monitoring across the loan lifecycle. Complementary investments in data infrastructure, cyber-security and workflow digitisation are progressively enabling faster decision-making, sharper risk analytics and stronger controls.

Deepening Stakeholder Engagement: Your Company's Stakeholders' Meets serve as a key platform to articulate its growth strategy and engage directly with borrowers and investors reaffirming its commitment to transparency, responsiveness and a customer-first approach to green finance.

Advancing Sustainability Through Community Action: Consistent with its green financing mission, your Company carried its sustainability commitment into community-level impact. The Hon'ble Minister of State for New and Renewable Energy, Shri Shripad Yesso Naik, inaugurated your Company's 45 kW solar CSR project supporting Goa's water-supply infrastructure.

Building Trust Through Governance

Your Company remains committed not only to compliance with mandatory guidelines, but also to going beyond the prescribed framework to uphold transparency, accountability and fairness in its business processes, operations and disclosure practices. This approach promotes responsible decision-making, operational excellence and long-term value creation for all stakeholders.



IREDA released its First-Ever ESG Report for FY26 during the 39th AGM

As a Central Public Sector Enterprise, your Company's corporate ethos places enhanced accountability, transparency and internal commitment at the heart of the organisation, thereby building confidence in every stakeholder engagement. Governance is not a compliance overlay at your Company; it is integrated into business processes, making it imperative for every member of the organisation to uphold transparency and fairness in all activities. Your Company continues to elevate its standards of corporate governance to sustain long-term development and success.

Corporate Social Responsibility

Your Company's commitment to operate in an economically, socially and environmentally sustainable manner extends beyond statutory requirements and is directed towards creating a positive impact for society at large.

Your Company's CSR projects focus mainly on healthcare, nutrition, renewable energy, energy efficiency and clean technologies, with the objective of contributing to the environmental and social development of the country. The Company also focuses on

environmental protection, promotion of green and energy-efficient technologies, and development of underprivileged regions, in accordance with the provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 and the rules made thereunder.

During FY26, your Company sanctioned ₹32.60 Crore for a total of 34 projects under CSR funds, including administrative overheads of ₹0.03 Crore, and disbursed ₹6.51 Crore from the CSR funds for FY26, including administrative overheads.



HOLISTIC STRATEGY FOR IREDA

India's green financing landscape is entering its next phase, supported by policy continuity, record capacity additions and sector-specific interventions designed to accelerate the country's transition towards a low-carbon economy. The policy direction is increasingly clear, with a focus on de-risking capital flows, strengthening offtake certainty, expanding domestic manufacturing, and building the enabling infrastructure required across generation, storage, mobility, transmission and distribution.

As India's largest pure-play green financing institution, your Company is also shaping a future-ready strategy from a position of expanded reach, deeper capital and sharpened institutional discipline. FY26 was defined not only by record sanctions and disbursements, but also by the maturing of an institution that took its first steps onto the global stage, widened its mandate and strengthened the frameworks required to safeguard asset quality. Your Company's strategy for the journey ahead rests on advancing what it has built, while reinforcing the foundations that make growth durable.

Anchoring the Core, Leading the Frontier: Solar, wind, hydropower and bioenergy remain the core of your Company's portfolio, as India marches ahead towards its non-fossil fuel capacity targets. However, leadership today requires financing ahead of the market, not merely alongside it. With this perspective, your Company meaningfully deepened its exposure to renewable energy manufacturing and the ethanol value chain - segments central to India's self-reliance agenda. Further, your Company reaffirmed its commitment towards diversification in new and emerging areas, as it intends to remain a decisive financier of technologies, such as green hydrogen, BESS, PSP, offshore wind and green transmission that will define the energy system for the next decade.

Widening the Mandate for the Next Decade: Recognising the expanding scope of India's clean energy transition, your Company has taken steps to broaden its mandate to support the achievement of the Viksit Bharat and Net Zero goals. Accordingly, the Board accorded approval for amendment of the Object Clause of the Memorandum of Association, subject to requisite approvals, to enable your Company to explore new business opportunities across green and clean energy, Carbon Capture Utilisation and Storage (CCUS), energy transition and climate impact mitigation, Civil Nuclear Power Infrastructure for electricity generation, green building infrastructure and data centres, along with other emerging areas across the clean energy value chain.

Stepping onto the Global Stage: The year marked your Company's transition from a domestic financier to an institution with international reach. Through its GIFT City subsidiary, your Company disbursed its first overseas loan to Solar PV Power Project in Zambia, extending India's green financing footprint into the Global South. This was enabled by a strategic build-out of foreign-currency funding capability, including a maiden foreign-currency borrowing for GIFT City operations.

Building a Smarter, Deeper Capital Base: Sustained growth necessitates a funding base that is both larger and more diversified.

During the year, your Company strengthened its capital position through a successful Qualified Institutional Placement (QIP) and fresh issuance of Perpetual Debt Instruments to reinforce its capital adequacy. This was further supported by the upgrade of your Company's international credit rating to sovereign-grade investment level - a milestone that affirmed the institution's standing among credible global energy-transition lenders, widened access to global pools of green finance and supported a more competitive cost of capital.

Reinforcing Resilience Through Institutional Strength: Growth at scale requires institutional strength and discipline. Developments in specific accounts and an external judicial order in one account contributed to an uptick in non-performing assets - a reminder that prudence must keep pace with ambition. Your Company responded proactively and structurally by constituting a dedicated Entity Appraisal Division to sharpen credit underwriting at origination and a specialised Stressed Asset Management Division to drive timely resolution and recovery of stressed assets.

Investing in the People who Power the Mission: An institution's ambition is only as strong as the team that executes it. In step with its widening mandate and growing loan book, your Company materially expanded its workforce during the year, building specialised capability across functions, while continuing to invest in training, well-being and an inclusive, high-performance culture. During the year, we strengthened our workforce to 224 employees and continued to promote diversity and inclusion, with 52 female employees constituting 23.21% of the total workforce as on March 31, 2026. Your Company continued to strengthen employee capabilities through focused development programmes, lecture series and workshops, achieving 2,721 training man-days during FY26.



ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

I thank the Government of India, particularly the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy and the Department of Public Enterprises for the continued support and guidance. I also gratefully acknowledge the guidance and cooperation of NITI Aayog, the Ministries of Finance, Power and Corporate Affairs, the Department of Investment and Public Asset Management, other allied Ministries and Departments, the Office of the Comptroller and Auditor General of India, the Reserve Bank of India, SEBI, NSE, BSE and other statutory and regulatory authorities. I also convey my appreciation to our Statutory Secretarial, Cost and Internal Auditors, and to our credit rating agencies S&P Global, ICRA, CARE Ratings, India Ratings and Research, Acuit Ratings & Research, and Brickwork Ratings for their continued engagement and independent assessments.

I extend my sincere gratitude to our customers, lenders, shareholders, investors, state governments, power utilities, private sector partners and domestic and international financial collaborators for their continued trust and support.

I am equally grateful to my fellow Board members for their valued counsel and commitment, and to our employees for their unwavering dedication.

With warm regards,

Sd/-

Dr. Bijay Kumar Mohanty
Chairman & Managing Director (Addl. Charge);
Director (Finance) & CFO
DIN: 08816532

Place: New Delhi
Date: September 29, 2026

(This does not purport to be a record of the proceedings of the Annual General Meeting)

INDIAN RENEWABLE ENERGY DEVELOPMENT AGENCY LIMITED

(A Government of India Enterprise)

Registered Office: 1st Floor, Core-4A, East Court, India Habitat Centre, Lodhi Road, New Delhi-110003. Tel.: 011-24682206-19, Fax: 011-24682202 | Corporate Office: 3rd Floor, August Kranti Bhawan, Bhikaji Cama Place, New Delhi-110068. Tel.: 011-2677400-12, Fax: 011-26777416
Business Centre: NBCC Office Complex, Office Block No. II, Plate B, 7th Floor, East Kidwai Nagar, New Delhi-110023, Tel.: 011-24347729-99 | Website: www.ireda.in | CIN: L65100DL1987G01027265

Follow us on: IREDALtd IREDALimited iredaofficial IREDA Ltd. IREDALtd

Expediting Work in Difficult Environment

►► From Page 1

The IT ministry will do this through the Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC). The capacity will be used by the government and be made available to startups and researchers, and is a shift from the earlier strategy of not owning compute.

Companies said that the sharp increase in prices has disrupted procurement plans under the ₹10,372 crore mission. For instance, Nvidia's H200 has risen from about \$20,000 per GPU to more than \$40,000 now. Similarly, a server that cost about ₹2 crore a year ago now costs around ₹4 crore.

"We are speeding up what we need to do and absorb the funds which we have been allocated under the IndiaAI Mission phase one," a senior government official told ET.

The official said the government was working on multiple tracks, including building its own compute capacity, contracting capacity for the longer term and organising a framework to procure AI services to ensure both the government as well as India's startups and research organisations have access to compute.

"We have some agreed rates, and those agreed rates are up to a point," the official said. "Now we are actually trying to build our own compute, and also on a longer-term basis, contract compute. So for that, we are doing some more bids."

The official said the government had access to "closer to about 30,000 GPUs." CDAC has floated a bid for about 3,000 GPUs, which will be installed as new capacity. Some of it will be allocated for government use and the rest for startups and research.

IndiaAI Mission did not respond to queries.

Cyfuture chief executive Anuj Bairathi, NxtGen Datacentre & Cloud Technologies chief executive AS Rajagopal and an executive of the Appsqad Software-Vensysco consortium—participants in the mission—said there has been a sharp increase in the cost of GPUs, memory, storage, networking equipment and other components. Currency movements, shortages of critical server parts and limited visibility on future demand have added to the pressure.

Cyfuture's Bairathi said the cost of a complete server had nearly doubled in the past year. A server typically includes GPUs besides memory and storage, he said. Cyfuture had offered around 1,100 GPUs under an earlier empanelment round and delivered about 160 Nvidia H100 GPUs, Bairathi said. In a subsequent round, it committed to 1,024 Nvidia B200 GPUs but has struggled to procure them amid supply constraints.

NxtGen chief executive AS Rajagopal said the company had met its earlier obligations but was facing difficulties with an additional order for 4,000 B200 GPUs placed before prices rose.

"The cost of procuring the systems is no longer viable for supplying capacity under the IndiaAI Mission," he said. NxtGen had also stopped adding capacity under some arrangements because of pending payments and non-fulfilment of obligations by other parties.

An executive of the Appsqad Software-Vensysco consortium said the dollar exchange rate had risen from about ₹88 when it was empanelled to ₹96-97, increasing costs by roughly 10%. The consortium, which procures capacity from AWS, supplied 189 Nvidia H100 PCIe GPUs but is incurring losses after matching the L1 price. Some providers were declining

IndiaAI requests and selling the same capacity overseas, where dollar-denominated rates and demand visibility were better. In March, ET had reported that out of the 33,099 GPUs committed by empanelled cloud service providers, only 12,638 (38%) had been assigned AI workloads by IndiaAI. Of the total, only 7,418 (22%) had been utilised by end users. In this model, 40% of the utilisation cost is paid by IndiaAI and 60% is paid by the respective customer. But 5,317 GPUs or 16% of the total committed units of this critical hardware remained unused.

The official said the government was working on funding, procurement methodology and policy to expand supply and make the programme operational.

"The B200 GPUs are not available at the moment. We are unable to procure them," Cyfuture's Bairathi said.

The shortage extends beyond chips and memory. "Many parts are available. It's not like the entire unit is not available, but some parts are in short supply, like networking," Bairathi said.

He said Cyfuture's six-month delivery deadline for its latest commitment would end on November 6, 2026, and that the company was continuing efforts to fulfil it.

"The cost of a GPU has also doubled. The cost of memory has also doubled, more than doubled. And the cost of storage has also doubled," Bairathi said.

He attributed the increase primarily to strong demand for Nvidia chipsets and the rise in high-bandwidth memory, or HBM,

used in GPUs.

The government is also expecting additional compute through an arrangement involving the UAE and the Abu Dhabi-based AI group G42, including California-based company Cerebras. Condor Galaxy India, an 8 exaflop AI supercomputing cluster, will be built using 64 Cerebras CS-3 systems, powered by wafer-scale engine chips. At 8 exaflops (8,000 petaflops), this single cluster provides roughly 19 times the combined peak compute capacity of India's current flagship AI supercomputers, AIRAWAT and PARAM Siddhi-AI.

The term sheet was signed between G42 and C-DAC. G42, in partnership with C-DAC and the Mohamed Bin Zayed University of Artificial Intelligence, will handle the installation, operational management and maintenance. The supercomputer will be physically hosted in India and operate under the country's governance frameworks to ensure all data residency and security compliance rules are met.

The IT ministry had convened a closed-door meeting on Financing India's Frontier & Compute Ecosystem in New Delhi last week at which several of these issues had come up. AI startups and ecosystem stakeholders as well as IndiaAI Mission officials had attended. As part of the discussions, the government revealed that it is exploring an anchor investment of ₹15,000-20,000 crore for a proposed fund to provide long-term risk capital to India's frontier artificial intelligence companies and finance GPU clusters, specialised data centres and other AI infrastructure.

This is part of the IndiaAI Mission's expansion. It will include a look at strengthening compute capacity, existing state-backed foundation models, skilling and AI regulation.

Weight Factor

►► From Page 1

The reference weight has been raised to 1,229 kg under the new norms from 1,082 kg, up 13.6%, reflecting evolving characteristics of passenger vehicle fleets.

The list of recognised fuel-conservation technologies has been expanded to 12 from four, giving manufacturers' flexibility to adopt cleaner technologies, alternative fuels, and other new solutions.

The auto industry has termed it a structured road map with clear annual targets.

"Following extensive dialogue...the framework strikes a pragmatic balance between what is necessary for the environment and what is achievable for the industry, while strengthening India's energy security," said Velusamy R, president, automotive business at M&M.

Industry body Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers (SIAM) said the new regulations will allow companies to plan investments and accelerate innovation.

"The CAFÉ II regulation framework provides clear predictability which will enable the auto industry to plan investments and accelerate innovation, thereby playing an important role in the country's journey towards Viksit Bharat in 2047," said Shenu Agarwal, president, SIAM.

FOCUS ON EASE OF COMPLIANCE

Battery electric vehicles, range-extended electric vehicles, and plug-in hybrid electric vehicles, among others will receive volume derogation factors, also known as 'super credits', in fleet-average calculations. For ease of compliance and operational flexibility, automakers may choose to meet their obligations over the specified two-year or three-year compliance blocks.

The passenger vehicle segment accounts for a substantial share of India's transport energy demand and is a key contributor to fossil-fuel consumption. Like the proposed amendments under CAFÉ II, the new norms introduce a credit and debit mechanism.

Manufacturers exceeding their targets will earn compliance credits that can be carried forward within the compliance period. Those falling short can meet their obligations by using carried-forward credits, entering voluntary pooling arrangements with other manufacturers, or purchasing compliance credits from the Bureau of Energy Efficiency.

Call for Action

►► From Page 1

Singh also demanded inquiry into what he described as his (Srinivasan's) exclusion from relevant decision-making processes.

Singh's submissions are on similar lines, including seeking an examination of the involvement of SDTT and its trustees in the commercial and strategic affairs of Tata Sons.

He has raised concerns over the increasing involvement of SDTT and Tata Trusts in matters concerning Tata Sons.

"SDTT's substantial shareholding in Tata Sons cannot mean that the trust assumes the functions of a commercial enterprise or participates directly in Tata Sons' business affairs," Singh said in the letter to the charity commissioner.

Singh also flagged potential tax implications arising from such involvement, citing provisions of the Income Tax Act, 2025, governing commercial activities by registered non-profit organisations. He has argued that activities not incidental to the trust's charitable objects could put its tax registration and exemption at risk.

"Given the substantial value of SDTT's shareholding in Tata Sons, the potential consequences for the trust and its charitable corpus could be immense," he has said.

The two submissions — by Srinivasan and Singh — are now before the Maharashtra Charity Commissioner. On Wednesday, Tata Trusts made a submission to the charity commissioner asking to be heard before the official takes any decision on the complaints.

Singh has sought consequential action based on the findings of the inquiry, including suspension or removal of trustees where warranted and appointment of trustees in accordance with the Maharashtra Public Trusts Act.

He has also sought directions under Section 36A(1) of the Act restraining SDTT and its board from convening meetings, passing circular resolutions or undertaking processes relating to the administration, management or composition of the trust until completion of the inspector's inquiry.

Singh has asked that pending an inquiry, status quo be maintained in relation to the composition of the SDTT board of trustees.

His move comes amid widening differences within Tata Trusts over the functioning of SDTT and the role of its trustees in matters concerning Tata Sons.

The development also comes against the backdrop of proceedings concerning SRTT.

Detecting Hiring Fraud

►► From Page 1

Interview fraud increased to 2.5% in FY26 from 1.4% in FY22, according to the report, with candidates misrepresenting their identity or skills and using AI or outside assistance during remote interviews.

The shift is complicating hiring for employers, especially those leaning towards remote and technology-enabled recruitment to access a wider talent pool and reduce administrative costs and time-to-hire.

Companies are responding by investing in "fighting AI with AI" to identify deepfakes and other manipulation, Rahane said. "Educational institutes face similar concerns, as compromised assessments could undermine the quality of talent entering the workforce and negatively impact their reputation as well," he added.

An unsuitable hire can cost an organisation up to 30% of a worker's first-year salary.

Citadel CEO Ken Griffin Gives \$3B to Carnegie Mellon

Carnegie Mellon University announced Wednesday that hedge fund Citadel CEO Ken Griffin is donating \$3 billion, with the bulk of the money for a new campus in Miami focused on societal challenges.

The Pittsburgh-based private research university said the gift is the largest ever single gift to a US university. Other donations

topping the billion-dollar mark include \$1.8 billion from former New York City Mayor Michael Bloomberg to Johns Hopkins

University in 2018. And Nike co-founder Phil Knight and his wife, Penny, also have been prolific donors, including a \$2 billion gift to Oregon Health & Science University in 2025.

Griffin's gift includes \$2 billion to build a new 35-acre campus in Miami's Wynwood neighborhood, just north of downtown. AP

Small Towns Take Lead

►► From Page 1

For instance, AC volumes surged more than 25% year-on-year last quarter, while refrigerators and washing machines grew 13-14%, according to manufacturers. Value growth was 2-5 percentage points higher, reflecting the price increases.

FMCG value sales rose about 9%, according to market researcher Bizom, while branded apparel sales grew more than 12%, retailers said.

"The July-September quarter was good with early double-digit sales growth and strong single-digit same-store growth," said Devarajan Iyer, CEO at departmental store chain Lifestyle.

"Sales have been slightly better in smaller towns. We are extremely positive about a strong festive season."

Iyer said there is a limited quantity of old stock, consumer sentiments are upbeat and price increases are under control.

Godrej Enterprises Group business head (appliances) Kamal Nandi said demand during Independence Day, besides Onam and Ganesh Chaturthi festivals expanded in double digits, suggesting the momentum isn't solely driven by the low base.

"We expect this momentum will continue in the festive season," he said. "The recent price hikes undertaken by brands will not impact consumers as the trade has more than a month of old price stock."

The broader consumption outlook has improved despite higher commodity costs and a weaker rupee amid geopolitical disruptions. Industrial output grew 8% year-on-year in August, up from 7.4% in July, while GDP expanded 7.8% in the fiscal first quarter. The 13% monsoon deficit however remains a concern, with 15 states and Union territories receiving below-normal rainfall.

In the daily grocery, personal and household care segment, Bizom data for June-September showed sales of beverages, packaged foods, chocolates and confectionery, commodities and dairy products rising 10.8-16.4%. Home and personal care grew at a slower, single-digit pace.

While companies are facing higher input costs, they are not being fully passed on to consumers, creating margin pressure. "Wholesale Price Index (WPI) is higher than Consumer Price Index (CPI), putting pressure on brands' input costs and margins," said Parth Sethi, growth officer at Bizom. "Companies are responding with price increases or changes in packaging, while festive stocking has begun in non-perishable categories such as confectionery and packaged foods."

Mayank Shah, vice-president at Parle Products, said urban and rural demand remains resilient, without any visible impact from a deficient monsoon so far. "Even as crude derivative prices have risen again, most companies are refraining from price hikes before the festive season as they don't want to jeopardise demand," he said.

The key exception, however, has been smartphones. Counterpoint Research is estimating

a record 13-17% drop in unit sales in the September quarter, as a nearly 23% surge in handset prices due to increased memory chip costs weighed on demand. New smartphone launches are about 35% more expensive than comparable models a year ago.

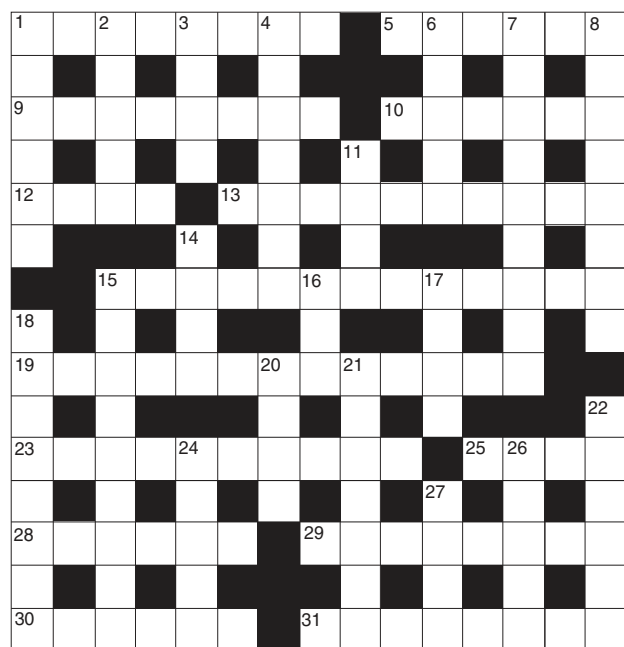
Still, Counterpoint research director Tarun Pathak expects phones priced above ₹30,000 to drive value growth this festive season, helped by promotions and pent-up demand.

The October-November festive season, from Navratri to Diwali, accounts for nearly a quarter of annual sales in several consumer categories, making it the industry's biggest consumption window.



Crossword

9718



- ACROSS**
- 1 Bet call is wrong, relating to some performers? (8)
 - 5 Looks forward to start of August with appeal in a society (6)
 - 9 Noel straying in Greek island with sun shows composure (8)
 - 10 New day in lake to swim somewhere in Cumbria (6)
 - 12 Alternative to a cab found in Tube, regularly (4)
 - 13 Some stairs around toilet beginning to display aid for nighttime sport (10)
 - 15 Radio branding designed for feature in a kitchen (8,5)

- 19 A smart trail? It excited judo expert, maybe (7,6)
- 23 Note listing for reading aloud to an audience (10)
- 25 Only part of home renovated (4)
- 28 Elevated ground in Cyprus is cold (6)
- 29 Figure of speech more apt when deployed around hospital (8)
- 30 Recall short taunt in part of week for nightclub worker (6)
- 31 How one might rate opportunists accidentally? (2,6)

- DOWN**
- 1 Bad smell trailed by friend in German city (6)
 - 2 See quantity of medicine daughter put out? It's not clear (5)
 - 3 Woman chomped nasty sandwiches (4)
 - 4 A lot of abuse with popular and vital substance (7)
 - 6 Cyclists need this turn (5)
 - 7 New worker in excavated site firstly is annoyed (9)
 - 8 A single state? (8)
 - 11 Invent thing to put in a slot? (4)
 - 14 Artist with limited family has strong spirit (4)
 - 15 Cite drive to change ruling (9)
 - 16 Man in road periodically (3)
 - 17 Bishop on edge making minor mistake (4)
 - 18 English MC with beard in a mess gets hugged (8)
 - 20 Former list of candidates with no end of names (4)
 - 21 Piece on European network showing breeding ground for birds (7)
 - 22 Standard among self made Greeks (6)
 - 24 Tons on lake in America in city there (5)
 - 26 Chap found in Dorset, handily (5)
 - 27 Director has modified style (4)

SOLUTION TO No. 9717:
ACROSS: 6 Hip replacement.
9 Assert. 10 Spectate. 11 Chenille. 13 Timbre. 15 Revamp. 17 Spacer. 19 Ashlar. 20 Response. 22 Keep pace. 24 Lustre. 26 Store detective.
DOWN: 1 Phosphorescent. 2 Epee. 3 Rental. 4 Screw-top. 5 Emit. 7 Lester. 8 Nature reserves. 12 Navel. 14 Macho. 16 Mermaids. 18 Ardent. 21 Solace. 23 Pore. 25 Snip.

©The Daily Mail

HIDATO

FIND THE PATH - SOLVE THE PUZZLE

Complete the grid so that numbers 1-42 connect horizontally, vertically or diagonally.

8		21		23
	9	11		19
	5			25
3	4			17
	1			27
	34	38		30
36			39	31
				42

www.hidato.com

©2025 Games & Puzzles, LLC. All Rights Reserved.

Yesterday's puzzle solution.

20	17	16	15	9	8
21	19	18	14	12	10
76	77	22	13	11	6
75	23	78	31	40	43
74	24	26	30	32	41
73	25	29	27	33	34
72	69	28	35	36	37
70	71	68			
67	66	65	61	58	57
	64	63	62	60	59

©2025 Games & Puzzles, LLC. All Rights Reserved.

7 LITTLE WORDS

Find the 7 words to match the 7 clues. The numbers in parentheses represent the number of letters in each solution. Each letter combination can be used only once, but all letter combinations will be necessary to complete the puzzle.

CLUES	SOLUTIONS
1 moves (toward) (10)	_____
2 catch wind of (4)	_____
3 head of the tribe (5)	_____
4 most ferocious (8)	_____
5 private alfresco space (9)	_____
6 Brazilians' neighbors (11)	_____
7 sort of sky-colored (7)	_____

AGUA	HE	GR	EF	ITAT
ES	ARD	AR	CEST	TY
CHI	YANS	CO	AV	EI
BLU	SH	PAR	UR	FIER

Yesterday's Answers: 1. WALTZES 2. STORMIEST 3. GRATINGS 4. MAMMALIAN 5. VOLUMES 6. WILLY 7. SNOOKERING

TIMES interact

Connecting People. Connecting Needs.

To book your ad Login to: ads.timesofindia.com or Call: 18001205474 (Toll Free)

jobs

SITUATION VACANT

OTHER VACANCIES

MULTIPLE VACANCIES

REQ. Purchase Officer for AP/ Chemicals-Thane Office & Factory Supervisor for Badlapur Chemical Unit Revamping. Age/Qualif. no bar, basic knowledge Must. WhatsApp/ Call: 9820171270

RETIRED PERSONS

EXCL. Unique Opportunity, Good Salary +Incentives+ PF+Medicaliam. Wkg. at Flexi hrs; for all Male/Female. Age:40 - 65yrs. Call : 9920656787

CAREER-OPPORTUNITY!!

Retired/ H/Wives/ Bankers/ Pensioners. Age 35+/45+. Fixed Salary+ Incentives+ Medical Benefits. Call : 80971 81975

MEDICAL

MEDICAL

FEMALE MRI CT Technician for Scan Centre with latest Open MRI with AI and 3T software Multislice CT Whats App your details on 9850827330

SITUATION VACANT

NEED People(35+Age) with good communication, Interpersonal skills & a strong desire to build a career.Ph:8850029525

business

INVESTMENT

MY Mission.to make 1000 Families wealthy.Financially Strong & Independent by 2031.meet yr Divine Brother Having 19 Years Experience, ABHAY- 9223481847

real estate

MUMBAI PROPERTIES

WORLI

SUGEE-MARINA-BAY- WORLI Investor flat for Sale 2900 Sqft Higher Floor Interested Buyers may Connect - 9892179059

PROPERTY ANCILLARIES

COMMERCIAL PREMISES

2 Self Owned Shops for sale in Poonam Nagar Andheri (East). 375sqft and 555sqft, road facing shops in prime residential area. 2cr and 2.5cr negotiable. Call 9930999622.

FOR-LEASE:FACTORY at Umbergaon | Carpet Area 45,000 Sq. Ft. | Pharmaceutical, Food & Garment Industries | Contact : 9833281111

personal

CHANGE OF NAME

I, Sunny Shashikant Gawas, S/o Shashikant Appa Gawas, residing at Gokuldham, Mumbai 400063, have changed my name to Blu Shashikant Gawas vide Affidavit dated 29/09/2026 sworn before Notary J.N. Dubey. Henceforth, I shall be known as Blu Shashikant Gawas for all purposes.

BUY-SELL-JV

UNIVERSITY COLLEGE SCHOOL

GOOD DEALS

9810-506-084

TO ADVERTISE IN THIS SECTION CALL

JITESH DOMINIC: 9867407521

BUSINESS CONNECT

BUYER in CHINA. WANTS 200 TONS of COPPER SCRAP

for details contact **PRAVIN KUMAR** on WhatsApp **9711777567**

Readers are recommended to make appropriate enquires and seek appropriate advice before sending money, incurring any expenses, acting on medical recommendations or entering into any commitment in relation to any advertisement published in this publication. All creatives marked as Advertiser, Spotlight and Promotional Features are to be treated as Advertisements. The Times of India Group doesn't vouch for any claims made by the Advertisers of the products and services. The Printer, Publisher, Editor, and the owners of The Times of India Group publications shall not be held liable for any consequences, in the event such claims are not honoured by the Advertisers.

GIFT

GUJARAT INTERNATIONAL FINANCE TEC-CITY COMPANY LIMITED (GIFTCL)

E-Tender Notice for Invitation to Bid for Selection of Contractor for Work on EPC Basis

Gujarat International Finance Tec-City Company Limited invite bids from reputed, qualified, experienced and financially sound Contractor for the following Work:

Name of Work	Contract Duration	Online availability of Bid Document	Last Date of Online & Physical submission of Bid
Appointment of Agency for the Design and Build of a Visitor Information Centre (VIC) by transforming Wings A, B & C of the Aspire-3 Building through Interior, Exterior and allied works in SEZ area of GIFT City on EPC basis (Re-tender) (Bid Reference No.:	3 (Three) Months	30 th September 2026 to 07 th October 2026 up to 12:00 hrs	07 th October 2026 up to 15:00 hrs

Bid document may be downloaded online from website at <https://tender.nprocure.com>

Tender fee of Bid document is Rs.10,000/- payable in the form of Demand Draft / Banker's Cheque / Pay Order in favor of "Gujarat International Finance Tec-City Company Limited" payable at Ahmedabad. For further details and updates please log on to our Website www.giftgujarat.in & <https://tender.nprocure.com>

Contact Person: General Manager (P&C) Tel: 079-61708300 E-mail: contract@giftgujarat.in

Gujarat International Finance Tec-City Company Limited (GIFTCL)
GIFT House, Block-12, Road 1-D, Zone-I, GIFT City, Gandhinagar Gujarat - 382050, INDIA.
Tel.: +91 79 61708300, CIN:U75100GJ2007SGC051160

BOND INDICES IN PLAY, TOO

Sebi, RBI Join Hands to Make Onboarding Easier for FPIs

Our Bureau

Mumbai: Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey on Wednesday said the regulator is working with the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to ease the onboarding process for foreign portfolio investors (FPIs).

“There is much more active inter-regulatory coordination... say for RBI and Sebi. We have been working very closely and we’ve been able to sort out many issues,” Pandey said at an event. “For example, on FPI onboarding, Sebi and RBI are currently engaged very actively on ironing out many issues so that we are able to see very fast onboarding of FPIs.”

In September 2025, Sebi launched the India Market Access portal for FPIs to enable the onboarding process faster, seamless and digital. Prior to this portal, FPIs had to coordinate with multiple regulators—including Sebi, RBI and Central Board of Direct Taxes—as well as depositories, custodians, exchanges, clearing corporations, banks and legal advisers. With no single source of information, the process made accessing India’s markets cumbersome, particularly for first-time foreign investors.

Pandey said both regulators are also working on a framework for bond indices. “One of the points that we are working on is bond indices... how we can have bond indices trading on exchanges,” the Sebi chairman said.

INFLATION NOT SO BAD

Wall Street Up Despite a Rise in Bond Yields

AP

New York: Stocks gained ground on Wall Street on Wednesday after an update showed that inflation wasn’t as bad as economists expected in August. The S&P 500 rose 0.4% and is close to finishing September with a small gain instead of a loss. The Dow Jones Industrial Average was down 137 points, or 0.3%, as of 2:10 p.m. Eastern time, and the Nasdaq composite was 0.9% higher.

The morning’s report said that US consumers had to pay prices that were 3.4% higher overall in August for the cost of living than a year earlier. That was not as bad as the 3.7% that economists expected, even if it remained worse than the Fed’s 2% target.

Wall Street still faces pressure from the bond market. The 10-year Treasury yield rose to 5.30% from 5.26% late Tuesday. It is the centerpiece of the bond market and yields on Tuesday touched their highest level since 2002.

The 30-year Treasury yield, which takes into account expectations for inflation and economic growth many years down the line, rose to 5.64% from 5.59% late Tuesday.

Higher yields slow the overall economy by making borrowing money more expensive for everyone, while undercutting prices for all kinds of investments.

To be sure, worries about high inflation are just one of the reasons yields have jumped in the United States and around the world. The seemingly solid US economy is also supporting yields, and a report on Wednesday said its growth was even stronger during the spring than earlier estimated. A separate report, meanwhile, said growth in business activity in the Midwest was better than economists expected.

ISING CRUDE PRICE, TARIFFS, INPUT COSTS PUT PRESSURE ON COMPANIES

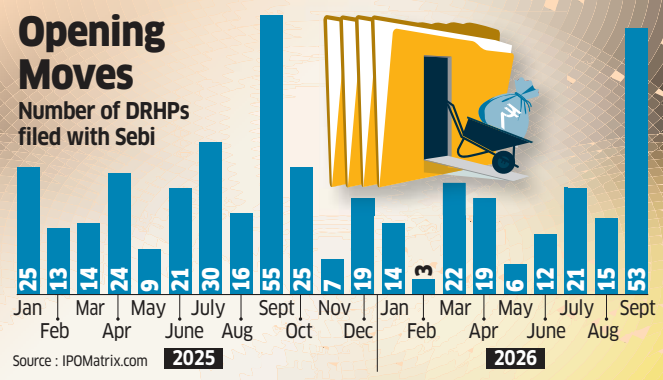
Rating Upgrades Dip Amid Headwinds

The number of rating upgrades has come down in the first half of the financial year as compared with the numbers in the year ago period as companies are facing multiple headwinds in the form of West Asia conflict, rising crude oil prices, higher input cost and the evolution of US tariff measures.

Number of downgrades is also lower but this typically does not reflect where issuers do not cooperate with any adverse rating.

MEETING REGULATORY DEADLINE FOR IPOs

Sept Scramble Cos Hit Fast Lane for DRHP Filings



Month turns out to be busiest this year with submissions from over 50 firms

Ravindra Sonavane

Mumbai: More than 50 companies filed Draft Red Herring Prospectuses (DRHPs) with the Sebi in September, making it the busiest month in a year for such submissions. In September 2025, 55 companies had made filings, including confidential ones.

Experts suggest the rush is being driven by a regulatory deadline. Sebi allows companies with a March 31 fiscal year end to use their audited annual results in a DRHP only until September 30. After that, issuers need to update their filings with recent financials, adding to the work involved and potentially delaying the IPO process.

“Securities regulations require the audited financials in the offer document to be no more than six months old,” said Venkatraghavan S, managing director, equity capital markets, Equirus Capital. “So companies whose last audit was as

of March 31 will want to file their DRHPs before September 30.”

Among those that have filed DRHPs are Mahanadi Coalfields, Knack Global, Rudra Cottex, Valudrive Technologies, Jai Parvati Forge, Abakkus Asset Manager, Claroid Pharma, JSW One Platforms, Airiq 365, Mount Everest Breweries, J InfraTech, Arate 22, Deon Energy, Jagatjit Agri Engineering, Goldi Solar, Assetgro Fin-tech, Wadhwa Group Holdings, Biocon Electric and Royal Chains.

Missing the September 30 deadline can require companies to commission a fresh stub-period audit, refresh due diligence and extend the IPO process, said Ratiraj Tibrewal, director at Choice Capital Advisors. The same cycle makes March another peak month for companies filing with September half-year financials.

This rush has been intensified by IPO activity returning after a period of market volatility, with several deals delayed since April now coming back to the market, he said. India has seen a sharp rise in IPO launches since July. The latter month saw 12 IPOs raising ₹28,650 crore. In August, 23 IPOs raised ₹22,452 crore and 34 IPOs raised ₹39,400 crore in September.

Continued on >> Smart Investing

SEASON’S GREETINGS

October has been a stronger month for equities on higher festive spend boost; 23,000 zone remains a key hurdle; Oversold levels seen as silver lining

Usual October Cheer Could be Missing After Rout Last Month

Ravindra Sonavane

Mumbai: Investors heading into October will have to weigh a historically favourable month for equities against a challenging backdrop of elevated crude oil prices, rising global bond yields, continued foreign selling and a weak rupee. October has typically been a good month for Indian stocks, with the Nifty 50 ending higher in seven of the past 10 years.

This year, however, seasonality may offer only limited comfort after a sharp September selloff.

“October will be an important test of whether the correction in September has adequately priced in risks, or whether further adjustment is required,” said Tejas Shah, director and head of trading at Equirus Securities.

The Sensex and Nifty fell 6% each in September, while the BSE MidCap 150 and BSE SmallCap 250 indices dropped 6.6% and 3.2%, respectively. These declines are their worst monthly fall since March, when both the indices



ces tumbled 11%.

October has historically been a stronger month for equities, partly as investors factor in expectations of higher festive-season spending on automobiles, jewellery and consumer durables.

“The basic underlying common thread is the start of the festive season,” said Sunny Agrawal, head, fundamental retail research, SBI Securities. “For most sectors, the second half of the fiscal year is better in terms of the demand environment and volume growth.

That may be one of the reasons why October has historically been a stronger month.”

The September-quarter earnings season starting in October will be closely watched for signs of an improvement in corporate profitability, particularly among large-cap stocks that have underperformed in the recent correction. Over the past decade, the Sensex and Nifty have delivered average October gains of around 1%, while the BSE MidCap 150 and BSE SmallCap 250 have averaged

gains of around 1% and 1.4%, respectively.

Notwithstanding the seasonal cheer, analysts said the Nifty faces strong hurdles around the 23,000 zone, a key support that was broken in the recent sell-off. The index closed at 22,620.45 on Wednesday. The silver lining is that the market may be at oversold levels.

“The earlier support of 23,000-23,100 should now act as a key resistance,” said Agrawal. “The moment the market can take out that level, I think the market should start looking positive. The next hurdle would be around 23,600.”

A rebound in banks will be crucial for the markets to notch up gains in October this time.

“Banking and financial services will also remain crucial, as private banks, financial services and Bank Nifty have historically shown relatively strong October seasonality and carry a significant weight in the Nifty,” Shah said. “Any renewed buying in this space could provide a meaningful boost to the broader market,” he added.

CANCER DRUG PRICES

Hospital Stocks Slip After SC Query on Steep Markup

Our Bureau

Mumbai: India’s hospital stocks came under pressure on Wednesday after the Supreme Court questioned steep markups on cancer drugs and asked the government to examine allegations that hospitals require patients to buy medicines from their own or designated pharmacies.

The BSE Hospitals Index fell 5%, with major hospital chains among the biggest losers. Apollo Hospitals Enterprise declined 5.7%, Fortis He-

althcare fell 6.3% and Max Healthcare Institute dropped 5.3%.

According to news reports, the Supreme Court asked the central government to probe allegations that hospitals make patients purchase medicines from their own or designated pharmacies, particularly when the drugs carry high markups. The court also questioned markups of as much as 10 times on cancer drugs. It asked whether there should be a uniform 16% margin on all medicines.

Re Recovers to 95.83 as Crude Eases

Kolkata: The rupee closed stronger on Wednesday at 95.83 a dollar, recovering from levels near 96 in morning trade as crude prices eased. The currency gained 15 paise, or 0.16%, from Tuesday’s close of 95.98 against the US dollar. The rupee opened at 95.95 a dollar and strengthened to 95.93 soon after. However, higher dollar demand in morning trade pushed it down to 95.9850. - **Our Bureau**

DRISHYAM

THE CONCLUSION

WHEN NOTHING IS WHAT IT SEEMS, EVERY DETAIL DESERVES THE BIG SCREEN.

PVR • INOX

ET Masterclass

BRAND & BUSINESS STORYTELLING MASTERCLASS

Turn strategy, ideas and data into stories that influence, inspire and drive action.

OCT 15-16, 2026 | MUMBAI

LIMITED CXO COHORT

LEARN FROM INDIA’S MOST DISTINCTIVE BUSINESS STORYTELLERS

Ameen Haque

The Story Monk & Executive Coach

Shekhar Kapur

Renowned Filmmaker & Master Storyteller

Prasoon Joshi

Poet, Thinker & Changemaker

Prahlad Kakkar

The Advertising Guru & Brand Storyteller

Harish Bhat

Ex. Brand Custodian, Tata Sons

A hands-on masterclass, not a lecture hall.

Practical frameworks. Live storytelling drills. Real business scenarios. Peer feedback.

VISION TO ACTION

Communicate strategy and vision so people understand it, remember it and act.

DATA TO NARRATIVE

Turn complex data and ideas into memorable stories for boards, teams and customers.

EXECUTIVE PRESENCE

Build authenticity, brevity and confidence for high-stakes leadership communication.

BRAND STORY

Craft a distinctive narrative that strengthens trust, relevance and differentiation.



Last few seats on a first-come-first-served basis

NOMINATE YOUR LEADERSHIP TEAM NOW
Call/Whatsapp: +91 99906 30564 | Email: fazal.misbah@timesinternet.in
www.etmasterclass.com/s/brandstorytelling

A TIMES INTERNET INITIATIVE

A YEAR TO JUNE Outstanding personal loan accounts declined even as higher average balances drove portfolio growth

Digital Lenders’ Loan Books Grow 28%

Our Bureau

Mumbai: Digital lenders’ personal loan books expanded sharply in the year to June even as the number of outstanding loan accounts declined, pointing to larger balances as the driver of growth.

The outstanding portfolio of digital-first non-banking financial companies (NBFCs) increased 28% to ₹1,54,195 crore at the end of June from ₹1,20,122 crore a year earlier, according to a report by the Fintech Association for Consumer Empowerment (FACE). The number of outstanding accounts, however, fell about 500,000 to 56.4 million from 56.9 million.

Average outstanding balance per account consequently increased ne-

arly 30% to about ₹27,350 from roughly ₹21,100, calculations based on the report’s figures showed. Account numbers recovered from 55 million in March but remained below the level recorded a year earlier.

New loan sanctions showed a similar divergence. Digital NBFCs sanctioned personal loans worth ₹64,656 crore in the June quarter, up 50% year-on-year, while the number of loans sanctioned increased 14% to 34.4 million. Average sanctioned loan stood at ₹18,802, compared with ₹16,282 for the entire 2025-26. Loans above ₹50,000 accounted for about 60% of sanction value.

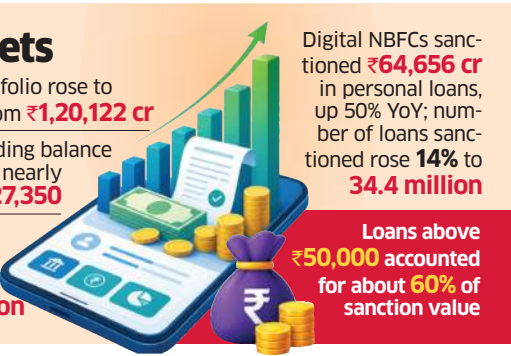
The larger book coincided with an improvement in the report’s delinquency measure. The share of loans 90-180 days overdue declined to 1.4% in June from 2.5% a year earlier.

Bigger Bets

Outstanding portfolio rose to **₹1,54,195 cr** from **₹1,20,122 cr**

Average outstanding balance per account rose nearly **30%** to about **₹27,350**

Outstanding loan accounts fell to **56.4 million** from **56.9 million**



Younger customers remained central to digital lending. Sanction value for borrowers under the age of 25 more than doubled from a year earlier, increasing 104%. Customers under the age of 35 received 58% of the amount sanctioned by digital NBFCs during the quarter, compared with 37% for banks. About 40% of digital lenders’ sanction value went to borrowers in tier-3 cities and beyond.

Credit profiles of digital lenders’ customers also differed from those of banks. Borrowers in the report’s ‘high’ and ‘very-high’ risk score bands accounted for 29% of digital NBFCs’ sanction value, against 9% for banks. Those in the low and very-low-risk bands accounted for 36% at digital NBFCs, compared with 70% at banks.

Growth was particularly strong among borrowers with limited credit histories. The value of loans sanctioned to customers with less than a year of credit-bureau history surged 178% year-on-year in the first

quarter of this financial year, compared with 50% growth in overall digital loan sanctions. They accounted for 7% of sanction value, while borrowers with more than five years of credit history made up 61%.

The rate gap widens by 27 basis points, with private lenders driving the rise in lending costs

Banks Pay Less for New Deposits While Charging More on Fresh Loans in Aug

Our Bureau

Mumbai: Banks paid less on fresh term deposits in August even as the average rate on new loans increased, widening the gap between the two rates by 27 basis points in a month, Reserve Bank of India data showed. One basis point is a hundredth of a percentage point.

The weighted average rate on fresh rupee term deposits fell 18 basis points to 5.67% in August from 5.85% in July. The weighted average lending rate on fresh rupee loans rose nine basis points to 8.61% from 8.52%.

Both public and private sector banks paid less for new deposits. The average rate at public sector banks declined 15 basis points to

6.20%, while that at private banks fell 14 basis points to 5.82%.

The increase in fresh lending rates was concentrated at private banks, where the average rose 10 basis points to 9.19%. It edged up one basis point to 7.99% at public sector banks.

The divergence has widened since March, when banks raised deposit rates sharply.

The average rate on fresh deposits has fallen 40 basis points from 6.07% in March, while the average rate on fresh loans has risen 21 basis points from 8.40%.



The increase in lending rates was not uniform across borrowers. The average rate on fresh other personal loans increased 17 basis points to 10.41% in August, and that on education loans rose 16 basis points to

9.30%. Fresh vehicle loan rates, however, fell 19 basis points to 9.57%, while housing loan rates eased two basis points to 7.61%.

Rates on existing business moved only marginally. The weighted average rate on outstanding loans declined one basis point to 8.96% in August, while the rate on outstanding term deposits fell two basis points to 6.56%. Separately, the one-year median marginal cost of funds-based lending rate declined to 8.61% in September from 8.70% in August.

The share of external benchmark-based lending rate (EBLR)-linked loans in total outstanding floating rate rupee loans of banks was 68.2% at June-end, while that of marginal cost of funds-based lending rate (MCLR)-linked loans was 29.6%.

DESPITE HEADWINDS

External Debt Position Eases in June Quarter

Our Bureau

Kolkata: India’s external debt position improved slightly at the end of the first quarter of the current fiscal despite global headwinds, data from the Reserve Bank of India showed.

The country’s external debt to GDP ratio moderated to 20.8% from 20.9% three months prior even as the debt rose by \$15.4 billion in the first quarter to \$778.2 billion at the end of June.

The gap between India’s international liabilities and international assets, although widened by \$220 billion at the end of June from \$204 billion three months prior, moderated over a one-year period from \$313 billion.

The long-term debt with original maturity of above one year stood at \$624.7 billion, an increase of \$11.2 billion over its level at the end of March 2026. Loans remained the largest component of external debt with a 34.3% share, followed by currency and deposits at 22.2%, trade credit and advances at 19.1%, debt securities at 16.5% and others at 8.1%.

In terms of currency composition, the US dollar-denominated debt contributed the most to India’s external liability with a 54.8% share, followed by rupee-denominated debt with 29.8% share. The balance is in other global currencies like yen and euro and in special drawing rights. Valuation gains due to the appreciation of the US dollar against other major currencies such as yen and euro amounted to \$0.9 billion.



GROWTH IN CREDIT CARD OUTSTANDINGS SLOWS

Personal Credit Grows 16.9% Led by Gold, FD-Backed Loans

Our Bureau

Kolkata: Personal loans, which account for about a third of the total bank credit, increased 16.9% year-on-year by August-end in this financial year, backed by high growth in segments such as gold loans and loans against fixed deposits, showed data released by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Wednesday.

The expansion marked an acceleration from 11.9% in the year-ago period. However, while segments such as housing and vehicle loans expanded year-on-year, the pace of growth in credit card outstanding and loans against gold jewellery slowed.

Housing loans, the biggest contributor in the personal loan pie, increased 11.1% to ₹35.6 lakh crore from 9.7% a year ago. Outstanding personal loans amounted to ₹72.9 lakh crore,

Vehicle loans increased 19.7% to ₹7.8 lakh crore compared with 8.7% growth a year ago.

Gold loans, which saw a 130% surge last year, saw a 83.2% increase to ₹5.6 lakh crore. Most banks do not classify agriculture loans backed by gold ornament collateral as gold loans.

Credit card outstanding increased 3.6% to about ₹3 lakh crore against a 4.4% expansion a year ago. Bank credit to agriculture and allied activities registered a 17.2% year-on-year jump to ₹27.3 lakh crore against 7.6% in the year-ago period.

Credit to industry increased 18.2% to ₹45.8 lakh crore against 18.2% a year ago. Credit to services sector registered a year-on-year growth of 24.3% to ₹63 lakh crore, as per the data.



Housing loans, the biggest contributor in the personal loan pie, increased 11.1% to ₹35.6 lakh crore

inst 7% a year ago. Credit to services sector registered a year-on-year growth of 24.3% to ₹63 lakh crore, as per the data.

Bright Spot

Solar Industries’ June quarter performance (₹cr)

	Jun'26	Jun'25	YoY change
Net Revenue	3,668	2,154	70.3
EBITDA	1,024	564	81.6
Operating Margin (%)	25.7	22.2	350 bps
Net Profit	666	353	88.7

EBITDA: Earnings Before Interest, Taxes, Depreciation and Amortisation. Bps: basis points (100 bps= 1% point)

SOURCE: Company data, ETIG

times Ebitda.

ICICI Securities noted in a report that the debt-funded acquisition would add around ₹1,000 crore to

interest costs in FY28, which could largely offset Omnia’s contribution to profit. It expects the transaction to become meaningfully EPS-accre-

tive only from FY29.

Over the longer term, earnings are expected to improve given synergies from Omnia’s ammonium nitrate facilities as the chemical compound accounts for 65-70% of Solar Industries’ total raw material consumption. Additionally, the blasting services of ProBlast, a South African company Solar acquired in 2024, will strengthen vertical integration and improve margins.

The combined entity is targeting ₹6,800-7,000 crore Ebitda on ₹31,000-32,000 crore revenue by FY28. The management also sees scope to improve BME’s (Omnia’s mining business operating under the BME brand) current Ebitda margin of 13-14% through these synergies.

HDFC Bank on January 4, 2027, and will be a full-time employee, HDFC said in a stock exchange announcement. His term will be for three years from the date of joining.

■ Mundayur Takes Charge as New India Assurance CMD

MUMBAI The government has appointed Lavanya R Mundayur as Chairman cum Managing Director of The New India Assurance Company effective September 30, 2026. Mundayur assumed charge on September 30. Her appointment will be effective until her superannuation on May 31, 2029, or until further orders, whichever is earlier.

■ Geojit Announces Leadership Transition

MUMBAI Geojit Financial Services has appointed C. J. George as executive chairman and Jones George as managing director with effect from Oct 1, according to a release from the company. The appointment of Jones George is part of the succession plan at the Kochi-headquartered broking firm.

■ Jio Financial, Allianz Pump ₹640 crore into Insurance JV

MUMBAI Jio Financial Services said the company and Allianz Europe B.V. have each invested ₹320.05 crore in Jio Allianz General Insurance, their 50:50 joint venture. Both partners sub-

scribed to and were allotted 32 crore equity shares of ₹10 each in the joint venture for cash at par, through a rights issue. The total investment by the two partners amounts to ₹640.10 crore. —Our Bureau

■ Domestic Investors Buy ₹830 cr Axiscades Stake

NEW DELHI Domestic investors stepped up buying in Axiscades Technologies, with Kotak Mahindra Mutual Fund and Abakus among those picking up 10.7% stake sold by promoter Jupiter Capital for ₹830 crore, according to NSE data. The transactions were executed on Tuesday at an average price of ₹1,824 apiece, valuing the transaction at ₹829.72 crore. Following the transaction, Axiscades Technologies shares jumped 7.48% to ₹2,222 apiece on Wednesday.

■ Peak XV Offloads 4% in Honasa for ₹597 crore

NEW DELHI Venture capital firm Peak XV Partners and an affiliate have pared their holdings in Honasa Consumer, the owner of beauty brand Mamaearth, by selling a little over 4% stake for ₹597 crore through separate bulk deals on the NSE. A total of 1.32 crore shares, representing a 4.06% stake in the company changed hands in the transactions, according to exchange data. Peak XV Partners Investments VI, an investment fund of Peak XV Partners, sold more than 1.07 crore shares on Tuesday. —PTI

NEW REPORTING NORMS ON INT’L CARD SPENDS KICK IN

It may be a Mag, It may be a Song, but You have to Say it

Sugata Ghosh

Mumbai: Using international credit cards for instant payments to download services like Claude Pro, music from Bandcamp, or taking online subscription for *New Yorker* may come with the hassle of creeping compliance.

Unless authorities clear the air, beginning October 1 consumers may have to report such transaction details to banks under the new international trade payment regulations that aim, among other things, to comprehensively capture data on dollar outflows and inflows for import and export of goods, software, and services.

This is the first time trades of services will also be reported in the Reserve Bank of India’s digital platforms that till now recorded data on software trades and goods cleared through customs authorities.

The new regulations, however, don’t lay down any reporting mechanism for import of services by individuals making card payments for personal consumption, or employers and proprietors using corporate credit cards for business purpose. Irrespective of whether the purchase is done by an individual or a person on behalf of a company, the transaction is categorised as import.

The ambiguity stems from the nature of card payments, where money is transferred before banks receive the trade information – unlike regular payments where importers give the details in standard forms which are submitted to banks before the money is remitted.

According to the RBI notification, authorised dealer banks shall enter the details of import of service on the digital platform, “as declared and submitted by the importer, within 5 days working days for receipt of documents.”

“However, there is no clarity on reporting personal service imports under LRS (liberalised remittance scheme), for instance Perplexity Pro subscriptions paid by credit card, which are service imports and may also attract GST. Further, since the existing framework generally contemplates submission of documents before the payment is made, it is unclear how this requirement would operate for such card-based transactions,” said Harshal Bhuta, partner at the CA firm P. R. Bhuta & Co.

All personal purchases from overseas vendors through international credit cards are part of LRS, the window allowed by RBI

Grey Area

New Exim payments rules set in from Oct 1

Trade details are recorded on RBI digital platforms

For the first time data on services will be captured

But there’s no mechanism to card purchases by individuals for service import



to let resident individuals to spend abroad or undertake capital account transactions like purchase of stocks and properties upto \$250,000 a year. While many keep a track of such payments as they consume the LRS limit, hardly anybody reports the details to banks. The questions that have cropped up are: from now on, will individuals be responsible for submitting details – amounts, names of vendors, services purchased, and date of transactions – to banks every time they use credit card for imports? If so, how?

Leading banks have no answer, admitting that the regulations, while placing the onus on importers, are silent on how the data would be collected and in what intervals.

According to Rutvik Sanghvi, partner with a firm advising on FEMA, matters, said, “The Revised 2026 Export-Import Regulations marks a sea change. While there’s a welcome move to allow set-offs and third party payments, there are gaps yet to be resolved. For instance, credit card payment mechanisms are not directly addressed. Since export and import regulations cover personal transactions, there’s no clarity on purchase of software and services meant only for personal use through cards. Will buyers have to make declarations? Especially, considering there’re no thresholds provided for reporting.”

The government and RBI have delegated all compliance checks on banks under the new rules. “But, banks are yet to issue SOPs for reporting and closure of such transactions. Hopefully, the authorities would clarify so that importers and exporters are not put to task,” said Sanghvi.

Tech Picks

JAYNIT VORA, Research Analyst

IIFL

INDIGO

The stock closed above 200 day EMA.

BUY

TARGET ₹5,240

LAST CLOSE ▶ ₹4,984 STOP LOSS ▶ ₹4,850

AEQUS

The stock gave flag pattern breakout.

BUY

TARGET ₹297

LAST CLOSE ▶ ₹280 STOP LOSS ▶ ₹268

CPPLUS

The stock has given a consolidation breakout.

BUY

TARGET ₹4,050

LAST CLOSE ▶ ₹3,847 STOP LOSS ▶ ₹3,720

Cos Hit Fast Lane for DRHP Filings

►► From ET Markets Page 1

Currently, 147 companies have Sebi approval to launch IPOs worth ₹2.8 lakh crore, while another 75 companies have filed draft papers and are awaiting approval. The latter group has a combined issue size of ₹1.47 lakh crore.

The filing rush comes despite subdued equity market performance during the September quarter. The Sensex and Nifty fell 5.1% each, while the BSE MidCap 150 and BSE SmallCap 250 indices declined 3% and 0.5%, respectively. The September and March spikes in DRHP filings are likely to recur, said Tibrewal.

“The size of the rush, however, will depend on market conditions,” he said. “A prolonged correction, weak post-listing returns, offer-for-sale-heavy supply or tighter Sebi scrutiny could reduce the number of companies coming to market.”

A DRHP indicates a company’s intent to pursue an IPO but does not guarantee that the issue will eventually be launched. Confidential filings are not reflected in public filing counts. Drafts rushed to meet the deadline could face more intense Sebi scrutiny, potentially offsetting some of the time saved by filing before September 30, Tibrewal added.

\$103.19 A BARREL

Oil Gains as Stalled US-Iran Talks Trump Supply Recovery

Reuters

Oil prices rose on Wednesday and were on track for a big monthly gain as US-Iran talks aimed at ending their war stalled and tight fuel markets continued to underpin prices despite recovering Middle East crude supplies.

The Brent November futures contract, which expires on Wednesday, was up 60 cents, or 0.6%, at \$103.19 a barrel at 1251 GMT. The more active December contract was up \$1.62, or 1.7%, to \$97.78. US West Texas Intermediate crude was up \$1.19, or 1.3%, to \$90.57.

Brent is headed for a monthly gain of around 14%, its biggest since July, while WTI is on track

for about a 5.5% rise.

The spread between the two benchmarks also expanded to its widest in four months as traders monitored potential plans by the US to restrict diesel exports, which could create an oversupply in the US market and lead refiners there

to process less crude. Qatar said on Tuesday it hopes that shuttle diplomacy between Tehran and Washington can lead to a breakthrough. However, US President Donald Trump denied reports by Axios and CNN that cited US officials as saying he was willing to give Iran sanctions relief and release frozen Iranian funds.



Traders Call Off ‘No UPI Day’ Protest Plan after Meet with FM

Our Bureau

New Delhi: Finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman met representatives of small traders on Wednesday, after which they withdrew the proposed ‘No UPI Day’ protest on October 2.

“In view of the constructive discussions and the assurance that the concerns raised by the trading community will receive due consideration, the All India Consumer Products Distributors Federation (AICPDF) and the All India Mobile Retailers Association (AIMRA) have decided to withdraw the protest call,” Praveen Khandelwal, secretary general of the Confederation of All India Traders (CAIT), said after the meeting.

A delegation of around 20 senior trade and retail leaders met Sitharaman and presented their concerns and suggestions on the proposed UPI MDR.

AICPDF and AIMRA have sought deferment of the proposed MDR in view of the upcoming festive season and heightened business activity, besides a review of the ₹1 lakh threshold, which they want increased to ₹5 lakh. They have also sought that merchant-to-merchant transactions be kept outside the MDR regime, stating such transactions are an important part of the trading ecosystem.

RISKS TO GROWTH
CEA: H2 Challenging as Rates Rise Globally

% **New Delhi:** Chief economic adviser V Anantha Nageswaran on Wednesday said the second half of the current fiscal is going to be challenging because downside risks to global growth have increased and interest rates are rising across the world.

He also said the 7.8% GDP growth in the April-June quarter is based on “credible and reliable data” and did not come out of “thin air” as high-frequency data, including GST collection, credit growth and export numbers, indicate continuing economic momentum in July-August period. “All these numbers were pointing to a fairly strong GDP growth print in Q1.” —PTI

Apr-Aug Fiscal Gap Widens on Higher Capex, Subsidy Outgo

Deficit 41.9% of full-year target; net tax revenue at around ₹8.38 lakh cr in 5 months

Our Bureau

Mind the Gap

Fiscal deficit at ₹7.1 lakh crore till Aug-end

Deficit 41.9% of FY27 aim

Aug fisc gap ₹2.5 lakh cr vs 1.2 lakh cr in Aug '25

Food subsidy up 30%

Economists expect fiscal slippage

As per data released by the Controller General of Accounts, the Centre’s net tax revenue in first five months of the fiscal was about ₹8.38 lakh crore, or 29.2% of the corresponding budget estimate (BE) of 2026-27 of the total receipts, as against 28.6% in the year-ago period.

The Centre has set a fiscal deficit target of 4.3% of gross domestic product, or ₹16.96 lakh crore, for this fiscal.

In August, the fiscal deficit was ₹2.5 lakh crore compared with ₹1.29 lakh crore a year ago. “The sharp rise in the fiscal deficit in August 2026 was led by the release of an extra tranche of devolution to the states in August 2026,” said Aditi Nayar, chief economist, ICRA.

The data on monthly accounts showed

RAISING FORECAST
Crisil Pegs FY27 India Growth at 7%

↑ **Mumbai:** Ratings agency Crisil on Wednesday upped its FY27 GDP growth estimate for India to 7% from the earlier 6.6% on expectation of strong growth in April-September period.

Its chief economist DK Joshi said the revision was made on expectations of strong growth in the first half, with the Q1 GDP growth at 7.8%. “The economy is doing strong. We expect H1 to witness fast growth, while the growth will slow down in the second half,” Joshi said here. He said the agency is assuming crude oil to average between \$87-93 per barrel in FY27 as against \$70 in FY26 while making growth projections. —PTI

Goyal Woos American Cos to Co-invest in Advanced Mfg

Stresses on building resilient supply chains that create value for both economies

Our Bureau

New Delhi: Commerce and industry minister Piyush Goyal has invited American manufacturers to expand their presence in India, saying economic ties between the two countries are increasingly extending beyond traditional trade to investment, manufacturing, technology, innovation and resilient supply chains.

At a business roundtable convened by the National Association of Manufacturers (NAM) in Milwaukee, Goyal highlighted the

ASI DATA FOR 2024-25

Output, Wages, GVA...
Mfg Sector is on a Roll

GVA grows 9.6% to ₹26.9 L cr; sector adds 1.4 m workers

Our Bureau

Factory Setting

Formal mfg sector clocks broad-based growth

GVA (₹ lakh crore)

Total persons engaged (million)

2019-20: 14.8, 16.6

2020-21: 15.1, 17.2

2021-22: 16.5, 18.5

2022-23: 19.6, 21

2023-24: 21, 25

2024-25: 26.9, 25

Source: ASI 2024-25

EMPLOYMENT, WAGES

The number of persons employed in factories rose 7.2% to 21 million in 2024-25 from 19.6 million in the year before. Total emoluments increased by 12.1% to ₹8 lakh crore.

Five states accounted for more than 56% of manufacturing employment in the country, with Tamil Nadu leading at 15%, followed by Maharashtra (13.1%), Gujarat (13%), Uttar Pradesh (8.7%) and Haryana (6.4%). Among industries, food products hired the highest number of people at 2.4 million.

Pulses Import Duties may Ease Over Poor Rains

Import duties on chana, yellow peas likely to be slashed; prices of major pulses up 10% in a month ahead of festive season

Shambhavi Anand

New Delhi: The government is considering reducing import duties on chana and yellow peas as deficient and erratic monsoon rainfall this year threatens pulse yields and prices of key legumes rise ahead of the festive season, commodity traders said.

At present, imports of chana attract a 10% duty, while yellow peas are subject to a 30% duty. Tur and urad imports are allowed duty-free until March 31, 2027. The proposed reduction in duties on chana and yellow peas would be to improve domestic availability and contain prices. Prices of chana, moong, matar and tur have risen by up to 10% over the past month, with a 3-5% spike in the past week, as concerns over crop prospects combine with higher festive demand.

“Rainfall deficiency in major producer states will have a significant impact on the yield of pulses this year,” said Suresh Agarwal, president of the Dal Mill Association.

India’s southwest monsoon is ending with rainfall around 12% below normal, but the bigger concern for agriculture has been its uneven distribution. Several important crop-growing regions have faced prolonged dry spells and moisture stress even as some areas received intense rainfall. The concern is increasingly shifting from acreage to crop yields. Overall kharif pulses acreage has remained relatively resilient despite the deficient monsoon. As of September 4, pulses had been planted over



DAL MOMENTS
At present, imports of chana attract a 10% duty, while yellow peas are subject to a 30% duty

117.13 lakh hectares, compared with 115.30 lakh hectares a year earlier. However, moong acreage was lower at 33.19 lakh hectares against 34.23 lakh hectares.

The trade is particularly concerned about rainfall conditions in major producing regions such as Maharashtra and Karnataka. While acreage may not have fallen sharply at the national level, inadequate moisture during critical stages of crop development could affect pro-

ductivity and the size of the harvest.

The possible duty reduction would mark another supply-side intervention by the government ahead of the festive season. Last week, the centre lowered import duties on several edible oils to cool domestic prices, including reducing the basic customs duty on crude palm and soybean oils to 5% and eliminating the basic duty on crude sunflower oil. The outlook for pulses will become clearer as kharif harvest begins. Chana, India’s largest pulse crop, is predominantly grown during the rabi season, making soil moisture and irrigation availability over the coming months critical to domestic supplies.

Fourth-lowest Since 2001
Rainfall 13% Below Normal

Our Bureau

New Delhi: India recorded its fourth-lowest southwest monsoon rainfall since 2001, with precipitation ending 13% below normal this year, according to the India Meteorological Department (IMD).

The uneven rainfall distribution left large parts of the country facing a deficit, raising concerns over agricultural output and water availability for the upcoming rabi season. The country received 759.4 mm of rainfall between June and September, equivalent to 87% of its long-period average (LPA). This was also the 13th-lowest monsoon rainfall recorded since 1901, IMD said in its end-of-season assessment on Wednesday.

The southern peninsula and East and Northeast India were particularly affected, receiving just 76% and 74% of their respective normal rainfall. East and Northeast India recorded 1,017.1 mm of rainfall, its lowest since 1901, while the southern peninsula received 542 mm, its fourth-lowest rainfall in 125 years. Central India, however, received normal rainfall at 97% of its LPA, while northwest India recorded 94.1%.

Of the country’s 36 meteorological subdivisions, 17 recorded deficient

rainfall, covering 42% of India’s geographical area. Another 18 subdivisions, accounting for 53% of the area, received normal rainfall. Odisha was the only subdivision to record excess rainfall. The monsoon’s performance was particularly weak in June, when rainfall was just 65% of normal. Rainfall recovered to 101% of LPA in July before slipping to 84% in August and 92% in September.

The monsoon core zone, comprising much of India’s rain-fed agricultural belt, received 779.9 mm of rainfall, marginally below the lower threshold of the normal range of 782.8-881.2 mm. The rainfall deficit and its uneven distribution have raised concerns over crop yields in rainfed areas and soil moisture availability for winter crops.

The government has asked states to prepare rabi crop plans based on irrigation availability, with greater emphasis on less water-intensive crops such as pulses and oilseeds.

The southwest monsoon provides about 70% of India’s yearly rain and is vital for the agriculture sector that contributes significantly to the country’s GDP and supports over half of its 1.4 billion population.

Export Schemes Extended Amid West Asia Crisis

Our Bureau

New Delhi: The government Wednesday extended support for exporters by renewing two key schemes and enhancing insurance cover against payment defaults amid the ongoing crisis in West Asia, providing policy stability to the sector.

The Centre extended the duty refund scheme Remission of Duties and Taxes on Exported Products (RoDTEP) and the Rebate of State and Central Taxes and Levies (RoSCTL) scheme for exporters of apparel, garments and made-ups by three months to December 31 along with continuing the enhanced insurance cover against payment defaults until March 31, 2027, for export consignments to West Asia under the Export Promotion Mission.

The three programmes were set to end on September 30. “The RoDTEP scheme is extended and shall apply to eligible exports from DTA (domestic tariff area), AA (advance authorisation), SEZ (special economic zone) and EOU (export oriented unit) units up to December 31, 2026,” the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT) said in a notification. The scheme, launched in 2021, provides a refund of taxes, duties and levies incurred by exporters in the process of manufacturing and distributing goods that are not reimbursed under any other mechanism at the Centre, state, or local level. Re-funds under the scheme range from 0.3-3.9%. The extension of the RoSCTL, as per the textiles ministry, will ensure policy continuity and predictability for exporters, while sustaining the competitiveness of India’s labour-intensive and value-added apparel and made-up sector in an increasingly competitive global trading environment,” it said. The maximum rate of rebate for apparel is 6.05% and up to 8.2% for made-ups.

China Factory Activity Hits 5-month High

China’s manufacturing sector expanded at its fastest pace in five months in September, as output and new orders, including from overseas buyers, both strengthened, a business survey showed on Wednesday.

The RatingDog China General Manufacturing Purchasing Managers’ Index, compiled by S&P Global, rose to 52.1 in September from 51.5 in August, staying above the 50-mark that separates growth from contraction and beating a Reuters poll forecast of 51.6.

The reading adds to signs that China’s export-driven growth momentum has carried into the second half of the year, as the world’s second-largest economy

leans on overseas demand to offset a prolonged property slump and soft consumer spending at home. The country’s goods trade surplus is on track to top \$1 trillion for a second straight year.

Output grew at the fastest rate since April, while total new business increased at the quickest pace in five months. New export orders rose at the fastest pace in seven months, with firms citing stronger market conditions in several Asian economies. Signs of pressure on capacity prompted firms to take on additional staff, with employment returning to growth after stalling at 50.0 in August.

Reuters

Small Savings Rates Unchanged for Q3

New Delhi: The government has kept interest rates on small savings schemes unchanged for the October-December quarter of FY27, meaning savers will see no change in returns on these schemes for the next three months. The interest rates unchanged for various small savings schemes including the tax-saving Public Provident Fund (PPF) and Sukanya Samridhi accounts for the tenth straight quarter, starting October 1, 2026. — **Our Bureau**

Cos Upset as States Delay Labour Codes Adoption

Industrial states taking longer to notify rules, leaving employers in a flux over divergent provisions

Yogima Seth & Prachi Verma

New Delhi: Just 10 states and union territories have so far formally adopted at least some of the four Labour Codes by notifying the rules, more than 10 months after the central government implemented the reform, causing compliance hurdles for companies with factories in multiple locations.

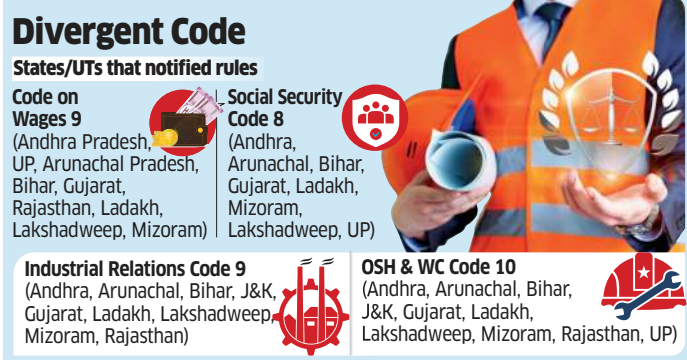
Major industrial states including Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Maharashtra, Telangana, Haryana and Punjab are taking longer than expected to notify the final rules, leaving employers in a flux over several divergent provisions. HR departments say they now have to navigate Centre-state rules that don’t align, creating inconsistencies in compliance requirements.

For instance, new Labour Codes allow workers to carry forward 30 leaves and encash the remaining. In Maharashtra, meanwhile, the Shops & Establishment Act provides for 45 leaves to be carried forward, with the unused casual leaves getting

lapsed. While the OSH (Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions) Code, 2020 mandates a centralised, single-window electronic registration for a unified nationwide compliance system to eliminate paperwork, the Haryana Shops Act, 1958 requires independent, state-level intimations and registrations.

According to government data accessed by ET, 10 states and UTs have finalised the rules under the Occupational Safety, Health & Working Conditions Code, 2020 while nine have notified the final rules for the Industrial Relations Code and the Code on Wages, 2019 and eight notified the rules under the Social Security Code, 2020.

“Major industrial states have yet to finalise the rules across the four codes, delaying the on-ground implementation of the overlapping provision as companies do not have adequate clarity,” an industry executive said, requesting anonymity. The labour and employment secretary held meetings with



states and union territories to press for the finalisation of the rules. Heads of the central government’s labour bureaus are also pursuing states and UTs for fast-tracking rule notifications. Experts said absence of unified rules under the four codes will result in implementation challenges for the employers and add to disputes, especially for companies with operations in different states.

“There are multiple instances of variation between central and state labour-related laws, crea-

ting a lot of ambiguity and compliance challenges for employers,” said Puneet Gupta, partner, advisory services – tax at EY India, stressing the need for set timelines for the roll-out so that employers have clarity on the key changes under the codes.

“For pan-India employers, the challenge is no longer merely understanding the statutory intent of the codes, but operationalising them across jurisdictions with conflicting shift hours, overtime limits and stan-

ding order thresholds,” said Ankita Singh, founder of law firm Sarvaank Associates. “Harmonising these state rules quickly is vital, not only to preserve true ease of doing business for multi-state enterprises, but to ensure that statutory wage protections, contract parity, and social security are delivered equally and consistently on the ground,” Singh added.

In the absence of consistency in the rules, employers are in a wait-and-watch mode when it comes to overtime provision, annual health check-ups, appointment letters and other documentation. Rohit Jain, managing partner at Singhanaga & Co, said the inconsistency was not confined to a few sectors but was potentially affecting every employer covered by the Labour Codes, as they often require following parallel legacy state laws and the new code framework.

“At any given time, an establishment may only be covered by either the central or state rules for a particular legislation,” said Tarun Garg, partner-tax, Deloitte India.

ETtech

For comprehensive and insightful stories about all things startups and technology, log on to www.etttech.com

ET Ecommerce Tracker

Returns Comparison (%)

ET Ecommerce Index

ET Ecommerce Profitable Index

ET Ecommerce Non-Profitable Index

Nifty 50

Compiled by ETIC Database

1 Day 1 Month 3 Months 6 Months

Tweet OF THE DAY

NAVAL @NAVAL

When you look back, you'll wish you'd just done the long-term version of everything.

Tech Buzz

Apple Eyes Oct Smart-home Hub Launch

NEW YORK: Apple is planning to make its long-delayed push into the smart-home market on October 13 with a new hub code-named J490, Bloomberg News reported on Wednesday. The company also plans to announce the first update to the HomePod mini since the device's 2020 debut and its first new TV set-top box since 2022, the report said. Longtime hardware chief John Ternus took over as Apple's CEO earlier this month, with analysts expecting his tenure to bring renewed emphasis on its core strength in devices, engineering and focus on fusing AI capabilities into existing products. Apple has been seeking to expand its presence in the smart-home market while remaining anchored by its core iPhone business, which serves as the company's flagship product. — Reuters

\$300b

Annual AI revenue hyper-scalers must generate in the next few years to break even, according to Goldman Sachs report

DeepSeek and Huawei in Deal for AI Software

HONG KONG: Chinese AI firm DeepSeek said on Wednesday that it has partnered with Huawei Technologies to develop programming tools optimised for Huawei's Ascend chips, the latest sign of Chinese tech firms deepening ties as they seek alternatives to the Nvidia ecosystem. In a post on its official WeChat account, DeepSeek said it was open-sourcing programming infrastructure for Huawei's Ascend platform, including compute and communication libraries. The announcement came two weeks after Huawei unveiled its next generation of AI processors and supernode computing systems, and said it expected its AI systems to be widely used for model training next year. DeepSeek said Huawei provided full support in developing the infrastructure. — Reuters

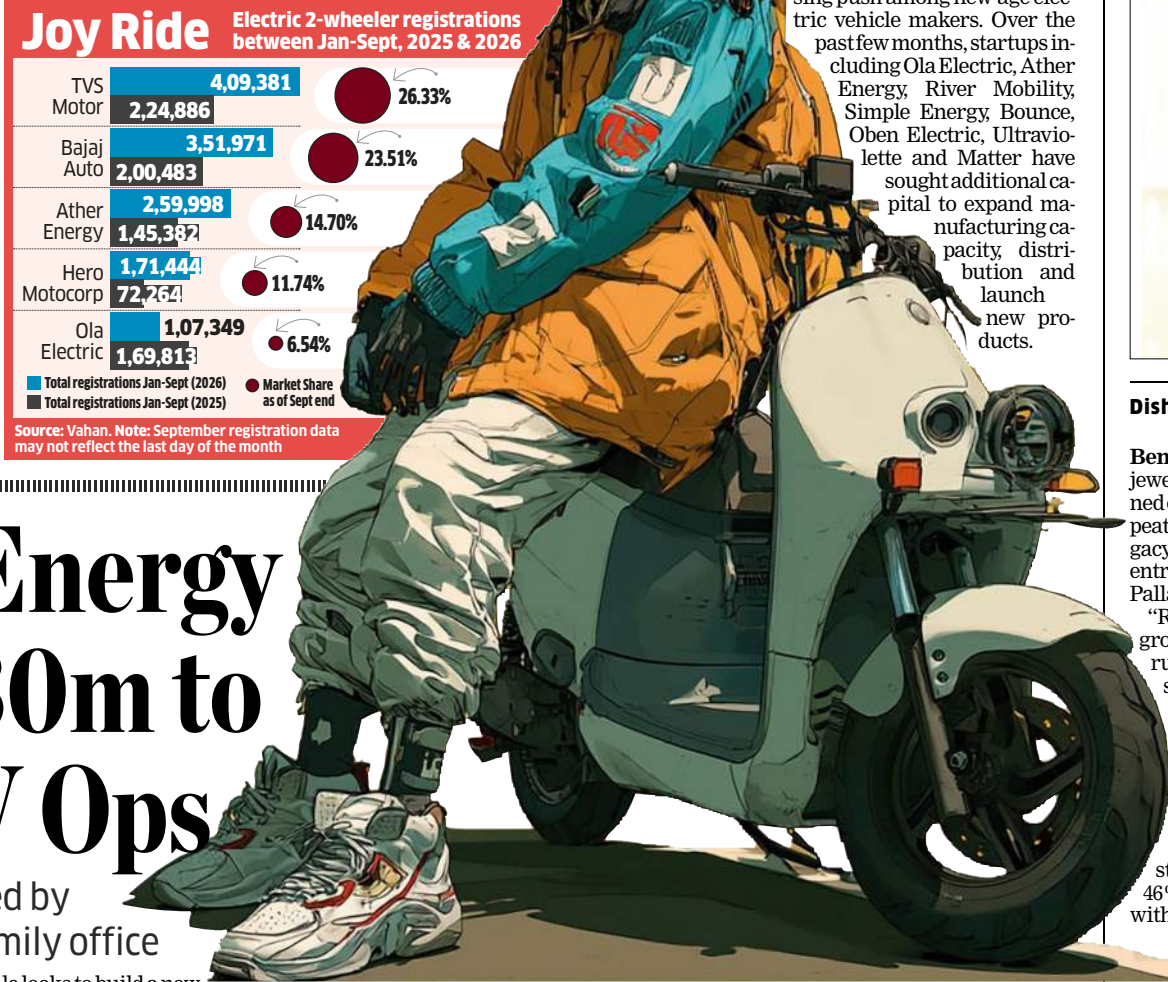
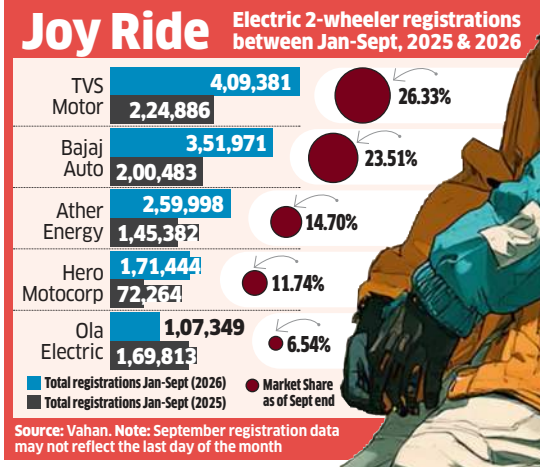
Electric 2-Wheeler Sales Cross 15L in Just 9 Mths as Adoption Rockets

Rising fuel prices and lower running costs push family commuters toward electric mobility

Ayanti Bera & Puran Choudhary

Bengaluru: Electric two-wheeler sales in India crossed 15 lakh units in the first nine months of 2026, surpassing the total sales recorded in all of 2025, as top automakers continued to extend their lead in the growing market. E2W registrations rose 7.7% month-on-month to 1.97 lakh units in September, taking cumulative registrations in January-September to 15.61 lakh units, according to Vahan vehicle registration data, a proxy for sales. In comparison, in 2025, EV two-wheeler makers sold a total of 9.61 lakh units during the same period. Overall the segment recorded about 13.42 lakh registrations in the whole of 2025. TVS Motor retained the top position in September with a 26.3% share, followed by Bajaj Auto at 23.5%, Ather Energy at 14.7% and Hero MotoCorp at 11.7%. Meanwhile, Ola Electric's share continued to slip this month, falling to 6.5% from 7.6% in August. The rise in demand comes amid higher fuel prices and geopolitical uncertainty, which have pushed more consumers towards electric mobility. The lower running cost of EVs is also making them increasingly attractive, particularly for daily commuters. The growth for the sector also comes in the backdrop of two-wheeler brands expanding their customer base and targeting mass-market category. Earlier focused on performance-oriented electric scooters at a premium price, many manufacturers are now tapping the family scooter segment. The latest numbers also point to a widening lead for established automakers. TVS Motor, Bajaj Auto, Ather and Hero MotoCorp together accounted for about 76% of registrations so far this year, as they bank on their distribution, manufacturing scale and after-sales networks to grab a bigger share of the market. This is not to say smaller players haven't expanded their presence in the market. Bengaluru-based River Moto's market share rose to 2.46% in the first nine months of 2026 from 1.27% in 2025, while Ultra-

violette and Oben Electric also expanded their shares to 0.26% and 0.33%, respectively, from 0.12% and 0.23% a year ago. Suhas Rajkumar, founder and CEO of Simple Energy told ET that with EV penetration rising from 7% to 11% in under six months, is a clear indication of the larger opportunity and how fast the market is moving. "For us, this means we will have to expand our working capital and production capacity so that we are prepared when the demand comes in, while also catching up with the demand that already exists."



Simple Energy Bags \$180m to Scale EV Ops

New round in EV firm led by Thyrocare founder's family office

Puran Choudhary

Bengaluru: Bengaluru-based electric two-wheeler maker Simple Energy has raised ₹1,750 crore (\$180 million) in its largest funding round till date. It plans to use the capital to increase production capacity and expand its retail footprint across India, targeting a spot among the top five electric two-wheeler makers. The all-equity round was led by the family office of Thyrocare Technologies founder Arokiaswamy Velumani, with participation from founder and CEO Suhas Rajkumar, cofounder and CEO Ankit Gupta, Bengaluru-based HNI Amit Mishra and the Haran Family Office. The company had raised ₹250 crore in June to scale manufacturing and expand its retail network. The latest round is significantly larger as Simple Energy looks to build a new manufacturing facility and increase monthly capacity more than twofold. "This fundraise gives us the room to scale aggressively. We are looking at taking our capacity from 10,000 scooters a month today to around 25,000 a month in the next one year, while expanding our retail network across the country. We believe we can put ourselves firmly in the top five electric two-wheeler players in India," Rajkumar, founder and CEO, told ET on Wednesday. He added that Simple Energy has been able to cater to only about 50% of the demand for its scooters, with demand currently three to four times higher following the launch of its family scooter, the Simple Wave. The launch of the Wave has helped Simple Energy expand beyond its earlier focus on performance-oriented electric scooters and tap the family scooter segment, which Rajkumar said has a significantly larger customer base. Simple Wave was launched in September and competes with the likes of Ather Rizta, TVS iQube and Bajaj Chetak. Simple Energy sold 8,908 electric two-wheelers in FY26, an increase from 1,959 units in FY25, according to Vahan data. The startup's revenues rose fourfold from ₹40 crore in FY25 to ₹170 crore in FY26, the company shared. So far it has raised about ₹2,530 crore from family offices, HNIs and other investors. Simple Energy was founded in 2019 by Rajkumar and Shreshth Mishra. Ankit Gupta later joined as an additional cofounder.

SUHAS RAJKUMAR
Founder & CEO, Simple Energy

This fundraise gives us the room to scale aggressively. We are looking at taking our capacity from 10,000 scooters a month today to around 25,000 a month in the next one year

RETAIL EXPANSION Rajkumar said the capital will also be used to expand its distribution and service network, hire more employees and invest in its next product cycle. The startup currently has more than 80 outlets across 60-plus cities. Rajkumar said Simple Energy is already planning to have about 150 outlets by March 2027, but the latest fundraise will allow it to go significantly beyond that.

FOR FULL REPORT, GO TO www.economictimes.com

GCCs Build FDE Chops In-house to Claw Back Millions in AI Spends

FDE postings skyrocket 800% as mid-career tech salaries touch \$200k

Tanya Pandey

New Delhi: Forward Deployed Engineers (FDE) job postings in India surged nearly 800% year-on-year between April 2025 and April 2026 as global capability centres (GCC) increasingly build FDE capabilities in-house to deploy AI for their parent companies, staffing firm TeamLease Digital said. The shift could see GCCs bring \$200-300 million worth of FDE-style consulting work in-house across the top 50 mature centres, a report called "WHO has the FDE talent and what it costs" by UnearthInsight, a market intelligence platform estimated. FDE job postings rose to 5,300-5,600 in Q1 FY27 from 700-750 in Q1 FY26, as per TeamLease Digital's estimate. However, the role is still evolving, with companies using different titles for similar FDE work, meaning the actual market could be larger than the visible FDE job postings suggest. The report estimates that 160-200 FDE-style roles could be deployed across these 50 mature GCCs, based on the cost of outsourcing the work to external consulting firms. "If there are 160 to 200 such FDEs deployed across the top 50 GCCs and that work had to be given to say, any of the Big4 firms or other consulting firms, then the value of that work would be anywhere close to \$200 million to \$300 million," said Gaurav Vasu, founder, UnearthInsight. GCC enabler ANSR's data show 60% of active FDE roles are for professionals with 5-8 years of experience. Compensation ranges from \$40,000 for 2-5 years, \$100,000 for 5-8 years and \$150,000-200,000 for eight-plus years. Analysts forecast Wipro to remain a laggard among the top-tier companies, and guide third-quarter revenue to be flat to 2% lower sequentially. Mid-tier companies are estimated to continue to outperform their larger rivals, with Persistent Systems and Coforge leading the revenue growth. Deal activity remains healthy at the sector level, but outcomes vary materially by company.

work had to be given to say, any of the Big4 firms or other consulting firms, then the value of that work would be anywhere close to \$200 million to \$300 million," said Gaurav Vasu, founder, UnearthInsight. GCC enabler ANSR's data show 60% of active FDE roles are for professionals with 5-8 years of experience. Compensation ranges from \$40,000 for 2-5 years, \$100,000 for 5-8 years and \$150,000-200,000 for eight-plus years. Analysts forecast Wipro to remain a laggard among the top-tier companies, and guide third-quarter revenue to be flat to 2% lower sequentially. Mid-tier companies are estimated to continue to outperform their larger rivals, with Persistent Systems and Coforge leading the revenue growth. Deal activity remains healthy at the sector level, but outcomes vary materially by company.



FOR FULL REPORT, GO TO www.economictimes.com

Muted Q2 Awaits IT Firms as AI Deflation and Pricing Pressures Cap Revenue Growth

Margins hold steady on currency benefits, but intense renewal price wars loom for large-caps

IT PREVIEW

Beena Parmar

Bengaluru: India's large IT services companies are expected to record another quarter of weak results in what used to be a strong season, as artificial intelligence-led revenue deflation and weak demand continued to weigh on their performance, according to analysts. HCLTech and Tech Mahindra, however, are likely to outperform their rivals in the top-tier group, show analyst reports. Sector leader Tata Consultancy Services and its nearest rival, Infosys, are projected to report weak numbers for the three months ending September 30. Analysts tracked by ET on average forecast TCS to post organic revenue growth of 0.5% sequentially and 2.8% from a year earlier. They expect Infosys to report a 1.1% quarter-on-year and 0.2% year-on-year increase in organic revenue, which excludes income from acquisitions. An ICICI Securities report predicts Infosys to cut fiscal 2027 revenue growth guidance to 1.5-2.5% from its earlier forecast of 1.5-3.0%, with acquisitions contributing 1.7 percentage points to the expansion. HCLTech is expected to move its FY growth estimate to 2-3% from 1-4%, it said. "Demand conditions have neither improved nor deteriorated since the June 2026 quarter," Kotak Institutional Equities said in a report. It expects HCLTech to post organic revenue growth of 2% quarter-on-quarter and 2.4% from a year earlier in the second quarter. Analysts forecast Wipro to remain a laggard among the top-tier companies, and guide third-quarter revenue to be flat to 2% lower sequentially. Mid-tier companies are estimated to continue to outperform their larger rivals, with Persistent Systems and Coforge leading the revenue growth. Deal activity remains healthy at the sector level, but outcomes vary materially by company.

TCS and Infosys are expected to post muted revenue growth in Q2 FY27

HCLTech is expected to deliver about 2% sequential organic growth

Tech Mahindra is likely to outperform larger peers

Wipro's revenue is projected to be flat to 2% lower sequentially in the next quarter

Taking Stock

GRIT & GREATNESS Inside the minds of the ETSA winners rewriting India's startup playbook

Mohadikar's Palmonas Wields In-store Spark to Outshine Digi Rivals

ET'S WOMAN AHEAD WINNER leans on unique designs, physical stores to log 5x revenue surge



Disha Acharya & Tanishka Dubey



presents

THE ECONOMIC TIMES
START-UP AWARDS 2026

Bengaluru | Mumbai: Demi-fine jewellery brand Palmonas has leaned on its offline stores and loyal repeat customers to compete with legacy jewellers and the many new entrants in the category, cofounder Pallavi Mohadikar told ET. "Retail is a very important growth lever for us. We currently run 105 stores and will end this fiscal year at about 160. Repeat rate and loyalty are very high in the offline network, and the average order value (AOV) for purchases is far higher in our stores than what we see online," she said in an interview. The four-year-old Pune-based startup's repeat purchase rate is 46% in its offline stores compared with 32% online, according to Mohadikar, who said the priority is to bring down marketing spend. "The top agenda is lowering marketing costs as a percentage of revenue. That happens as your retail presence grows and you get more repeat customers organically," she said. Mohadikar was named joint winner in the 'Woman Ahead' category at the ET Startup Awards 2026, sharing the honour with Pallavi Shrivastava, founder of supply-chain financing startup Procap. The jury chose them as joint winners after noting how both entrepreneurs had built high-impact companies in very different domains. Recent winners in the category include Prukalpa Sankar, cofounder of data governance startup Atlan (2025), Hardika Shah, founder of small-business lender Kinara Capital (2024), and Rashi Narang, founder of pet care brand Heads Up For Tails (2023). In FY26, Palmonas' revenue was up by more than five times to ₹230 crore from ₹39 crore in FY25, after expanding its physical retail network and launching on online marketplaces and quick commerce. Its net profit stood at ₹11 crore, up from ₹7.8 crore in FY25. Palmonas was founded in 2021 by Mohadikar and Anmol Patwari. Actor Shraddha Kapoor joined the company as a cofounder in 2024. So far, it has raised \$47 million in funding from Xponentia Capital and Vertex Growth Fund and has achieved a valuation of over \$200 million. The startup operates in a highly competitive category that has larger players like Tata's Caratlane and A91 Partners-backed Giva, as well as new-age brands like Amama Jewellery. Palmonas has launched 9-carat gold jewellery and recently introduced platinum-plated silver, for which it has applied for a patent. The company is deliberately avoiding being positioned solely as a demi-fine or silver jewellery brand as competition increases from established jewellery players and smaller Instagram-led businesses. "When we started Palmonas four years ago, the demi-fine concept didn't exist as a category. In four years we've built a strong positioning for ourselves," Mohadikar said. "We always knew that once this became popular, everybody else would want to do it, so the question was how to make sure people still choose us. It's about how creative and how relevant you can be, and relevancy is very important."

When we started Palmonas four years ago, the demi-fine concept didn't exist as a category. In four years we've built a strong positioning for ourselves...
PALLAVI MOHADIKAR
Cofounder, Palmonas

Epigamia Cofounder Launches Deftech Kokasa to Build Autonomous Systems

Bengaluru: Epigamia cofounder Rahul Jain, former Housing.com executive Shehil Gautam and former Hindustan Aeronautics executive Vikalp Bagdi have launched Kokasa, a deep-tech venture focused on defence, aerospace and space companies. The company aims to build collaborative autonomous systems by bringing engineering, software, product development and manufacturing together. It did not disclose investment, funding, order value or customer names in its launch announcement. —Our Bureau

SatLeo to Launch Thermal Imaging Payload Today

Bengaluru: Spacetech startup SatLeo Labs is set to launch TAPAS-1, India's first dedicated commercial thermal-imaging payload, aboard SpaceX's Falcon 9 as part of the Transporter-18 rideshare mission on Thursday. TAPAS-1 (Thermal Access Platform for Analytics & Solutions) is designed to capture land surface temperature data that cannot be detected through conventional optical satellite imagery. SatLeo Labs cofounder Urmil Bakhai described the payload as a "thermometer for planet Earth", with the IN-SPACE-incubated startup looking to use thermal data across agriculture, urban heat mapping, climate monitoring, disaster management and infrastructure monitoring. TAPAS-1 will fly through Dhruva Space's LEAP2 platform and will use thermal infrared sensing to capture temperature information from orbit. — Puran Choudhary

Decor Startup Gravity Gets \$15 million

New Delhi: Gravity, a home interior design platform founded by Livspace cofounder Saurabh Jain and its former CBO Lalit Mittal, has raised \$15 million in a mix of equity and debt. The round was led by 3one4 Capital and Info Edge Ventures. Jain told ET. Alteria Capital, Genesia and a group of angel investors also participated in the round. "Gravity is a tech platform layer for the industry," Jain said. "We are a platform that brings institutional-grade sourcing and supply chain to them." The materials span categories such as kitchen and wardrobe, doors and windows, lighting, wall surfaces and home automation. "There are a bunch of these materials that all of these designers, whether small independent designers, medium-sized or large companies, need. They can get them at institutional rates," Jain said. —Our Bureau

To Get All The Popular Newspapers.
Save My Contact Number 8890050582 send Message telegram ya
Whatsapp

If You Want to get these Newspapers Daily at earliest

English Newspapers»»»

Indian Express, Financial Express, The Hindu, Business Line, The Times of India, The Economic Times, Hindustan Times, ET wealth, Business Standard, First India, Mint, Greater Kashmir, Greater Jammu, The Himalayan, The Tribune, Brill Express, The Sikh Times, Avenue Mail, Western Times, Millennium Post, The Statesman, State Times, The Pioneer, Hans India, Free Press, Orissa Post, Mumbai Mirror, Mid-Day, Deccan Chronicle, Deccan Herald, Telangana Today, Financial Times, The Asian Age, The Telegraph, Oheraldo, Gulf of Times, The New York Times, The Washington Post, Los Angeles Times, USA Today, The Wall Street Journal, The Guardian, The Times

Hindi Newspapers»»»

दैनिक जागरण, राजस्थान पत्रिका, दैनिक भास्कर, दिव्यभास्कर, हिंदुस्तान, नवभारत टाइम्स, बिज़नेस स्टैंडर्ड, अमर उजाला, जनसत्ता, द पायोनीर, राष्ट्रीय सहारा, प्रभातखबर, लोकसत्ता

Others»»»

Hindi & English Editorial, Employment News, Malayalam Newspapers, Tamil, Telugu, Urdu, Gujarati

Type in Search box of Telegram @NewsTG8 And you will find a Channel named NewsTG join it and receive daily editions of all popular newspapers at the earliest

Or

you can click on this link

<https://t.me/NewsTG8>